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Rewiring Delhi's water future



NATION: Pg 5

Nepalese delegation led by RSP chief calls on Amit Shah



FILM: Pg 14

Anna to direct 'The Seven Husbands of Evelyn Hugo'

OPPOSITION DEMANDS PRADHAN'S SACKING

Govt replaces two top CBSE officials, orders probe into OSM procurement

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Centre on Tuesday ordered a high-level probe into the Central Board of Secondary Education's (CBSE) procurement of services for its controversial On-Screen Marking (OSM) system, while simultaneously removing the board's chairman and secretary amid growing concerns over alleged irregularities in the Class 12 digital evaluation process. The developments came as affected students, parents and opposition parties intensified scrutiny of the examination body's handling of answer-sheet evaluation, re-evaluation and grievance redressal mechanisms.

The government transferred CBSE Chairman Rahul Singh and Secretary Himanshu Gupta and appointed senior bureaucrats Lokhande Prashant Sitaram and Varun Bhardwaj as their replacements. The action followed allegations that scanned copies of answer sheets provided to



» CBSE SAID ITS RE-EVALUATION PORTAL FACED CYBERATTACKS, INCLUDING A DENIAL-OF-SERVICE ATTACK GENERATING 1.5 MILLION HITS IN TWO MINUTES

some Class 12 students during the re-evaluation process did not match their handwriting, triggering questions about possible answer-sheet mismatches within the OSM system. Soon after the reshuffle, the Cabinet Secretariat announced

the constitution of a one-member committee headed by S. Radha Chauhan, Chairperson of the Capacity Building Commission, to examine matters related to the procurement of services for the CBSE's on-screen marking system. According to an official memorandum,

the committee has been empowered to seek assistance from officials of other departments and will submit its findings to the Department of Personnel and Training within one month. The memorandum was also

shared with the Department of School Education and Literacy and the Department of Personnel and Training. The controversy has gathered momentum in recent weeks after students and parents reported technical glitches,

payment failures, delays in accessing answer books and problems during verification and re-evaluation. Questions were also raised about the transparency of the digital evaluation process.

The issue reached Parliament's Standing Committee on Education, Women, Children, Youth and Sports, chaired by Congress MP Digvijaya Singh. During a meeting of the panel on Tuesday, 17-year-old Jharkhand student Sarthak Sidhant, who appeared for the Class 12 board examination this year, presented a seven-page document detailing alleged anomalies in the tendering process adopted by the CBSE for selecting vendors for online marking services.

Sarthak's presentation was made in the presence of Rahul Singh, before his transfer, along with School Education Secretary Sanjay Kumar and other officials from the Ministry of Education and the CBSE.

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India rejects third-party role in resolving Nepal border dispute



Says issues must be resolved bilaterally

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: India, on Tuesday, clearly stated that it would not accept any third-party intervention in solving the boundary dispute issues with Nepal, emphasising that all pending issues between the two neighbours should be sorted out using the existing bilateral process.

The reaction followed after reports of Nepal having proposed the involvement of third parties like United Kingdom and China in sorting out some disputes between the two neighbouring nations.

While addressing the press here in the national capital, the Ministry of External Affairs spokesman, Randhir Jaiswal, said that India and Nepal have systems in place to handle all matters related to their boundary. He noted that more than 98 per cent of the 1,850-kilometre-long India-Nepal border has been delimited, except for a few portions. He said that some of the border disputes were caused by a change in the course of the Gandak River.

"Besides, there are instances where the territory is occupied beyond the border in No Man's Land on the portions of the border which have been delimited. These places are now being jointly surveyed," he said.

"Bilateral mechanisms are already in place for handling the problem," remarked Jaiswal, referring to the fact that both nations had made

KEY POINTS

» MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal says India and Nepal already have established systems to address boundary-related concerns

» Over 98% of the 1,850-km India-Nepal border has been demarcated; only a few stretches remain unresolved

arrangements for addressing such problems.

He then stressed the point that it was a strictly bilateral affair involving India and Nepal, adding, "It should be clear to all concerned that there is no room for any third parties to get involved in a bilateral affair."

India and Nepal have one of the most open international borders in South Asia. Despite having resolved almost all border issues, some disagreements continue to exist over limited stretches of this border, primarily at Kalapani-Lipulekh-Limpiyadhura in the west and Susta in the south.

The issue of Kalapani revolves around conflicting views on the source point of the Mahakali (or Kali) River. According to Nepal, the source point is Limpiyadhura, which implies that Kalapani, Lipulekh and Limpiyadhura lie within

Continued on P4

Venezuela's acting President Delcy Rodriguez begins India visit; energy, trade talks in focus

Talks come as India increases Venezuelan crude purchases amid disruptions in global oil supplies

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Delcy Rodriguez, Venezuela's acting president, will begin a five-day visit to India on June 3, with energy cooperation expected to dominate discussions as New Delhi seeks to strengthen crude oil supplies amid disruptions linked to the West Asia crisis. The visit, which runs until June 7, is also expected to focus on expanding collaboration in trade, investment, pharmaceuticals, technology, healthcare, transportation and renewable energy, reflecting a broader push by both countries to deepen bilateral ties.



Announcing the visit, External Affairs Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said Rodriguez is scheduled to hold extensive talks with Prime Minister Narendra Modi. The discussions will cover

Apart from official meetings, the Venezuelan delegation will visit facilities linked to India's energy, pharmaceutical and automobile sectors

the full spectrum of India-Venezuela relations and explore opportunities for greater cooperation across several sectors.

Rodriguez assumed office as Venezuela's acting president after

the detention of then president Nicolas Maduro by US forces in January. She will be accompanied by a high-level delegation that includes the ministers of foreign affairs, economy and finance, science and technology, communication and information, and transportation.

Energy security is expected to be a key theme during the visit. India was once among the largest buyers of Venezuelan heavy crude, importing more than 400,000 barrels per day at peak levels. However, purchases came to a halt in 2020 due to sweeping US sanctions

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HARVESTING HOPE



A worker plucks tea leaves at a tea garden, in Golaghat district, Assam, on Tuesday

Cabinet puzzle nears resolution as Shivakumar takes oath today

MPOST BUREAU

BENGALURU: Karnataka chief minister-designate D K Shivakumar is set to take oath as the state's new chief minister at Bengaluru's Lok Bhavan on June 3, even as the Congress leadership continued discussions in New Delhi on Tuesday to finalise the composition of the new cabinet.

The swearing-in ceremony, scheduled for 4.05 pm, has prompted extensive security and traffic arrangements in the city, with authorities preparing for large crowds of party workers and supporters expected to gather around the venue.

Shivakumar, who also serves as Karnataka Pradesh Congress Committee president, was elected leader of the



Shivakumar, who also serves as Karnataka Pradesh Congress Committee president, was elected leader of the Congress Legislature Party on May 30

Congress Legislature Party on May 30. He is expected to be sworn in along with a limited number of ministers in the first phase, with a larger cabinet expansion

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Seven killed, 40 hurt as two state-run buses collide near Surat

SURAT: At least seven persons were killed, and around 40 were injured after two buses operated by the Maharashtra State Road Transport Corporation (MSRTC) collided near Bardoli town in Gujarat's Surat district on Tuesday, and one of them caught fire, police said.

All the deceased were travelling in the bus that caught fire. The incident occurred on National Highway No. 53 near Uva village, officials said, adding that the road connects Maharashtra with Gujarat.

Surat district Superintendent of Police Rajesh Ghadhiya said one of the buses was travelling from Surat to Dhule, while the other was headed towards Surat from Chalisgaon in Maharashtra.

"On the highway from Bardoli to Vyara, the bus headed to Maharashtra hit a tractor. After losing balance, it jumped the divider and collided with the bus coming from the Maharashtra side, causing it to overturn and land in a low-lying area beside the road. The bus caught fire," said Ghadhiya.

He said teams of police, fire brigade and officials from Surat and the neighbouring Tapi district rushed to the spot and launched rescue operations immediately.

"We rescued several passengers trapped in the bus and shifted the injured to Bardoli hospital. Around 40 people sitting in both buses received injuries, while seven people lost their lives."

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Monsoon expected to onset over Kerala around June 4: IMD



MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The southwest monsoon is expected to onset over Kerala around June 4, the India Meteorological Department (IMD) said on Tuesday.

Typically, monsoon arrives in Kerala around June 1, which marks the beginning of the southwest monsoon season (June-September).

"Conditions are favourable for further advance of southwest monsoon into some more parts of southwest and southeast Arabian Sea, Lakshadweep Islands, some parts of Kerala and Tamil Nadu around June 4," the IMD said in its daily forecast. It added that the monsoon will also advance in some more parts of southwest, westcentral, eastcentral and northeast Bay of Bengal, and the remaining parts of southeast Bay of Bengal around this date.

The IMD had earlier said the monsoon onset over Kerala would take place on May 26.

Continued on P4

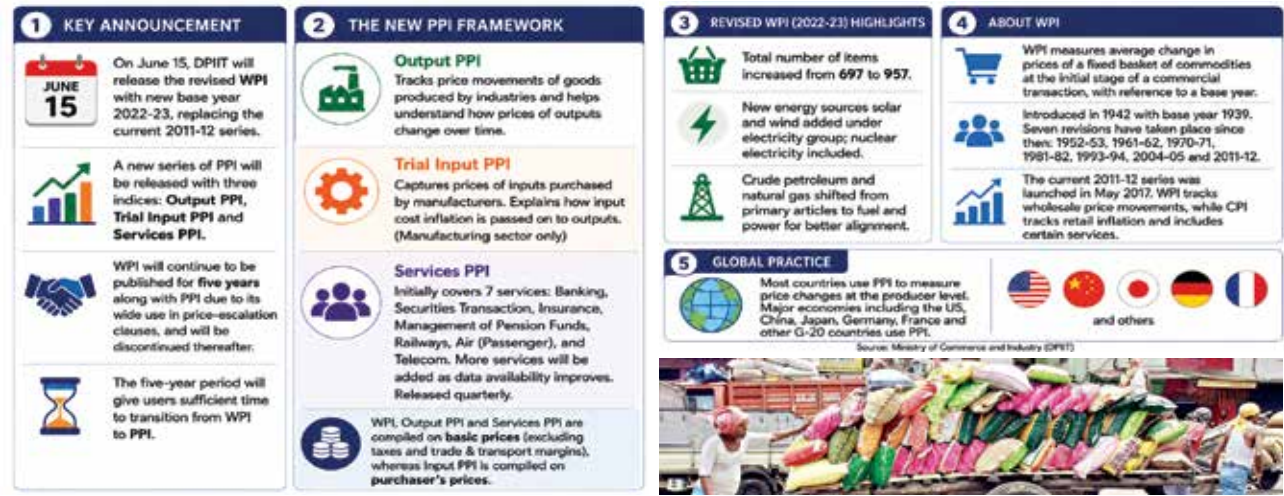
The IMD had earlier said the monsoon onset over Kerala would take place on May 26

Govt to replace WPI with Producer Price Index

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The government has announced plans to gradually discontinue the Wholesale Price Index (WPI) over the next five years and replace it with a more comprehensive Producer Price Index (PPI) framework aimed at providing a clearer picture of inflation trends across the economy. The transition will begin on June 15, when the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) releases a revised WPI series with a new base year of 2022-23 along with a new set of producer price indices covering output, input and services.

Speaking to reporters, Principal Economic Adviser in the Commerce and Industry Ministry Praveen Mahto said the



revised WPI series would replace the current 2011-12 base year series. Alongside it, the govern-

ment will launch three new producer price indices: Output PPI, Trial Input PPI and Services PPI.

The ministry said WPI would continue to be published for five years because of its widespread

use in long-term contracts and price-escalation clauses.

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NORTH DELHI'S MUKUNDPUR AREA

LPG blast triggers building collapse; 11 hurt & 1 critical



OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Eleven people were rescued, one of them in a critical state, after a single-storey utensil colouring factory collapsed in an LPG cylinder blast in north Delhi's Mukundpur area on Tuesday morning, officials said.

The incident occurred at Gali No. 1, Ishu Vihar, Mukundpur-II, near the cremation ground. According to the Delhi Fire Services (DFS), a call reporting the blast and house collapse was received at 9.37 am. The caller informed authorities that several residents were feared trapped under the debris.

"Information was received that a blast had taken place and a building had collapsed, trapping people inside. Rescue teams were immediately rushed to the spot and search and rescue operations were launched," a DFS official said.

Deputy Commissioner of Police (Outernorth) Hareeshwar Swami said police received information about the blast and collapse around 9.30 am, following which an Emergency Response Vehicle (ERV) that was patrolling nearby and local police personnel

“The building comprised a ground floor that was being used for refilling small LPG cylinders”

rushed to the spot. "Eleven people have been rescued. One woman suffered burn injuries and is in a critical condition. She has been referred to Safdarjung Hospital," Swami said.

The officer said an initial investigation suggested that the blast might have occurred while transferring gas from a big cylinder to a smaller one. Some cylinders were found at the spot.

"Prima facie, we got to know that a utensil colouring factory was being operated from the building. Many gas cylinders were found there. The process of transferring gas from big cylinders to small ones was taking place and that appears to be the possible reason behind the blast," Swami said.

According to DFS officials, the building comprised a ground floor that was allegedly being used for refilling small LPG cylinders from commer-

cial LPG cylinders when the blast took place, resulting in the collapse of the structure.

"Prima facie, we got to know that a utensil colouring factory was being operated from the house," Swami said.

The blast occurred in a 250-square yard single-storey house, officials said.

The DFS said 10 of the injured were taken to Babu Jagjivan Ram Memorial Hospital and Dr Baba Saheb Ambedkar Hospital for treatment, while the critically injured woman was referred to Safdarjung Hospital.

Authorities cleared debris and searched the collapsed structure to ensure no one remained trapped underneath.

Personnel from the National Disaster Response Force (NDRF), Delhi Fire Services, local police and a dog squad were deployed at the site. The DCP said that all injured were workers employed at the factory.

Eyewitnesses said they rushed to the site after hearing a loud explosion and joined rescue efforts. Ignoring their own injuries, locals cleared debris and helped pull out trapped victims, urging onlookers to stop filming and assist.

Two fatal stabbings reported in New Usmanpur

Victims include 26-yr-old man and 17-yr-old boy; cops examining motive and leads

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A 26-year-old man and a 17-year-old boy were stabbed to death in separate incidents reported in northeast Delhi's New Usmanpur area, police said on Tuesday.

In the first case, a 26-year-old man identified as Lalit, a resident of nearby Brahmpuri, was found dead in Bhagat Singh Colony during the early hours of Tuesday.

According to police, information about a stabbing incident was received at New Usmanpur Police Station in the morning. A police team rushed to the spot, where Lalit



was found lying on the ground. He had sustained multiple stab injuries and was declared dead at the scene.

A forensic team was called to examine the crime scene and collect evidence. Police said preliminary investigation sug-

gests that Lalit was murdered. A case has been registered under Section 103(1) (murder) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), and further investigation is underway.

In a separate incident in the same police station area, a

Further investigations are in progress to ascertain the circumstances that led to the fatal attacks and whether any personal enmity or other factors were involved: Police

17-year-old boy was stabbed to death on Monday night.

Police said they received information about the incident at around 10.25 pm. On reaching the location, officers found the teenager lying on the ground with stab injuries.

He was immediately taken to a nearby hospital, where doctors declared him dead.

Investigators are working to establish the motive behind the killing and are examining the victim's recent movements and associations. CCTV footage from the surrounding area is being scrutinised, while local residents are also being questioned as part of the probe.

Police said efforts are underway to identify and apprehend those responsible in both cases. Further investigations are in progress to ascertain the circumstances that led to the fatal attacks and whether any personal enmity or other factors were involved.

Political heat rises after Saket collapse

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The collapse of an unauthorised five-storey building in South Delhi's Said-ulajab area near Saket Metro Station, which claimed six people died and injured eight others, has triggered a fierce political confrontation, with questions mounting over civic oversight, alleged official negligence, and the enforcement of building regulations in the Capital.

The structure, which housed a coaching centre, a café and a women's paying guest accommodation, came crashing down on May 30. In the aftermath, councillors of the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) staged a protest outside the office of Municipal Commissioner Sanjeev Khirwar at the Civic Centre, accusing the BJP-led Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) of failing to act despite repeated warnings about the building.

AAP leaders alleged that local residents had earlier approached the Delhi High Court through a writ petition challenging the property's unauthorised construction.



They claimed that despite concerns over the building's condition, the MCD informed the court that no construction activity was taking place and described the matter as a private dispute. Protesters demanded criminal proceedings against officials responsible for monitoring illegal constructions, arguing that timely intervention could have prevented the loss of lives.

The Delhi Police have arrested the building owner, while Chief Minister Rekha Gupta has ordered a magisterial inquiry into the incident. The MCD has also suspended Junior Engineer Aman Jain and Assistant Engineer Sudesh

Singh Chouhan, citing dereliction of duty, inadequate supervision and lapses connected to the collapsed structure.

Responding to the allegations, MCD councillor Satya Sharma described the incident as "deeply tragic" and expressed condolences to the victims' families. She said the civic body was prepared to examine all complaints and take stringent action against unauthorised constructions.

"This is a time for accountability and corrective measures, not political confrontation," she said, adding that strict legal action would be taken wherever violations are found. The tragedy has left students in

the area shaken, with many expressing concerns about safety in Delhi's densely populated educational hubs. "It could have been any one of us," a student said.

As investigations continue, the collapse has reignited a broader debate on civic accountability, urban safety and the human cost of unchecked illegal construction.

According to the MCD, the collapsed building, spread across nearly 300 square metres, comprised a basement and four floors, with upper storeys added in recent years. Officials said it was located in an unauthorised colony not among the 1,511 colonies identified for regularisation.

Mayor Pravesh Wahi said officials found responsible for negligence had been suspended and assured a detailed investigation into the incident. He said action would also be taken against senior officers if their involvement was established, and added that engineers had been directed to identify illegal constructions and initiate action as part of an ongoing crackdown across all 12 MCD zones.

Police nabs two more linked to Ghaziabad killing

DIPIKA KIROLA

GHAZIABAD: Ghaziabad Police have arrested two more men in connection with the murder of Surya, which took place in Ghaziabad on Bakrid. The accused, identified as Farhan and Atif, were apprehended from Pilibhit.

According to police, both men had been living and working in Ghaziabad for some time. During the investigation, officers allegedly found that Farhan had supplied the knife used in the murder to the main accused, Asad. Police teams travelled to Pilibhit and conducted searches at the accused's homes in the Bujkasawan locality. Family members were also questioned. The arrests have caused a stir in the area, with residents expressing surprise at the alleged involvement of the two men.

The main accused, Asad, was killed in a police encounter on May 28, officials said.

Meanwhile, the local administration has issued a notice to Asad's father, Nawab, regarding his house. Authorities claim the property was constructed on government land and have sought a reply within 15 days. Officials said action could be taken against the structure if a satisfactory response is not received. Police said the investigation remains ongoing and further action will depend on its findings.



Cops apprehend 3 more in Amar Colony murder

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: A second juvenile and two more accused have been apprehended by the Delhi Police Crime Branch in connection with the murder of 17-year-old Sai, who was shot in the head during a violent altercation outside a restaurant in South Delhi's Amar Colony last month.

According to police, the latest arrests include Jai Kumar, Yash and another juvenile whose age is being verified. The arrests come days after the Crime Branch's Northern Range team detained a 16-year-old juvenile allegedly involved in the shooting.

Sai succumbed to his injuries on May 26 after battling for six days in hospital. Investigators said the inci-

Sai succumbed to his injuries on May 26 after battling for six days: Cops

dent stemmed from a heated argument at a restaurant in Amar Colony that escalated into violence.

Acting on a tip-off, police conducted a raid in Shyam Nagar near Okhla Estate and apprehended the juvenile suspect. During questioning, he allegedly admitted his involvement in the incident. Police also recovered an automatic pistol believed to have been used in the crime.

The Crime Branch is continuing its investigation to establish the roles of all accused and determine whether others were involved.

Poor maintenance, monsoon woes & damaged drains continue to plague Jasola Janta Pocket 11

SHIVANGI SHUKLA

NEW DELHI: Residents of Jasola Janta Pocket 11 in Okhla have raised concerns over the deteriorating condition of their housing colony, alleging years of poor maintenance and civic neglect.

Locals claim that despite repeated complaints, there has been little improvement in the area's infrastructure. According to residents, the condition is similar across all blocks of the colony.

The area is grappling with

multiple issues, including damaged drainage systems, water-logging during the monsoon and cracks in buildings. Residents say the situation worsens during the rainy season, when water accumulates outside homes and on internal roads, disrupting daily life.

Atif Sheikh, a resident who has lived in the colony since 2004, said he has never witnessed any major maintenance work despite numerous complaints over the years.

"We face water-related issues and often have to arrange

“Locals claim that despite repeated complaints, there has been little improvement in the area's infra”

water from outside," he said. Speaking about electricity supply during the peak summer months, he added, "There are generally no power cuts, except occasionally when there

is a technical fault." Another resident, Madhavan Mohan, expressed disappointment over what he described as a lack of action by authorities and elected representatives.

"People come seeking votes, but no major issues are resolved. During the monsoon, the entire street outside our homes gets flooded and there is no one to address the problem," he said.

A local shopkeeper, who did not wish to be identified, alleged that some individuals discourage residents from fil-

ing complaints regarding the condition of the colony.

Residents continue to demand repair and maintenance work in the area. However, when contacted regarding the issue, officials from the Delhi Development Authority (DDA) said the colony does not fall under its maintenance jurisdiction and is instead managed by the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD). They added that the area also faces significant illegal encroachment, which could invite official action.

Court awards 10-yr term to three in dowry assault case

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: A Delhi court has sentenced three members of a family to 10 years of rigorous imprisonment in a dowry harassment and attempted murder case in which a young woman was allegedly thrown from the second-floor balcony of her home, leaving her permanently paralysed below the waist.

The sentence was pronounced on June 1, nearly four years after the case was registered at Kalindi Kunj Police Station in South-East Delhi.

According to police, the victim alleged that she was subjected to persistent cruelty, harassment and dowry demands by her husband, Amir Khan, mother-in-law Nasrin, and brother-in-law Sonu alias Firoz.

Investigators found that on February 14, 2022, a dispute over dowry demands escalated into violence, following which the three accused allegedly threw the woman from the balcony of their house. She sustained severe spinal injuries, resulting in permanent paralysis.

Following an investigation involving medical, documentary and scientific evidence, police filed a charge sheet against the accused.

Additional Sessions Judge Vishal Singh of Saket Courts convicted all three under Section 307 read with Section 34 of the IPC. Amir Khan and Nasrin were also convicted under Section 498A.

The court additionally directed compensation for the victim under the Victim Compensation Scheme.

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: As Delhi reels under soaring temperatures, concerns are mounting among students enrolled in the fourth year of the University of Delhi's Four-Year Undergraduate Programme (FYUP), with many questioning both the timing and utility of the additional academic year.

The university has directed colleges to operate from 8 a.m. to 8 p.m. to accommodate fourth-year classes. However, students say prolonged campus hours, coupled with temperatures exceeding 40°C, have made attendance and commuting increasingly difficult. Concerns over inadequate cooling facilities, dehydration risks and extended practical sessions have added to the challenges.

Beyond the immediate impact of the heatwave, several students have raised broader concerns about the structure of the FYUP itself. Danya Sharma,



a fourth-year student at Sri Aurobindo College, said the additional year has increased academic and financial burdens without offering proportional benefits for many students.

"The programme extends the duration of a degree, delaying plans for employment, higher studies and other career opportunities. Students also have to bear an extra year of tuition fees, accommodation expenses and other costs while managing internships and examinations," she said.

According to Sharma, while the fourth year may benefit stu-

'The programme extends the duration of a degree, delaying plans for employment, higher studies and other career opportunities'

dents interested in research, its advantages remain unclear for those pursuing jobs or professional courses. Similar concerns were echoed by students from Maitreyi College, who said the programme has delayed their entry into the workforce and postponed professional opportunities.

Students also argued that the fourth year lacks sufficient practical and field-based learning components that could justify the extended duration. Several expressed concern that the programme's implementation has outpaced the development of the infrastructure and

support systems needed to sustain it effectively.

Faculty members have likewise questioned whether colleges possess adequate resources, classrooms and staffing to support longer schedules. As the debate continues, the experience of students navigating both an intense heatwave and an extended academic calendar has renewed scrutiny of whether the objectives of the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 can be achieved without corresponding investments in student welfare and institutional infrastructure.

Noida plans 6-km elevated road to ease Delhi-bound traffic

DIPIKA KIROLA

NOIDA: Noida Authority has planned a six-km, six-lane elevated road connecting MP-1 and MP-2 roads to provide relief to thousands of commuters travelling between Greater Noida West, Noida and Delhi.

The proposed elevated corridor will stretch from beyond the Rajnigandha underpass to Uflex in Sector 60 and is expected to ease congestion near the National Dalit Prerna Sthal, one of the busiest traffic bottlenecks on the route, said officials. The project, estimated to cost around Rs 700 crore, is aimed at improving connectivity towards the DND Flyway and reducing travel time for daily commuters. Officials said the elevated road will allow motorists to bypass three major traffic signals, cutting the journey from nearly 30 minutes to around 10 minutes during peak hours.

The Noida Authority has received the feasibility report for the project from IIT Roorkee and has now assigned the

“The elevated road is being seen as a key infrastructure initiative to address long-standing congestion issues”

institute the task of preparing the detailed project report (DPR). The authority will pay about Rs 3.5 crore for the DPR, which will include engineering designs, traffic studies and implementation details.

Officials said the project is expected to significantly improve traffic flow on the Noida-Delhi corridor and benefit residents of Greater Noida West, including those living in large residential societies that rely on this route for daily travel.

The elevated road is being seen as a key infrastructure initiative to address long-standing congestion issues and strengthen connectivity between Noida, Greater Noida West and Delhi.

A NEW BLUEPRINT FOR EVERY DROP

Rewiring Delhi's WATER FUTURE

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: As Delhi battles recurring summer water shortages and an ageing distribution network, the city government has unveiled an ambitious reform package aimed at reshaping how water is supplied, conserved and reused across the Capital. The initiative includes a scientific water rationalisation plan, replacement of old pipelines, reduction of water losses and the introduction of a dual-piping system to recycle treated water, measures that officials describe as the most significant overhaul of Delhi's water management system in decades. Announcing the reforms on Tuesday, Water Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said the government was pursuing both immediate and long-term solutions to ensure equitable water access for all residents. The move comes at a time when Delhi's water demand has touched nearly 1,250 million gallons per day (MGD) during peak summer, while a prolonged dry spell in the Yamuna has reduced water production by around 100 MGD in recent days.

"People should understand that Delhi's water resources are finite while its population continues to grow. The answer is not only to bring more water to Delhi but also to manage every drop more efficiently. We are building a system that can serve Delhi not just today, but for decades to come," Singh said.

A key component of the reform agenda is the proposed Water Rationalisation Project, which seeks to address long-standing disparities in water distribution. According to the minister, complaints of water scarcity are concentrated in 12 to 13 Assembly constituencies every summer, while some areas receive comparatively higher supplies. "Still in 12 to 13 Assembly constituencies from where the majority of water-related complaints are received every summer. At the same time, there are areas receiving comparatively higher water supply. This imbalance has existed for years. We are now

HIGHLIGHTS

- » The initiative includes a scientific water rationalisation plan, replacement of old pipelines, reduction of water losses and the introduction of a dual-piping system to recycle treated water
- » Announcing the reforms on Tuesday, Water Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said the government was pursuing both immediate and long-term solutions to ensure equitable water access for all residents
- » A key component of

the reform agenda is the proposed Water Rationalisation Project, which seeks to address long-standing disparities in water distribution



working on a Water Rationalisation Project to ensure that every citizen, irrespective of where they live, gets equitable access to water," he said.

The project will analyse population density, consumption patterns, infrastructure availability and supply levels to create a more balanced distribution system.

The government is also targeting losses caused by ageing infrastructure. Singh said that nearly 5,500 kilometres of Delhi's 16,634-km water distribution network is more than 30 years old, making it vulnerable to leaks and contamination.

"Out of Delhi's 16,634-kilometre water distribution network, nearly 5,500 kilometres of pipelines are more than 30 years old. These ageing lines are prone to leakages and contamination," he said, adding that replacement of old pipelines has been prioritised.

As part of the broader reform agenda, the Delhi Jal Board is also moving ahead with projects aimed at reducing Non-Revenue Water (NRW), which refers to treated water lost due to leakages, theft and inefficiencies in the distribution network.

Another major reform under consideration is converting the open DSB Canal into a

closed pipeline-based system. According to the minister, 40-45 per cent of water is currently lost through the canal network. IIT Roorkee has been tasked with conducting a feasibility study for the project.

The government also plans to introduce a Dual Piping System under which highly treated recycled water will be supplied separately for non-drinking purposes such as flushing, landscaping, construction and vehicle washing.

The initiative will first be introduced in government buildings before being expanded to hotels, commercial establishments and housing societies, with incentives proposed for adopters. "Delhi cannot afford to flush drinking water down toilets. By using highly treated recycled water for such activities, we can save millions of litres of freshwater daily," Singh said.

Reaffirming the government's commitment, the minister said, "Our goal is that every household should receive clean water, every drop should be utilised efficiently and no area of Delhi should feel neglected." He added that the reforms are aimed at building a more resilient and equitable water system for future generations.

CM, German delegation discuss mobility, infra...

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Tuesday held talks with Mario Voigt, Minister-President of the German state of Thuringia, to explore avenues for deeper cooperation in areas ranging from smart urban development and digital governance to skill development, education and environmental technologies.

The meeting, held at the Delhi Secretariat, was attended by members of the visiting German delegation and focused on strengthening partnerships that could support Delhi's development priorities while expanding India-Germany cooperation at the sub-national level.

According to the Chief Minister's Office, discussions covered a broad range of sectors,



including sustainable urban infrastructure, digital innovation, talent mobility, water management, workforce development and clean technologies. Both sides explored opportunities for collaboration that could contribute to improving public

services, fostering innovation and creating employment opportunities.

Following the meeting, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta described the interaction as constructive and forward-looking. "I had a productive inter-

action with Mr. Mario Voigt, Minister-President of the German State of Thuringia, and the accompanying delegation at the Delhi Secretariat," Gupta said.

Highlighting the key areas discussed, she said both sides explored possibilities for cooperation in "smart urban development and sustainable infrastructure, digital governance and innovation, skill development and talent mobility, mobility, water management and environmental technologies, and education and workforce development."

The Chief Minister said the engagement reflected the growing scope of India-Germany relations and the role that states and cities can play in strengthening bilateral ties through knowledge-sharing and institutional partnerships.

Emphasising Delhi's commitment to global collaborations, Gupta stated, "Under the leadership of Hon'ble Prime Minister Narendra Modi, the India-Germany partnership continues to grow stronger across diverse sectors. Delhi is proud to contribute to this shared journey of innovation, sustainability and human development."

The visit comes at a time when Delhi is focusing on improving urban infrastructure, expanding digital governance initiatives and enhancing skill development programmes. Germany, known for its expertise in advanced manufacturing, vocational training, environmental technologies and sustainable urban planning, is considered a key partner in several development sectors.

Min Sirsa reviews pollution concerns

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Environment and Industries Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa on Tuesday visited Mungeshpur village and the Bawana Industrial Area to assess pollution-related concerns, review civic infrastructure and examine ongoing development projects in the region.

Accompanied by Social Welfare Minister and Bawana MLA Ravinder Indraj Singh, Sirsa interacted with residents and reviewed complaints related to air pollution, environmental degradation and public infrastructure. Residents raised concerns about emissions from industrial units located along the Delhi-Haryana border and their impact on air quality and public health.

Addressing residents, Sirsa said, "The Delhi Government's objective is to move forward by balancing development with

environmental conservation. Guided by this vision, and with the active participation and cooperation of the people, we are continuously working towards building a clean, healthy, and better Delhi."

The ministers conducted an on-ground inspection of the area and reviewed measures aimed at improving environmental conditions, cleanliness and sustainable development. They also attended a community programme at Ganga Toli Temple, where bicycles were distributed to girls and health camps offering cancer screening and eye check-ups for women were organised.

During the visit, a forest land parcel in Mungeshpur was inspected, with discussions focusing on large-scale plantation drives and the development of green zones to strengthen green cover and improve ecological balance in rural Delhi.



City Briefs

DELHI SECRETARIAT CELEBRATES GOA DAY AND TELANGANA DAY

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government on Tuesday organised a cultural programme at the Delhi Secretariat to mark Goa Day and Telangana Day, highlighting the contributions of both states to India's development and cultural diversity. Chief Minister Rekha Gupta extended greetings to the people of Goa and Telangana and praised their achievements in tourism, technology and industry. She said, "Goa is globally renowned for its natural beauty, rich cultural traditions and international tourism, while Telangana has emerged as one of the country's leading states in information technology, pharmaceuticals, innovation and industrial development." The event featured Goa's traditional Fisher Dance and a Telangana folk dance performance, drawing enthusiastic applause from the audience. Art, Culture and Languages Minister Kapil Mishra said, "The cultural achievements of Goa and Telangana are a powerful example of the harmony between India's diversity, traditions and modern development."

MCD SIGNS MOUs WITH FOUR AGENCIES FOR GEOSPATIAL PILOT

NEW DELHI: In a move aimed at modernising urban governance and improving property tax administration, the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) has signed Memoranda of Understanding (MoUs) with four agencies to undertake pilot projects using advanced geospatial technologies. The initiative will deploy drone-based aerial surveys, LiDAR mapping, Digital Twin technology, 3D city modelling, GIS-based asset mapping and data analytics to identify unassessed and under-assessed properties across selected areas of the Capital. Civic officials said the project is expected to enhance property tax collection while creating a more accurate database of municipal assets.

DELHI RECORDS HIGH OF 37.7 DEG C, NO HEATWAVE LIKELY THIS WEEK

NEW DELHI: Delhi on Tuesday recorded a maximum temperature of 37.7 degrees Celsius, 2.3 degrees below normal, amid relatively mild weather conditions across the city, weather data showed. According to the India Meteorological Department (IMD), temperatures remained below normal across monitoring stations, with Safdarjung, the base station, recording a maximum of 37.7 degrees Celsius, while the minimum stood at 26.8 degrees Celsius.

Cooling support reaches lakhs

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: As Delhi continues to grapple with soaring temperatures, the city government has intensified its heatwave relief campaign, reaching over 4.7 lakh residents through mobile relief units, cooling zones and temporary shelters set up across all 13 districts.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Tuesday said that since the launch of Mobile Heat Relief Units on May 6, relief has been provided to 4,70,089 people. During the period, authorities distributed 1,84,021 litres of drinking water, 2,43,945 ORS packets, 67,431 gamchas and 49,434 caps to help residents cope with extreme heat conditions.

According to government data, the highest number of

beneficiaries was recorded in the North-East district, where 83,703 people received assistance, followed by East district (66,964) and New Delhi district (41,667). New Delhi district distributed the highest quantity of drinking water at 32,974 litres, while Central North district distributed the highest number of ORS packets at 71,625.

The government has also established temporary shelters and cooling zones at key public locations, including metro stations such as Nangloi, Rohini and Peeragarhi, along with bus terminals and major markets.

"Cooling zones and temporary shelters are now fully operational at some locations, while installation and expansion work is underway at others. The government is continuously reviewing the situation and will

further expand relief measures wherever required," Gupta said.

In the Central district alone, 5,475 people have benefited from these shelters, where 2,100 litres of water and 375 ORS packets were distributed. Similar relief measures have been extended in West, South and North-East districts.

The Chief Minister urged residents to avoid unnecessary outdoor movement during peak heat hours, stay hydrated and use ORS when required.

"The Delhi Government remains committed to ensuring that no resident of the capital is deprived of relief and assistance during the ongoing heatwave," Gupta said, adding that the administration would continue monitoring conditions and expanding support wherever needed.

FOCUS ON ECOLOGY, CLIMATE RESILIENCE

New Ridge board for greener Delhi

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu has approved the reconstitution of the Ridge management board to preserve and secure the green lungs of the national capital.

The reconstituted Delhi Ridge Management Board (DRMB), in pursuance of a Supreme Court order, will transition Ridge governance through an integrated, multi-agency regulatory body, Lok Niwas officials said.

The Ridge represents ancient remnants of the Aravali range in the national capital, which contribute prominently to the city's green cover.

According to the officials, the board's primary mandate will be absolute ecological balance, climate resilience, and the protection of Delhi's vital Ridge ecosystem through a

The Ridge represents ancient remnants of the Aravali range in the national capital, which contribute prominently to the city's green cover

combination of senior secretariat leadership and prominent environmental experts.

The Ridge in the national capital is owned by the Delhi Development Authority (DDA), while the Environment and Forest Department of the Union Territory government is responsible for its maintenance. Agencies, including the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD), New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC), Revenue Department and Delhi Police are responsible for enforcement to protect it.

The reconstituted board will be an inter-agency platform designed to streamline environmental surveillance and eliminate administrative silos,

they said. Headed by the Chief Secretary of the Delhi government, the board will include the vice-chairman of DDA, an inspector general of forests rank officer from the Ministry of Environment, and a senior officer of the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs, heads of MCD and NDMC as members.

The technical and regulatory enforcement will be ensured by the Director General of the Central Public Works Department (CPWD), the Joint Commissioner of Delhi Police, and the principal secretaries of revenue and environment departments.

The Principal Chief Conservator of Forests, Delhi government, has been appointed

as member-secretary to oversee ground-level execution, while Chandra Prakash Goyal will represent the Central empowered committee (CEC) as a specialised board member, officials said. The panel will integrate civil society and non-governmental organisations, top environmental experts for enhanced public ownership and expert consultation. Arvind Madhav Singh of Centre for Sustainable Green Economy will serve as a non-government member to integrate sustainable global methodologies into ridge preservation, while Malvika Kaul will drive data-centric public participation and microflora enrichment strategies, officials said.

A specialised standing committee under the board will operate concurrently to handle rapid-response environmental interventions.

Burari DTO comes under CM's scanner



AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Tuesday conducted a surprise inspection of key Transport Department facilities in Burari, expressing displeasure over poor public amenities at the District Transport Office (DTO) and directing officials to immediately improve conditions for citizens.

During the visit, Gupta inspected the under-construction Automated Testing Station (ATS), the DTO office, the Vehicle Inspection Unit and the Heavy Motor Vehicle Training Institute. She reviewed infrastructure, service delivery and public facilities, stressing that government offices must provide citizens with dignified and convenient services.

At the DTO office, the Chief Minister interacted with applicants waiting for driving licence tests and found several people standing outside the premises due to inadequate arrangements. Citizens complained about the lack of seating, drinking water and other basic amenities.

Taking serious note of the situation, Gupta directed officials to ensure that no visitor is forced to wait outside and ordered immediate arrangements for seating, clean drinking water, fans, coolers and hygienic toilets.

"Citizens who visit government offices for services are entitled to respectful treatment and better facilities. Making people wait in extreme heat without access to basic amenities is unacceptable under any circumstances," she said.

The Chief Minister also reviewed the condition of the DTO complex and called for a comprehensive redevelopment

“ Making people wait in extreme heat without access to basic amenities is unacceptable under any circumstances

ment plan. She said the campus should be transformed into a model transport service centre with modern infrastructure, citizen amenities, parking facilities, green spaces and upgraded administrative offices.

Earlier, Gupta inspected the under-construction ATS project and was informed that the facility would be capable of testing five vehicles simultaneously and conducting fitness inspections of 80,000 to 90,000 commercial vehicles annually. She directed officials to maintain quality standards and complete the project within the stipulated timeline. Highlighting sustainable infrastructure, she stressed the need for rainwater harvesting within the complex and instructed officials to maximise groundwater recharge.

The Chief Minister also visited the Vehicle Inspection Unit and Heavy Motor Vehicle Training Institute, where she reviewed training facilities and simulation-based learning systems.

"Modern testing centres, improved training institutions, citizen-friendly offices and technology-driven services are important steps in this direction. Citizens of Delhi will be provided transport services that are transparent, convenient, safe and world-class," Gupta said.

She directed that all instructions issued during the inspection be implemented in a time-bound manner.

Twin civic push

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: With the monsoon approaching and waste management remaining a key urban challenge, the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) on Tuesday launched parallel initiatives aimed at strengthening sanitation infrastructure, promoting waste segregation, and improving preparedness against water logging across the Capital.

Delhi Mayor Pravesh Wahi inaugurated an "Aerobin" composting unit at Printer Apartments Housing Society in Rohini, describing it as a practical step towards decentralised waste management. The technology enables the conversion of up to 10 kg of wet waste into compost within approximately 40 days using bio-culture, while remaining odour-free.

Addressing residents

and civic officials, Wahi said source-level waste segregation would play a critical role in reducing the burden on Delhi's landfill sites. He urged housing societies to adopt similar composting systems, arguing that community-led initiatives could significantly cut the volume of waste transported to dumping grounds. Reiterating the civic body's commitment to eliminating landfill sites, he said sustained participation from citizens would be crucial in achieving the goal.

The Mayor also flagged off an intensive road-cleaning drive in Rohini, where mechanical sweepers and jetting machines were deployed along major roads. During inspections of residential lanes, he directed officials to maintain sanitation standards and warned against lapses in civic services.

UNDER JAL JEEVAN MISSION 2.0

Centre inks MoU with four states, UT to boost rural water supply

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Central government on Tuesday signed agreements with the states of Arunachal Pradesh, Jharkhand, Tamil Nadu, Nagaland and the Union Territory of Puducherry to strengthen rural drinking water supply systems under Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0.

The Memoranda of Understanding were signed during separate virtual meetings attended by Union Jal Shakti Minister CR Patil, Minister of State V Somanna and chief ministers of the respective states and Union Territory.

The agreements sought to institutionalise a model of rural water governance led by Gram Panchayats and were service-based and community-centred. The model aims to focus on the sustainability, quality, operation and maintenance, and community ownership of rural water

Highlights

- » The agreements sought to institutionalise a model of rural water governance led by Gram Panchayats and were service-based and community-centred
- » Patil said Gram Panchayats, district and state water and sanitation missions, and local communities must work together to ensure reliable drinking water services

supply infrastructure, according to a statement.

Addressing the virtual meetings, Patil said Gram Panchayats, district and state water and sanitation missions, and local communities must work together to ensure reliable drinking water services.

Highlighting the challenges posed by mountainous terrain and heavy rainfall in Arunachal Pradesh, Patil said a revised Operation and Maintenance Policy will be notified for the state soon.

He called for regular meetings of district water and

sanitation missions, faster accreditation of laboratories and observance of "Jal Arpan Diwas" for formal handover of water assets to gram panchayats.

In the case of Jharkhand, Patil laid emphasis on proper operation and maintenance, source sustainability and water conservation. He urged the state government to expedite the ongoing works so that all remaining rural households receive safe drinking water.

Commending Tamil Nadu's progress under the Jal Jeevan Mission, Patil called for greater focus on rainwater harvest-

ing, source sustainability, water conservation and greywater management.

For Puducherry, which achieved "Har Ghar Jal" certification in 2021, he said the priority should now be to ensure regular, reliable and sustainable water services, public awareness, community ownership, creation of Sujal Gaon IDs and notification of a revised Operation and Maintenance Policy.

Addressing the Nagaland chief minister, Patil expressed confidence that the state will provide tap water connections to all remaining households this year.

Arunachal Pradesh Chief Minister Pema Khandu said the mission has significantly transformed rural drinking water supply in the state despite difficult terrain, scattered habitations and remote locations.

He said the MoU under JJM 2.0 will further strengthen water

security and improve sustainability and reliability of rural drinking water supply systems.

Jharkhand Chief Minister Hemant Soren said the state remains committed to providing safe and reliable drinking water to every rural household and noted that the MoU will help expand functional household tap water connections, especially in remote areas.

He pointed to challenges such as difficult terrain and the need for clearances to lay pipelines through forest areas and land under agencies such as the National Highways Authority of India and Damodar Valley Corporation, and sought continued support from the Centre.

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay welcomed the extension of the Jal Jeevan Mission till December 2028 and said the state faces unique challenges as it does not have any major perennial source of water.

'NO LOCUS STANDI'

India rejects references to J&K in Pakistan-EU joint statement

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: India on Tuesday categorically rejected "unwarranted" references to Jammu and Kashmir in a joint press communique issued by Pakistan and the European Union, asserting that the region is an "inalienable part" of the country.

External Affairs Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said those who have no locus standi on the matter should desist from making such comments. "We categorically reject such unwarranted references in the joint press communique on matters internal to India," he said at his weekly media briefing.

Jaiswal was responding to a question on the communique.

"The Union Territories of Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh are integral and inalienable parts of India. Those who have no locus standi on such matters should desist from mak-

Randhir Jaiswal said those who have no locus standi on the matter should desist from making such comments

ing any comment on them," he said. The joint press communique was issued following Pakistan Foreign Minister Ishaq Dar's talks with EU Foreign and Security Policy Chief Kaja Kallas in Islamabad.

The communique had a reference to the "issue of Jammu and Kashmir".

It was issued after the eighth Pakistan-EU strategic dialogue.

The communique noted that the Pakistani side briefed the EU delegation on the "issue of Jammu and Kashmir" while the EU delegation briefed Pakistan on "Russia's war against Ukraine".

India successfully test-fires RudraM-II air-to-surface missiles

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The DRDO and the Indian Air Force have conducted the successful flight-tests of RudraM-II air-to-surface missiles from an airborne platform, the defence ministry said on Tuesday.

The missiles, after release, were guided to a predefined target with pin-point accuracy, it said, adding all the test objectives were "fully" met.

The ministry said the tests were conducted "under extreme release conditions" with critical trajectory establishing the capability of all subsystems.

The range of the missile is around 350 kms.

"The missiles after release were guided to a predefined target with pin-point accuracy. All the test objectives were fully met as confirmed by the flight data captured by various range instruments deployed by Integrated Test Range (ITR), Chandipur," the ministry said in a statement.

From Page 1

Govt replaces two top CBSE

The parliamentary committee had summoned senior officials from the Ministry of Education and the board to discuss issues arising from the implementation of the OSM system and the difficulties reported by students during the verification and re-evaluation process.

CBSE officials presented their own report before committee members and informed them that technical glitches affecting the portal had been addressed. The board also assured lawmakers that students would have until June 6 to apply for re-evaluation and related corrections.

When asked whether he was satisfied with the CBSE's explanations, Digvijaya Singh said, "That is for the committee to decide."

"The committee has always been looking at the issues of students and their problems. This is exactly what the committee has done," he told reporters after the meeting.

The panel also discussed implementation of the three-language formula in Classes 9 and 10, though Singh declined to comment on the matter, saying it was sub judice.

The Appointments Committee of the Cabinet approved the appointment of Lokhande Prashant Sitaram, a 2001-batch IAS officer of the AGMUT cadre and currently an additional secretary in the Ministry of Home Affairs, as the new CBSE chairperson.

Rahul Singh has been appointed as additional secretary in the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare.

The committee also approved the premature repatriation of Himanshu Gupta, a 2012-batch IAS officer, to his parent cadre in the Ministry of Home Affairs on administrative grounds. According to the order, Gupta will be eligible for another central deputation only after December 12, 2030.

Varun Bhardwaj, a 2008-batch Indian Information Service officer currently serving as director in the Ministry of Education, has been appointed as the new CBSE secretary.

The developments triggered strong political reactions, with opposition leaders arguing that the transfer of officials did not amount to accountability.

The Congress renewed its demand for the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan, alleging that responsibility for the controversy ultimately lay with the Ministry of Education.

In a statement on social media, the party said the minister was accountable for the alleged irregularities and claimed the government could not avoid responsibility by transferring officials.

Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi described the action as a "cover-up."

"Officials removed. Minister spared. This isn't accountability, it's a cover-up," Gandhi wrote on X.

He further said that if the Prime Minister was concerned about students affected by the controversy, action should have been taken against the education minister.

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge also termed the transfer of the CBSE chairman and secretary a "mere eyewash" and demanded that Pradhan be removed from office.

Congress general secretary Jairam Ramesh argued that the timing of the transfers, coming after the parliamentary committee meeting, appeared aimed at shifting responsibility to bureaucrats rather than political leadership. He noted that Rahul Singh had received a two-year extension from the Appointments Committee of the Cabinet as recently as November 2025.

Aam Aadmi Party national convener Arvind Kejriwal also questioned whether the transfer of officials amounted to punishment, alleging that the government was shielding those responsible.

Amid the administrative and political turmoil, the CBSE disclosed that its re-evaluation portal had come under a series of cyberattacks on Tuesday.

According to the board, "malicious actors" attempted to disrupt services through a denial-of-service attack that generated 1.5 million hits within two minutes. The board also reported more than one lakh attempts at unauthorised file access.

The CBSE said that despite the attacks, the portal remained operational and was supporting more than 8,000 concurrent users. As of 3 pm, over 16,000 students had successfully completed their submissions.

"While thousands of students accessed the CBSE re-evaluation portal today, malicious actors attempted to disrupt services through a barrage of cyberattacks," the board said in a statement posted on X.

Based on feedback from students, the board said it had refined the platform and extended session time limits to make the process smoother.

Cybersecurity expert Srinivas L, Joint Managing Director and Joint CEO of 63SATS Cybertech, described the incident as a coordinated operation involving both denial-of-service attacks and attempts to gain access to files.

He said the scale of activity suggested more than a routine disruption attempt and noted that the board had managed to keep services functioning despite the pressure. At the same time, he cautioned that India's examination infrastructure needed stronger built-in cyber resilience rather than relying on reactive responses after attacks occur.

The CBSE on Tuesday also formally opened its online portal for verification of issues observed in scanned answer books and for re-evaluation requests from students dissatisfied with their results.

The facility is available only to candidates who have already obtained scanned copies of their evaluated answer books. Stu-

dents can report issues such as missing pages, missing supplementary sheets, missing maps or graphs, blurred pages, incorrect answer books or evaluation against the wrong question paper set.

The application window opened on June 2 and will remain available until midnight on June 6. The entire process, including fee payment, is being conducted online through Aadhaar-based authentication.

Students without Aadhaar can use the Aadhaar details of a parent, guardian or relative, provided the corresponding personal details match the submitted information.

The CBSE has fixed a fee of Rs 100 per answer book for verification of issues in scanned copies and Rs 25 per question for re-evaluation. Payments can be made through UPI, debit cards, credit cards and net banking.

The board has advised students to carefully review all details before final submission, noting that information cannot be changed once the payment process is initiated.

The re-evaluation portal was launched after a delay, as the board had earlier indicated that applications were expected to begin by May 29.

India rejects

Nepal's territorial jurisdiction. The Indian view, on the other hand, differs in that the source is located further to the east.

The dispute emerged in 2020, when India laid a road linking Dharchula to Lipulekh Pass, which is an important link for pilgrims heading to Kailash Mansarovar. Nepal expressed dissatisfaction with the move and then published a political map with the addition of Kalapani, Lipulekh, and Limpiyadhura to Nepalese land, which was confirmed by Nepal's Parliament through constitutional changes.

Moreover, another point of disagreement is Susta, because, owing to constant river movement, the demarcation of boundaries has become difficult. Susta is among the examples used by India to illustrate the remaining undemarcated parts of the border. Moreover, both parties sometimes mention encroachments and occupation of "No Man's Land" in certain areas. Joint surveys and mappings are underway to resolve these problems.

By making the last statement, India once again reiterated that it will continue its policy of resolving all problems with Nepal only via direct negotiations and technical talks between the two parties. India is extremely sensitive to the problem of third-party involvement into this process, considering its stance on the matter throughout history.

Venezuela's

and related compliance concerns. Following the lifting of sanctions after Maduro's capture, India resumed imports from Venezuela, with

Indian oil companies increasing purchases in recent weeks as they seek alternative supply sources amid instability in West Asia.

Jaiswal described Venezuela as an important energy partner for India and noted that Indian public sector undertakings have made significant investments in the South American nation's energy sector. "India has been an important partner of Venezuela in the areas of energy and investment. Indian PSUs have made significant investment in Venezuela in the energy sector and they are keen to explore opportunities for further enhancing their presence," he said.

The visit is also expected to include discussions on issues affecting Indian investments in Venezuela. Asked whether more than USD 500 million in dividends owed to ONGC Videsh would be raised during the talks, Jaiswal said all important matters related to energy, trade and investment are likely to be discussed.

The two countries have longstanding cooperation in the energy sector. ONGC Videsh Limited and Corporacion Venezolana del Petroleo operate a joint venture, Petrolera Indovenezolana SA, for oil exploration and production in the San Cristobal field. ONGC Videsh holds a 40 per cent stake in the project.

Apart from official meetings, the Venezuelan delegation will visit facilities linked to India's energy, pharmaceutical and automobile sectors to better understand the country's industrial and technological capabilities and identify potential areas for partnership.

India and Venezuela share a history of friendly relations, with a major boost to bilateral ties coming during former Venezuelan president Hugo Chavez's state visit to India in 2005. Rodriguez herself has visited India several times, including as foreign minister in 2015 and as vice president in 2019, 2023, 2024 and 2025.

Her latest visit was initially planned to coincide with the International Big Cats Alliance Summit on June 1, but the event was later deferred. Officials in New Delhi expect the trip to further strengthen engagement between the two countries and open new avenues for cooperation across multiple sectors.

Shivakumar

likely to follow later.

Ahead of the ceremony, Shivakumar and outgoing Chief Minister Siddaramaiah held a series of meetings with Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge, senior leader Rahul Gandhi, Congress general secretary (organisation) K C Venugopal and AICC general secretary in-charge of Karnataka Randeep Singh Surjewala. Party sources said the leaders were working to give final shape to the new cabinet and were expected to hold further consultations before taking a final decision.

The cabinet formation has emerged as one of Shivakumar's first major politi-

cal challenges. Karnataka's council of ministers can have a maximum of 34 members, including the chief minister, while several former ministers and legislators are seeking positions in the government. According to party sources, the cabinet is expected to include a mix of experienced leaders and newcomers while balancing regional and social representation.

Speculation continues over the possibility of appointing multiple deputy chief ministers, including a Dalit leader. Former deputy chief minister G Parmeshwara and Priyank Kharge are among the names being discussed. Sources also indicated that leaders aligned with Shivakumar, Siddaramaiah and Kharge are lobbying for representation in the new ministry.

Siddaramaiah's son and MLC Yathindra is also among those hopeful of securing a cabinet berth. Meanwhile, discussions have continued over Siddaramaiah's future role within the party, with senior Congress leaders reportedly urging him to consider a Rajya Sabha position, though he has expressed a preference to remain active in Karnataka politics. The leadership is also considering a coordination committee headed by Siddaramaiah to strengthen links between the government and the party organisation.

The Delhi consultations are also expected to address the question of who will succeed Shivakumar as Karnataka Congress chief. Senior MLA and former minister Satish Jarkiholi is considered a leading contender, although his reported interest in both the organisational post and a cabinet berth has added to the calculations.

Back in Bengaluru, preparations for the oath-taking ceremony have intensified. Congress flags and banners featuring Sonia Gandhi, Rahul Gandhi, Shivakumar, Surjewala and Siddaramaiah have been displayed across the Vidhana Soudha and Lok Bhavan areas. LED screens have been installed at multiple locations to allow supporters to watch the proceedings.

Bengaluru Police Commissioner Seemant Kumar Singh said detailed security plans had been prepared after consultations with senior officers and protocol authorities. "Since it is an indoor event with limited seating capacity, entry will be restricted to invited guests only," he said.

Police have arranged special vehicle access for VIPs and dignitaries, while CCTV surveillance, AI-enabled cameras and the police command centre will be used to monitor security. Traffic restrictions will be in force from noon to 8 pm around Lok Bhavan, Race Course Road and adjoining areas, with commuters advised to use alternative routes.

A half-day holiday has also been declared for employees working at Vidhana Soudha, Vikasa Soudha and the multi-storied government office building in anticipation of heavy traffic and public gatherings around the ceremony

venue.

Seven killed

All the deceased were in the bus that caught fire," he said.

In Mumbai, state Transport Minister Pratap Sarnaik announced a financial assistance of Rs 10 lakh each to the families of those killed in the bus accident, dubbing it "extremely tragic and painful".

The MSRTC chairman also paid tributes to the passengers and MSRTC employees who lost their lives in the accident and conveyed condolences to their families, according to a statement.

"The heirs of the deceased will be provided assistance of Rs 10 lakh each," Sarnaik said.

He directed authorities to ensure free and the best possible medical treatment for the injured passengers.

Govt to replace WPI

During this transition period, both WPI and PPI will be released simultaneously before WPI is discontinued.

"Considering the wide usage of WPI in price escalation clauses, this index will be released for five years from the date of release of the revised series along with PPI and will be discontinued thereafter," the ministry said. According to Mahto, the five-year window will provide users sufficient time to shift to the new benchmark, after which PPI is expected to fully replace WPI.

The move aligns India with international practices followed by major economies such as the United States, China, Japan, Germany and France, as well as other G-20 countries, which use PPI to measure changes in prices received by domestic producers. The transition also follows recommendations from the International Monetary Fund.

Officials said the availability of both Output PPI and Input PPI would help track how changes in input costs affect prices of finished goods. While WPI, Output PPI and Services PPI will be compiled using basic prices that exclude taxes and trade and transport margins, Input PPI will be based on purchaser prices because industries buy inputs from the market.

The Services PPI will initially cover seven sectors: banking, securities transactions, insurance, management of pension funds, railways, air passenger transport and telecommunications. Mahto said the services basket would be expanded in future phases as more reliable data become available. Services PPI will be released on a quarterly basis.

DPIIT said monthly WPI and Output PPI data for May 2026, along with a back series from April 2023 to April 2026 covering 37 months, will be released on June 15. The Trial Input PPI for manufacturing will be published monthly on an experimental basis from March 2026 onward to assess data quality and gather stakeholder feedback. Services PPI data for the fourth quarter of 2025-26 will be

released along with a back series from the first quarter of 2023-24 to the third quarter of 2025-26.

The revised WPI basket has also undergone major changes. Dilip Kumar Sinha, Deputy Director General in the Office of the Economic Adviser, said the number of items included in the index has risen to 957 from 697. Renewable energy sources such as solar and wind power, along with nuclear electricity, have been added to the electricity group. Crude petroleum and natural gas have been shifted from primary articles to the fuel and power category to improve classification consistency.

WPI revisions are carried out periodically to reflect structural changes in the economy. Since its introduction in 1942 with 1939 as the base year, the index has undergone seven revisions, with the latest 2011-12 series launched in 2017. A working group headed by former NITI Aayog member Ramesh Chand was constituted in January 2025 to oversee the WPI revision and development of the PPI series.

The transition comes at a time when wholesale inflation remains under scrutiny. Wholesale price inflation rose to a 42-month high of 8.3 per cent in April, driven largely by higher energy costs linked to disruptions arising from the West Asia conflict.

Mahto also indicated that the Department of Expenditure would soon issue a circular advising users of government contracts to begin adopting PPI for future long-term agreements. "In a period of five years, we will be transitioning from WPI to PPI. So, henceforth in case they want to enter into a long-term contract then they should be using PPI rather than WPI," he said.

Monsoon expected

However, it got delayed and the department, on May 29, stated that the onset could happen in the following week.

Last week, the department in its revised forecast for the rainfall during the season said it would be below normal.

The IMD stated that India is expected to see 90 per cent of the long period average (LPA) this year.

LPA refers to the rainfall recorded over a particular region for a given interval, such as a month or a season, averaged over a long period of time, typically 30 to 50 years.

The LPA of seasonal rainfall over the country as a whole, based on data from 1971 to 2020, is 87 cm.

If the monsoon season sees less than 90 per cent of LPA rainfall, the IMD classifies it as "deficient". One reason for the below-normal rainfall could be the emergence of El-Nino conditions, which lead to less rain during monsoon in the country.

Currently, neutral El Nino-Southern Oscillation conditions are transitioning towards El-Nino conditions over the equatorial Pacific region.

The IMD said El-Nino conditions are likely to be weak in June, and moderate to strong in September.

APPEARS BEFORE PARLIAMENTARY PANEL

Student points out anomalies in CBSE tendering for OSM: Sources

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Top officials of the CBSE on Tuesday did not answer queries raised at a Parliamentary panel meeting on alleged irregularities in the vendor-tendering process for online marking in the Class-12 exams and instead, said it will submit a written response later, sources said.

Appearing before the Parliamentary Standing Committee on Education, Women, Children, Youth and Sports, the Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) officials presented a detailed response on a row over the On-Screen Marking (OSM) system due to which thousands of students faced problems caused by system glitches and anomalies.

The Ministry of School Education also submitted a one-page response on the system row over the online marking issue before the panel.

Highlights

» Top officials of the CBSE did not answer queries raised at a Parliamentary panel meeting

» Sarthak Sidhant, an 18-year-old student

affected by the CBSE's online marking system, made a presentation before panel on alleged irregularities

» Ministry of School Education also submitted a one-page response on the system row

Sarthak Sidhant, an 18-year-old student from Jharkhand affected by the CBSE's online marking system, made a presentation before the Parliamentary panel on alleged irregularities in the tendering process for vendor selection for online marking in the Class-12 exams.

Sidhant, who himself appeared in the exams, pointed out the anomalies in the tendering process of the CBSE to select vendors for online marking and put forth a set of questions for the board, the sources

said.

He also presented a seven-page copy of his findings before the Parliamentary panel chaired by Congress MP Digvijaya Singh, who heard him patiently and demanded answers from the CBSE officials.

Sidhant's presentation was made in the presence of CBSE Chairman Rahul Singh and Secretary, School Education, Sanjay Kumar, along with other officials of the Ministry of Education and the board.

Queries raised by the student on system anomalies and

the lack of background checks before handing over the contract for OSM led the panel chairman and some members to demand answers from the board officials.

While the officials answered some of the questions, they did not give replies to specific queries raised on why the contract was awarded to a firm without background checks and why the norms were changed arbitrarily at the last minute.

The CBSE officials said they would make a written submission on the issues raised.

The issue of going ahead with online marking without proper system checks or trial runs and without training teachers was also raised by members of the panel.

Besides, the chairman and some members also demanded that accountability be fixed and strict action taken against those responsible for the anomalies.

The CBSE officials informed

the panel that the board's system server, which was down, is now running fine and rectified. They told the panel that students can apply up to June 6 for revaluation in CBSE exams and there is nothing to panic, the sources said, adding that the board asserted that there is no need to extend this window as there is sufficient time to apply.

Some members also sought compensation for students in the form of grace marks or early evaluation, while also demanding fixing accountability and action against officials or the company, the sources said.

The CBSE separately handed over a report to the panel members, presenting their side on the problems faced by students, and assured the MPs that the glitches that appeared on its portal have since been rectified and students now have time till June 6 to apply for re-evaluation of their answersheets.

Nepalese delegation led by RSP chief calls on Amit Shah

Rabi Lamichhane also met S Jaishankar and BJP chief

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Union Home minister Amit Shah on Monday held talks with a Nepalese delegation led by Rabi Lamichhane, Chairman of the Rastriya Swatantra Party, in New Delhi.

According to the Home Minister's Office, Shah congratulated Lamichhane on his party's electoral success and conveyed India's best wishes for the success of the new government in Nepal.

Success in the recent elections drew recognition, as Shah extended congratulations to Lamichhane through a message from the Home minister's Office.

Wishes for smooth progress came from India, tied to hopes surrounding the formation of Nepal's incoming administration.

Focus turned to reinforcing the enduring bond linking India and Nepal. With mutual intent, the leaders confirmed dedication to growing



Union Home minister Amit Shah greets Nepalese delegation led by Rabi Lamichhane, Chairman, Rastriya Swatantra Party (RSP), in New Delhi

PTI

continued coordination. Shared intent shaped much of the exchange.

Amid ongoing dialogue, New Delhi and Kathmandu work to strengthen political, economic, cultural, along with human-level relations. Rooted in shared history, civilisation, geography, the two nations cooperate across trade, infrastructure, joint development efforts as well as regional safety matters.

Lamichhane also met External Affairs minister S Jaishankar here on Tuesday, as the two sides held discussions focused on the bilateral development partnership and enhancing people-to-people ties.

Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri was also present during the meeting.

Earlier in the day, the delegation of Nepal's ruling party, comprising its senior leaders met BJP national president Nitin Nabin and was accorded a grand welcome at the party headquarters on its arrival.

BJP GOVT IN ODISHA

Prez, PM Modi to attend second anniversary celebrations on June 20

OUR CORRESPONDENT

BHUBANESWAR: President Droupadi Murmu and Prime Minister Narendra Modi will attend the Odisha government's second anniversary celebrations at Rairangpur in Mayurbhanj district on June 20, according to a statement.

A grand public meeting will be organised in Rairangpur, the hometown of President Murmu, to mark the occasion, said the statement issued by the Chief Minister's Office on Tuesday.

Chairing a high-level review meeting for the high-profile event, CM Mohan Charan



PM Narendra Modi during a meeting with Odisha Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi

PTI

Majhi directed officials to ensure flawless arrangements, including security measures, public amenities, traffic management and adequate parking facilities.

"Since both the President and the Prime Minister are

attending the programme, special attention should be paid to ensure its smooth and successful conduct," the statement quoted the CM as saying.

The president and the PM are also expected to inaugurate and lay foundation stones for several important development projects in the state during the event, the statement said.

The meeting was attended by Chief Secretary Anu Garg, Development Commissioner DK Singh, Additional Chief Secretary (Home) Hemant Sharma and Additional Chief Secretary to the CM Shashwat Mishra, among other senior officials.

Kerala: SIT formed to probe attack on ED team

OUR CORRESPONDENT

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM: The Kerala Police have constituted a 30-member SIT to probe a case registered in connection with the attack on ED officials during a search operation at the residence of former Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan here.

The order constituting the SIT was issued by the Thiruvananthapuram City Police Commissioner on May 30.

The incident occurred on May 27, when an unlawful assembly allegedly interfered with Enforcement Directorate officials while they were carrying out their official duties.

Police said the decision to form the special team was taken considering "the gravity of the offence", the large num-

Closer Look

» The order constituting the SIT was issued by the Thiruvananthapuram City Police Commissioner on May 30

» The order stated that the SIT would function under the direct supervision of the Assistant Commissioner of Police, Cantonment Sub-Division

ber of accused persons involved and the need for a speedy and effective investigation.

The order stated that the SIT would function under the direct supervision of the Assistant Commissioner of Police, Cantonment Sub-Division.

Inspector Prasanth R, Station House Officer of Museum Police Station, has been appointed as the investigating officer in the case.

"The Supervisory Officer shall monitor the progress of

the investigation and ensure that all aspects of the case are thoroughly investigated," the order said.

It further directed that the progress of the investigation be reported to the Police Commissioner at regular intervals.

The crime has been registered under multiple provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) and Section 3(1) of the Prevention of Damage to Public Property (PDPP) Act.

Police officials said the

SIT would focus on identifying all those involved and completing the investigation at the earliest.

The case relates to an incident outside Vijayan's rented residence, where ED officials conducting a search operation were allegedly obstructed and attacked by a group of protesters.

Police have alleged that the gathering disrupted the officials' discharge of duty and their vehicles during the confrontation.

Investigating agencies allege that Vijayan's daughter, T Veena, and her firm, Exalogic Solutions, received money from CMRL, a sand-mining company, between 2017 and 2020 for IT and consultancy services that were allegedly never provided.

Biennial Rajya Sabha election in TN on June 18

OUR CORRESPONDENT

CHENNAI: The biennial election to the lone Rajya Sabha seat from Tamil Nadu, which fell vacant following the resignation of AIADMK member C Ve Shanmugam, will be held on June 18, Returning Officer P Thenmozhi said on Tuesday. Shanmugam, a former State minister who won from the Mailam Assembly constituency in the April 23 Assembly election, had resigned from the Rajya Sabha on May 7, necessitating the byelection to the Council of States from Tamil Nadu.

"The election is being held to fill a casual vacancy in the Council of States by the elected members of the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly," a release from the Secretariat said.

"Nomination papers may be submitted to Returning Officer and Additional Secretary of the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly Secretariat, P Thenmozhi, or to Assistant Returning Officer and Joint Secretary Pearline Roopkumar, between 11 am and 3 pm on any day, except Sunday, June 7, and not later than June 8, 2026," it added.

The nomination papers will be taken up for scrutiny on June 9 at 11 am.

If the election is contested following the withdrawal of candidature, if any, before 3 pm on June 11, polling will be held at the Secretariat on June 18 between 9 am and 4 pm, the release said.

SP begins candidate survey exercise for 2027 UP polls

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: The Samajwadi Party has begun an extensive exercise to identify potential candidates for the 2027 Uttar Pradesh Assembly elections, with party president Akhilesh Yadav personally monitoring the process.

Party sources said the strength of ticket aspirants is being assessed through a two-pronged mechanism. The first involves surveys conducted by a private agency, while the second relies on feedback from local party leaders and organisational networks.

The findings are expected to play a key role in ticket distribution, with the party seeking to prioritise winnability, public image and grassroots support over political recommendations.

According to sources, the survey exercise is being overseen by retired IAS officer Alok Ranjan. A dedicated team working under his supervision has been analysing potential candidates for all 403 Assembly constituencies in Uttar Pradesh. An office has been set up in Gomti Nagar, Lucknow, where a team comprising academic researchers, support staff and political analysts has been working on constituency-wise assessments.

The team has prepared a detailed report containing names of potential candidates and their electoral prospects. The report evaluates aspirants on several parameters, including their chances of winning, suitability within local caste equations, public acceptability, reputation and criminal record, if any.

It also examines whether a candidate has influence beyond his or her constituency and can impact neighbouring seats.

The findings will be presented before the party's core committee, which will take the final call on candidate selection.

Cong govt ensuring social justice, equal opportunity in T'gana: Rahul

Gandhi greeted the people on statehood day

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Telangana is the struggle and sacrifice of lakhs of people and the Congress government carries forward that legacy with social justice, equal opportunity, and the dignity of every person of the state, former party chief Rahul Gandhi said on Tuesday.

On Telangana formation day, Gandhi greeted the people of the state and paid his tributes to individuals who gave their life for the state's birth.

"Warm greetings to the people of Telangana on their Formation Day. Telangana is the struggle and sacri-

'Creation of Telangana stands as a defining moment in India's democratic journey'

fice of lakhs of people. Today we remember every individual who gave their life for the Telangana of their dreams," Gandhi said on X.

"The Congress government today carries forward that legacy with social justice, equal opportunity, and the dignity of every person of Telangana," he said.

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge extended his greetings to the people of Telangana, "a state born out of sacrifice, resilience, and the unwavering aspirations of millions".

He said the creation of Telangana stands as a defining moment in India's democratic journey.

"Under the leadership of Dr. Manmohan Singh and Smt. Sonia Gandhi, the Congress-led UPA government honoured the long-standing aspirations of the people and played a historic role in the formation of India's youngest state," Kharge said on X

Himachal BJP's Zila Parishad sweep: A strong political signal ahead of 2027 Assembly polls

The emphatic verdict has given the BJP significant political momentum in the state

ASHWANI SHARMA

SHIMLA: After establishing its dominance in the Urban Local Bodies (ULBs), the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) has decisively outperformed the ruling Congress in the Zila Parishad elections, securing a clear majority in nine of the state's 12 district councils.

The emphatic verdict has given the BJP significant political momentum and placed it firmly on the front foot ahead of the 2027 Assembly elections. The hill state, known for swapping power between the Congress and the BJP after every five years, has already taken the wind out of Congress's sails.

Overall, BJP-backed candidates have won around 143 Zila Parishad seats, Congress 56, and Independents 52. This is the all-time best performance of the party that lost power in 2022 because of the Congress guarantees, primarily the Old Pension Scheme and Rs 1,500 pm promised to women.

"The most significant polit-



BJP leaders and supporters celebrate as the party leads in the Mandi Municipal Corporations elections, in Mandi

PTI

ical takeaway is that BJP has performed strongly in the politically crucial districts of Mandi, Kangra, Hamirpur, Bilaspur, Solan, and Una, which together account for a substantial share of Himachal's electoral landscape. These districts are also considered bellwethers for future Assembly elections," admits Praveen Sharma, political analyst.

What adds spice to the BJP win is the fact that the party had declared its candidates, both for the four Municipal Corporations and Zila Parishads, while

the Congress committed a mistake by not naming its official candidates, which led to multiple choices and even rebellion. Says former Chief Minister Jaiaram Thakur, "The results indicate a clear shift in grassroots political mood before the 2027 Assembly elections. The Congress must start packing its bags and relieve the people of its misrule, anti-people policies, corruption and bad governance."

He admits that although Panchayati Raj elections were held on a non-party basis,

Key Points

» Overall, the BJP-backed candidates have won around 143 Zila Parishad seats, Congress 56, and Independents 52

» In Chief Minister's home district of Hamirpur, the BJP won 15 out of 19 seats. The Congress got just one

the results have unmistakable political implications. It is a vote against the Congress government led by Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu and a sign of the party's growing rural strength.

The scenario could make the Congress government really worry, as the BJP has won 25 out of 54 seats in Kangra, with Congress left to count its numbers at 11. In Chief Minister's home district of Hamirpur, the BJP won 15 out of 19 seats. The Congress got just one.

Mandi, the native district of

Jaiaram Thakur, the BJP completely trounced the ruling Congress, winning 25 of 36 seats. The Congress reconciled with just 4, less than the independents, who won 7 seats.

In Sirmaur, the home district of PCC president Vinay Kumar, the BJP won 11 of 17 seats, with the Congress winning a single seat, while five went to independents.

"The Congress defeat appears to be the result of multiple factors rather than a single issue, while the BJP's organisational machinery remained active and cohesive despite being out of power. The party successfully converted local dissatisfaction into electoral gains and effectively mobilised its cadre at the grassroots level," says Sanjeev Katwal, a senior BJP leader.

Secondly, anti-incumbency against the state government seems to have surfaced in rural areas, despite the fact that the Chief Minister had been talking about strengthening the rural economy.



Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath during the foundation stone laying ceremony of various projects, in Kushinagar district, Tuesday

PTI

"We reform the miscreants. Those who did not reform and did not listen to words ultimately responded to bullets," he said.

Drawing a contrast with previous governments, Aditya-

Nation Briefs

FIR AGAINST BJP MP, JLKM MLA FOR ROAD BLOCKADE

BOKARO: An FIR has been lodged against BJP's Dhanbad MP Dhullu Mahato and Dumri MLA and JLKM founder Jaiaram Mahato for allegedly abetting protesters in blocking a road while agitating against the murder of a Dalit woman at Bermo in Bokaro district, a police officer said on Tuesday. Sub Divisional Police Officer (SDPO) Bermo, Ravinder Kumar, told news agency the FIR was lodged at the Bermo police station on Monday night by the Sub Divisional Magistrate (SDM) Bermo, Mukesh Kumar Machua, against Mahato, Jharkhand Loktantrik Krantikari Morcha (JLKM) founder and 10 others for causing public inconvenience by blocking the Dumri Phuso road for 18 hours and preventing public servants from discharging their duties on Friday night.

SHAH TO BE ON 2-DAY TRIP PURA VISIT FROM JUNE 4: CHIEF MINISTER

AGARTALA: Tripura Chief Minister Manik Saha on Tuesday said Union Home minister Amit Shah would be on a two-day visit to the state from June 4, during which he would lay the foundation stone for a hotel and inspect the Bangladesh border. Shah will come here after attending the North Eastern Council (NEC)'s plenary session in Meghalaya's Shillong, he said. "Shah will arrive here on June 4. He will lay the foundation stone for the Taj Pushpabanta Palace hotel the next day," the chief minister told reporters.

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EDITORIAL

DAUGHTERS
BEYOND
MARRIAGE

The Supreme Court's ruling that married daughters cannot be excluded from compassionate appointments is far more than a service-related judgment. It is a powerful reaffirmation of constitutional equality and a long-overdue correction of a social prejudice that has survived in administrative rules for decades. By striking down the exclusion of married daughters from the definition of "family" for compassionate appointments, the court has challenged a deeply embedded assumption: that a daughter ceases to belong to her parental family once she is married. Such thinking may have been rooted in tradition, but it has no place in a constitutional democracy committed to equality and dignity.

Compassionate appointments and similar dependent quotas exist for a specific purpose. They are not instruments of inheritance, nor are they rewards passed down through family lineage. Their objective is to provide immediate financial support to a family that suddenly loses its breadwinner. The relevant questions, therefore, are simple: Was the applicant dependent on the deceased? Does the family face financial hardship? Can the applicant shoulder the responsibilities attached to the position? Marital status has little bearing on any of these considerations. Yet numerous government schemes and service rules across India have historically treated married daughters differently from sons. A married son continues to be recognised as part of the family irrespective of his circumstances, while a married daughter is often presumed to have transferred her loyalties, responsibilities and dependencies to another household. The Supreme Court has rightly identified this distinction for what it is—a gender stereotype masquerading as policy.

The court's observations reflect contemporary realities that policymakers have often failed to acknowledge. India's social and economic landscape has changed dramatically over the past few decades. Increasingly, daughters support ageing parents financially and emotionally. Many continue to reside with their parents after marriage, while others return to their parental homes due to personal, economic or social circumstances. In countless households, daughters are the primary caregivers to elderly parents. The assumption that marriage automatically severs these bonds is detached from lived experience. Equally important is the court's recognition that dependency is a matter of fact, not a matter of marital status. A married daughter may be dependent on her parents, just as an unmarried son may not be. Blanket exclusions ignore these complexities and replace evidence with prejudice.

The facts of the present case illustrate the absurdity of the discriminatory rule. The appellant continued to live in the same village after marriage, assisted her mother in operating the fair price shop, and later assumed responsibility for supporting her sisters, including a visually impaired sibling. None of these facts were disputed by the authorities. Her application was rejected solely because she was married. Such a decision not only denied her an opportunity but also undermined the very purpose of compassionate allocation, which is to support families facing hardship. The state's argument that married daughters may not satisfy local residence requirements was equally weak. As the court observed, constitutional adjudication cannot rest on sweeping assumptions disconnected from reality. Administrative convenience cannot justify discrimination.

The significance of this judgment extends beyond fair price shop dealerships or compassionate appointments. It is part of a broader constitutional journey towards dismantling outdated notions of gender roles. Over the years, courts have recognised daughters as equal coparceners in ancestral property, upheld their rights in inheritance, and expanded protections against discrimination. Yet many rules and regulations continue to carry remnants of an era when women were viewed primarily through the prism of marriage. The Supreme Court's ruling sends a clear message that governance must evolve with society. Public policy cannot be built on assumptions that daughters belong to one family before marriage and another afterwards. Family relationships are far more complex, and constitutional rights cannot be conditioned by archaic stereotypes. By placing dependency and need above marital status, the court has strengthened the promise of equality and reminded the state that justice lies not in tradition alone, but in recognising the realities of modern India.

COMMEMORATING
ICONS



ANIRBAN GANGULY

THE WRITER IS A MEMBER OF THE NATIONAL EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE (NEC), BJP, AND THE CHAIRMAN OF DR SYAMA PRASAD MOOKERJEE RESEARCH FOUNDATION

Bengal's greatest minds never saw Bengali pride and Indian nationalism as rival impulses; they saw one as enriching the other

BLUE
FUTURES



SHISHIR PRIYADARSHI

THE WRITER IS THE PRESIDENT OF CHINTAN RESEARCH FOUNDATION

The real divide may be between societies that govern water strategically — and societies that continue treating it as an infinite resource

At 150, Sarat Chandra Still Speaks

As India marks the 150th birth anniversary of Sarat Chandra Chattopadhyay, the timeless novelist continues to illuminate the hopes, struggles and moral dilemmas of ordinary people

2026 is an auspicious year for West Bengal and for Bengal's cultural, spiritual, educational legacy and her history of nationalism and for India. It marks several milestones connected with the life and contributions of such iconic personalities who, while being staunch Bengalis and proponents of Bengali culture, were also equally staunch and proud Indians and proponents of Indian nationalism and of Indian culture. They were spokespersons for Bengal's greatness and of India's greatness; they wrote describing the uniqueness of Bengali culture and of the greatness of Indian culture. They never made a distinction between Bengal's greatness and the rise of India. This consciousness and public perception and stance had gradually diluted and withered away from Bengal's public space and discourse in the last five decades.

This year marks the 150th year of Rishi Bankim's "Vande Mataram", and the historic change in West Bengal comes at an opportune time. Vande Mataram is now being sung without inhibition across the state, in schools, public functions and official occasions. It is being sung spontaneously by people with a sense of liberation.

2026 also marks the 200th birth anniversary of one of the greatest icons of nationalism, swadeshi and Atma nirbharta, Rishi Rajnarayan Bose. Rishi Rajnarayan Bose, was one of the tallest thought-leaders and reformers of his era, one of the brightest figures of the Bengal renaissance, a staunch nationalist, and among the earliest advocates of Swadeshi and self-reliance. He was a prolific author and towering thought-leader of his era and his book, "Hindu Dharma Shreshthata", became one of the most widely read and debated works of his time. Rajnarayan Bose was also Sri Aurobindo's grandfather, and that is why in later years he was also referred to, especially by Bipin Chandra Pal, as the "grandfather of Indian Nationalism."

Pal writes that it was under Rajnarayan Bose's inspiration that the Hindu Mela was started "a full quarter of a century before the Indian National Congress thought of an Indian Industrial Exhibition." Historian Nemai Sadhan Bose, in his classic "Indian Awakening and Bengal" writing of the Hindu Mela, observes that "a significant feature of the national movement in Bengal towards the end of the nineteenth century was the growth of what is known as the New Spirit. The spirit of self-help and the emphasis on the necessity of building up Indian industries, arts and crafts were first evident in the annual sessions of the 'Hindu Mela'.

This year also marks the 125th birth anniversary of Dr Syama Prasad Mookerjee. Among the most historic contributions that Dr Mookerjee made was the creation of West Bengal. As leader of Bengal and of



Sarat Chandra Chattopadhyay stands out as a reminder of literature's power to shape society, stir conscience and unite a nation

the Bengali Hindus, he prevented the entire Bengal from being included in Pakistan and fought for the creation of West Bengal. That there exists West Bengal today is because of Dr Mookerjee's farsighted leadership. For the first time since the creation of West Bengal, June 20, the day the Bengal Assembly had voted for the creation of West Bengal in 1947, will be officially observed this year as "West Bengal Foundation Day", signifying a long-awaited tribute to one of its greatest and most ardent proponents.

This year also marks the centenary of one of the greatest Bengali cine superstars, Uttam Kumar, often regarded as one of the greatest actors of Indian cinema, who dominated the Bengali film industry between the 1950s and 1970s. This year, thus, offers us ample scope both in Bengal and nationally to commemorate these personalities. This is especially true in West Bengal, since the state has seen a positive change. It is a change which believes in commemorating, disseminating and preserving the legacies of these Bengali icons and thought leaders.

For us, it is also significant that this year marks the 150th birth anniversary of one of the most iconic Bengali writers, Sarat Chandra Chattopadhyay. Very few Indians would there be, who would not have read Sarat Babu's novels in translations and would not have been moved by his stories or shed tears over them. If literature can unite, if language and emotions expressed in one language can connect minds and hearts across continents and countries, then Sarat Babu's works, after that of Gurudev Rabindranath Tagore, stand out as the most outstanding.

In his lifetime, Sarat Babu has achieved a status few novelists had achieved. Long after he has gone, his stories are still discussed, commented upon, written about and typecast into movies and plays.

On seeing Sarat Chandra's photograph, Sri Aurobindo remarked that he had a "large intelligence, an acute and accurate observation of men and things and a heart full of sympathy for sorrow and suffering. Too sensitive to be quite at ease with the world..."

Of Sarat Babu's writings, Gurudev Rabindranath Tagore wrote from his perch "Uttarayan", in Santiniketan, in March 1935, that Sarat Chandra "has guided Bengali novels nearer to the spirit of modern world literature" and that "he has imparted a new power to our language and in his stories has shed the light of a fresh vision upon the too familiar region of Bengal's heart revealing the living significance of the obscure trifles in people's personality. He has achieved the best reward of a novelist: he has completely won the hearts of the Bengali readers." Sarat Babu eventually won the heart of India too.

Later, a few months before Sarat Babu passed away, in January 1938, Gurudev Tagore offered a most moving tribute to him at a felicitation organised in Calcutta. He said that like the astrologer who dives into the deep skies and discovers various stars and constellations and their deeper configuration and effect, Sarat Chandra's eyes have plunged into the deep mysteries of the Bengali soul. His fascinating creations, describing the various dimensions of life, have enabled Bengalis to deeply know themselves. No other writer has been welcomed in the heart of Bengal as he has been...

Famous Bengali poet and singer Dilip Kumar Roy, son of the illustrious poet-composer Dwijendralal Roy, who composed the immortal ode, "Dhana Dhanye Pushpe Bhora, Amader ei Basundhara," translated Sarat Babu's famous novel "Nishkriti" (1917) in English in 1944, with Sri Aurobindo himself helping him with and revising the translation. The translation used Gurudev's

assessment of Sarat Chandra as a preface. It brought out a unique combination, in which Sarat Chandra's novel was translated, revised and introduced by three of Bengal's greatest sons, Gurudev Rabindranath Tagore, Sri Aurobindo and Dilip Kumar Roy. The translation was dedicated to the legendary teacher-statesman-philosopher Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan. Radhakrishnan, who taught at Calcutta University between 1921 and 1932, had absorbed and witnessed one of Bengal's finest ears to be by stalwarts such as Tagore, Sarat Babu, C.R.Das and Asutosh Mookerjee, among others.

In his assessment of Sarat Chandra, Dilip Kumar Roy movingly writes that Sarat Chandra's novels were "shot through with the life-throb and truth-throb that only intimate experience of suffering and squalor can inspire." None has known Sarat Chandra, writes Dilip Kumar Roy, "who has known him only as a spectator of life: he was intrinsically, a seeker after the hidden truths that life so often hurls past unheeding."

One can continue writing about many facets of Sarat Chandra's life and the way he immortalised himself in the Bengali cultural psyche. But let me end with one historic link. Sarat Chandra Chattopadhyay grew close with Asutosh Mookerjee's family. Young Syama Prasad Mookerjee, his elder brother, later Justice Rama Prasad Mookerjee, and their younger brother, the famous travelogue writer, Uma Prasad Mookerjee, developed a close bond with him, inspired by their common interest in and pursuit of Bengali literature and writing.

Around 1921-22, Syama Prasad and Uma Prasad launched a literary journal "Bangavani", which became widely popular. Leading litterateurs of the era contributed writings to the journal. Despite a lot of pressure and adversity, the Mookerjee brothers invited Sarat Babu to serialise his famous nationalist novel "Pather Dabi" in Bangavani. The series, which ran for three years, created a wave. Once completed, the Mookerjee brothers decided to publish it as a novel. Once published, in 1926, Pather Dabi's sparks, writes Uma Prasad, spread like leaping firecrackers across the country, lighting the dark night of bondage. Copies were sold out, and soon the British government banned the book. But by then, it generated waves and was being read by the ordinary reader as well as in revolutionary circles.

Sarat Chandra Chattopadhyay's 150th year offers us an opportunity to commemorate his profound contribution to our national life, to recall these important episodes that led us to freedom. Prime Minister Modi reminds us of "Vikaas" and "Viraasat", a true commemoration of Sarat Babu's legacy must be driven by that ideal.

Views expressed are personal

The Great Water Divide

As heat rises and populations grow, water security is emerging as one of the defining strategic advantages of the 21st century



The countries that solve water may gain the same strategic advantage that oil once conferred on nations

For decades, economists believed that the future of nations would be determined by capital, technology, trade integration, demographics, and military power. But a far more elemental force is beginning to shape the destiny of societies: water. Not merely access to water, but access to abundant, clean, reliable, high-quality water.

Many Afro-Asian developing economies are now entering what might be called a "triple water trap" — rising populations, intensifying heat, and weak water governance. Individually, each is manageable. Together, they risk becoming a structural brake on economic growth, state capacity, and social stability. And in a warming world, this divide may quietly become one of the defining civilisational fault lines of our age.

The Triple Water Trap

The first component of the trap is demographic pressure. Large parts of India, sub-Saharan Africa, and portions of the Middle East are urbanising and industrialising at extraordinary speed. Millions continue migrating toward cities every year. Yet water systems, reservoirs, drainage networks, sewage treatment, and groundwater regulation have failed to keep pace. The result is visible everywhere: collapsing aquifers, polluted rivers, tanker economies, erratic municipal supply, and growing inequality in access to clean water.

The second component is heat. Climate change is no longer an abstract environmental debate. Rising temperatures are directly affecting economic productivity. In large parts of India, Pakistan, and parts of Africa,

summer heat increasingly pushes human endurance and labour productivity toward dangerous limits. Outdoor work slows. Agricultural cycles become unstable. Construction, logistics, mining, and manufacturing all suffer simultaneously. Water scarcity magnifies every one of these pressures.

The third component is governance failure. Water stress alone is survivable. Water stress combined with institutional weakness becomes dangerous. Leakage, unregulated extraction, fragmented authority, polluted rivers, poor urban planning, and chronic underinvestment convert manageable stress into systemic crisis.

In many developing economies, water continues to be treated politically as an inexhaustible public entitlement

rather than as a strategic national asset. That illusion is becoming unsustainable.

Water - Europe's Civilisational Advantage

Across much of Europe, by contrast, water functions so efficiently that it is almost invisible. If one travels in Switzerland, where I have lived for over two decades, or through Austria, Norway, or much of Scandinavia, you can instinctively drink from the tap without hesitation. Rivers remain swimmable. Lakes remain pristine. Public trust in water systems is nearly absolute.

This is not merely about geography. It reflects generations of institutional discipline, ecological protection, engineering capability, and civic seriousness. And increasingly, it may translate into strategic economic advantage. Modern industry

is extraordinarily water-intensive. Semiconductor fabrication, pharmaceuticals, chemicals, food processing, advanced manufacturing, AI data centres, and green hydrogen ecosystems all require reliable access to vast quantities of high-quality water.

Investors are beginning to examine "water-adjusted risk" alongside labour costs and tax regimes. This creates an enormous advantage for water-secure societies.

Germany's industrial strength depends not merely on engineering excellence, but also on dependable river systems and sophisticated infrastructure. Netherlands transformed hydraulic vulnerability into a national engineering mission and became one of the world's agricultural powerhouses. Norway combines abundant freshwater with hydropower, giving it exceptional energy resilience. Water-rich societies are therefore not simply environmentally fortunate. They are becoming economically and strategically advantaged.

The Geography of Power in the Future

Freshwater may increasingly become to the 21st century what oil was to the 20th. Countries with secure aquifers, glaciers, rivers, desalination systems, and resilient infrastructure may possess hidden structural advantages in the decades ahead. Water security affects public health, industrial location, food systems, energy production, urban liveability, and political stability simultaneously. The implications for developing economies are profound.

Unsafe water imposes hidden but enormous costs on human capital. Children exposed to

contaminated water suffer long-term developmental and cognitive disadvantages. Heat stress reduces labour productivity. Water shortages increase inflation and agricultural distress. Scarcity fuels migration pressures and urban tensions.

A society perpetually firefighting tanker crises, droughts, and heatwaves inevitably struggles to sustain long-term strategic planning.

This is why water can no longer be treated as merely an environmental issue. It is becoming a core determinant of national competitiveness.

But Geography is not Destiny

Yet pessimism is neither necessary nor justified. Some of the world's most water-stressed societies have demonstrated extraordinary strategic foresight. Israel transformed scarcity through desalination and recycling. Singapore built one of the world's most sophisticated urban water systems despite severe natural limitations. United Arab Emirates invested massively in desalination infrastructure to sustain growth in an inhospitable climate.

The real divide, therefore, may not ultimately be between water-rich and water-poor nations. It may instead be between societies that govern water strategically — and societies that continue treating it as an infinite resource. That is the real warning for the developing world. Because in the coming decades, the defining divide between nations may not simply be between rich and poor, democratic, and authoritarian, or industrial and post-industrial. It may increasingly be between societies that solved water; and societies that did not.

Views expressed are personal

BHARAT
KI SOCH



ANIL RAJPUT
THE WRITER IS
CHAIRPERSON,
BHARAT KI SOCH

In our own times,
when institutions,
families and
leaders often
face choices
between
convenience
and principle,
Yudhishtir's
story remains
profoundly
relevant

Yudhishtir: The Epitome of Dharma

*Yudhishtir's life demonstrates that true leadership is forged not in victory,
but in the constant struggle to balance justice, duty, compassion and moral courage*

Yudhishtir stands among those rare epic personalities whose lives show that true strength does not arise merely from power or triumph, but from the ability to remain guided by principle amid uncertainty and adversity. His journey in the Mahabharat reveals a man constantly placed at the intersection of duty, truth, justice and human weakness. He was neither free from mistakes nor untouched by suffering, yet it was precisely through these trials that his character acquired depth. His life teaches that leadership is not only about commanding others but is equally about discipline, moral judgement and the willingness to uphold what is right even when the path is uncertain or personally costly.

Yudhishtir, the eldest son of King Pandu and Queen Kunti, grew up in the royal environment of Hastinapura under the guidance of revered teachers and elders, learning statecraft, warfare and ethical conduct. Yet his formative years unfolded amid rivalry, succession disputes and growing tensions within the Kuru dynasty. These circumstances shaped a life that was not merely about inheriting authority but about navigating the difficult balance between personal relationships, political responsibility and adherence to moral duty.

Yet his story also warns us that virtue, when not supported by discernment, can become vulnerable. The dice game remains one of the most painful and morally disturbing episodes of the Mahabharat. Yudhishtir entered a contest that gradually stripped him of wealth, kingdom and honour. He did not recognise that duty cannot demand submission to injustice, and that rigid adherence to rules can defeat the very purpose of righteousness. This episode teaches a difficult but necessary lesson. Goodness must not be passive and ethical conduct requires the courage to refuse what is wrong, even when wrong appears disguised as custom, protocol or social pressure.

The humiliation of Draupadi deepens this lesson further. It remains one of the gravest moments in the epic because it shows what happens when power loses morality and injustice is met with silence. Yudhishtir's anguish does not diminish the seriousness of that moment. For modern society, the lesson is clear. Virtue is incomplete if it does not protect dignity. Leadership cannot be measured only by



His story also warns us that virtue, when not supported by discernment, can become vulnerable

one's own honesty, but also by the ability to defend the honour, safety and rights of those who depend on one's judgement.

The years of exile reveal another side of Yudhishtir's character. Deprived of kingdom and comfort, he did not allow bitterness to overtake him nor allow hardship to compromise his moral compass. This phase of his life teaches the value of persistence and emotional discipline. Adversity often reveals whether a person's principles are genuine or merely convenient. Yudhishtir's conduct in exile shows that dignity need not depend on external position. A person may lose status, wealth and recognition, yet still preserve character. In an age where setbacks often lead to resentment, his conduct reminds us that circumstances should not be allowed to corrupt judgement.

The Yaksha Prashna episode stands among the finest expressions of his wisdom. When his brothers fall unconscious after drinking from the lake, Yudhishtir remains composed and answers the Yaksha's questions with humility and clarity. When

offered the choice to revive one brother, Yudhishtir chooses Nakula rather than Bhima or Arjuna, reasoning that since he, Kunti's son, is still alive, fairness demands that Madri should also have a surviving son. This decision captures the depth of his ethical vision. He does not choose to suit convenience or personal attachment but to ensure fairness. The lesson is profound. True justice is tested when one has the power to benefit oneself but chooses balance and fairness instead.

Yudhishtir's approach to war also reflects the burden of responsible leadership. He did not desire the destruction of the Kauravs. Repeated efforts were made to seek peace, and even a limited settlement was considered preferable to bloodshed. Yet when injustice persisted and every rightful claim was denied, he accepted the necessity of war. This reveals that responsibility is not always about choosing what is easy or pleasant, but often about bearing the consequences of difficult choices. The Mahabharat reminds us that there are

times when avoiding conflict at any cost can also become a form of surrender to adharma. Yudhishtir teaches that while leadership must exhaust the path of peace, it must not abandon justice merely to preserve outward calm.

At the same time, the war does not leave him morally untouched. The episode involving Dronacharya and the announcement concerning Ashwatthama shows the painful complexity of dharma in extreme circumstances. Yudhishtir, known for truthfulness, becomes part of a strategy where truth is spoken in a manner that conceals the full reality. The act may have served a military necessity, but it left a mark on his conscience and on his moral stature. This moment is important because it reminds us that even necessary choices can carry ethical costs. In leadership, one must never become so excessively attached to success that one stops examining the means used to achieve it.

After the war, Yudhishtir's conduct towards Dhritarashtra and Gandhari revealed the gentler strength of his character.

Though Dhritarashtra's sons had stood against the Pandavs and the war had caused immeasurable suffering, Yudhishtir did not allow victory to become bitterness. He continued to treat Dhritarashtra with affection, respect and care, while extending the same dignity to Gandhari. This showed that his sense of duty was not limited to those who stood with him, but extended equally to all who came under his responsibility. He showed that empathy does not erase accountability, but it can temper bitterness and prevent justice from becoming cruelty. The burden of leadership also includes caring for all stakeholders, including those who once stood on the opposite side. His conduct shows that reconciliation is stronger than conquest, and that forgiveness can free the victor from becoming a prisoner of resentment.

The final journey of Yudhishtir offers one of the most moving lessons in the Mahabharat. As the Pandavs proceed towards the Himalayas, one by one his companions fall. A dog continues to follow him, and when Yudhishtir is invited to ascend without the animal, he refuses to abandon a being that has shown loyalty. This act completes the moral arc of his life. After kingdoms, wars, debates and trials, dharma is revealed in a simple act of compassion. The episode reminds us that righteousness is not only found in grand declarations or public decisions. It is also found in how one treats the weak, the dependent and the voiceless when no worldly reward remains.

Yudhishtir's life, therefore, offers Bharat a deeply layered understanding of values. In our own times, when institutions, families and leaders often face choices between convenience and principle, Yudhishtir's story remains profoundly relevant. He reminds us that ethical life is not built by perfection, but by sincerity of conscience and the willingness to return to the right path after error. His journey asks every individual to examine whether power is being used with humility, whether silence is enabling injustice, whether success has been separated from morality, and whether duty is being carried with compassion. Yudhishtir endures in Bharat's moral memory because he shows that greatness does not lie in never being tested, but in preserving the discipline of dharma through every trial.

Views expressed are personal

CURIOUS
MINDS



DEBAPRIYA MUKHERJEE
THE WRITER IS
FORMER SENIOR
SCIENTIST,
CENTRAL
POLLUTION
CONTROL BOARD.

Marks have
become more
important than
curiosity, and
examination
patterns more
important than
imagination

Beyond The Marks Race

*The future of science education will not be decided by marksheets alone, but by classrooms
that teach children to observe, question, experiment and think independently*

Recent political discussions surrounding the condition of education in West Bengal, including concerns expressed by Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari, have once again drawn attention to a deeper crisis within the state's academic culture. Beneath debates over infrastructure, recruitment, and institutional reform lies a far more important question: are our schools genuinely producing scientifically minded students capable of competing with the best young minds in the world?

Since assuming office, the Chief Minister has repeatedly assured the people of West Bengal that the education system would undergo meaningful reform and intellectual renewal. Like many teachers and citizens, I welcomed these assurances with genuine hope. I believed Bengal's classrooms might gradually move away from mechanical learning toward a culture rooted in scientific curiosity, conceptual understanding, and independent reasoning.

Driven by this belief, I spent the last four years investing sincere effort, time, and even my own limited financial resources to introduce low-cost science and mathematics experiments for students. My intention was simple: to make learning practical, engaging, and intellectually alive. I attempted to show students that science is not merely a collection of formulas and textbook definitions, but a method of observing, questioning, and understanding the world around us.

Yet the experience has often been deeply discouraging. While students frequently respond enthusiastically to experimental learning, the larger educational environment remains overwhelmingly dominated by examination obsession and coaching dependency. For many students and guardians, education has increasingly become a race for marks rather than a pursuit of understanding. Creativity, curiosity, and conceptual clarity are often sacrificed in favour of coaching-centre routines designed solely to maximise examination scores. Under such conditions, even sincere classroom innovation struggles to survive.



Science education in many schools continues to remain trapped within a culture of memorisation

This reflects a much deeper crisis within Indian education itself. At a time when technological revolutions are transforming the world with astonishing speed, science education in many schools continues to remain trapped within a culture of memorisation. Students are trained to reproduce definitions, formulas, and prepared answers with mechanical precision, often without understanding the principles behind them. Marks become more important than curiosity, examination patterns more important than imagination, and coaching culture more influential than genuine learning. As a result, many students perform well in examinations while remaining intellectually dependent and scientifically insecure.

Such an approach fundamentally misunderstands the nature of science. Science was never built through passive memorisation. Human civilisation advanced because individuals questioned accepted beliefs, observed nature carefully, experimented fearlessly, and developed the courage to think independently. From Isaac Newton to Albert Einstein, from Jagadish Chandra Bose to C. V. Raman, great

scientific minds emerged not through rote learning, but through deep curiosity and intellectual courage.

Unfortunately, many students gradually lose this curiosity as they progress through the school system. Young children naturally ask questions about the world around them: why objects fall, how electricity works, why plants grow, or why the sky changes colour. Yet classrooms often suppress this instinct by rewarding silence and discouraging mistakes. The student who memorises fastest is praised, while the student who questions deeply may be treated as disruptive. Such an environment may produce obedient examinees, but it rarely produces innovative thinkers.

This reality is especially painful because extraordinary talent exists even in the most ordinary schools across India. Through interactions with many young students, I have repeatedly observed that intellectual potential is not limited by geography or economic background. A student from a rural classroom or small town may possess as much natural ability as a student from elite institutions. The real difference often lies in exposure, mentorship, and confidence. Unfortunately,

many students are psychologically conditioned to believe that global excellence belongs only to expensive private schools or foreign universities such as the University of Oxford or Massachusetts Institute of Technology. This belief itself becomes a form of educational inequality.

True science education does not necessarily require luxurious laboratories or expensive technology. Some of the most effective learning can emerge from simple observation and experimentation. A candle flame can teach combustion, a bicycle wheel can demonstrate rotational motion, and an ordinary kitchen utensil can become an instrument of scientific inquiry in the hands of a creative teacher. What matters most is not the cost of equipment, but the quality of intellectual engagement.

The role of teachers therefore becomes crucial. A transformative teacher does more than complete the syllabus. Such a teacher awakens wonder. Instead of demanding blind acceptance, the teacher encourages evidence-based thinking. Instead of discouraging mistakes, the teacher treats them as opportunities for deeper understanding. In such classrooms, students do not merely study science; they begin to think scientifically.

India's future scientific strength will not be determined solely by prestigious institutions or policy announcements. It will be shaped in thousands of ordinary classrooms where teachers either encourage curiosity or suppress it, where students either learn to think or merely learn to repeat. Educational reform therefore cannot remain confined to administrative changes alone. It requires a cultural transformation in the way society understands learning itself.

A great science classroom is ultimately not one where students memorise the most answers. It is one where they learn to observe carefully, question fearlessly, reason independently, and explore the universe with confidence. Only then can Indian students truly compete not merely with one another, but with the finest young minds anywhere in the world.

Views expressed are personal

WHO SAID WHAT



Rajdeep Sardesai
@sardesai Rajdeep

A 17-year-old @sidhant_sarthak who exposed the CBSE tender document process is likely to appear before a parliamentary panel today. More power to you, young Sarthak; you have done what we in the media should have done: shown truth to power! (Hope you aren't called 'anti-national' for your efforts!)



Ravish Kumar
@ravish_journo

In today's India, that's exactly the mistake you made. You shouldn't have raised your voice. A paper had leaked, so they would have just blamed Rahul Gandhi. The government would have rewarded you.

AT DISTRICT-LEVEL

Activate ‘contingency plans’ to tackle El Nino threat: Centre to states

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Union Agriculture ministry on Tuesday directed central and state agencies to activate district-level contingency plans immediately after the India Meteorological Department (IMD) forecast a below-normal southwest monsoon and the possible development of El Nino during the rainy season.

Agriculture minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan, who chaired a high-level meeting at Kishi Bhawan, said preparations should prioritise timely farmer advisories, availability of certified drought-tolerant and short-duration seeds, moisture conservation and scientific use of reservoir water.

He told officials the contingency plans must be implemented based on local conditions and should not remain ‘mere paperwork’.

Chouhan asked states to prepare clear strategies for re-sowing, life-saving irrigation and alternative crops if rainfall gaps of two to four weeks occur, an official statement said.

He said the government will strengthen digital and call-centre advisories to reach farmers quickly, monitor pest and disease risks linked to weather changes, and continuously review state preparedness, with central support deployed where response is weak.

Sowing of kharif crops has begun in some areas that received early rains. The IMD has forecast that monsoon will be around 90 per cent of the long-term average and has indicated El Nino conditions could develop later in the season. The IMD expects the southwest monsoon to arrive on June 4.

Officials said in the meeting



Workers work in a paddy field as paddy transplantation begins across the region, near Amritsar, Punjab, on Monday

HIGHLIGHTS

» Agriculture minister Chouhan said preparations should prioritise timely farmer advisories, availability of certified drought-tolerant seeds, moisture

conservation and scientific use of reservoir water

» He told officials the contingency plans must be implemented based on local conditions and should not remain ‘mere paperwork’

that national seed stocks exceed current requirements for both kharif and rabi seasons and that a national seed reserve has been created for emergencies.

Chouhan stressed the importance of certified, high-quality seeds and said short-duration varieties should be made available for resowing if needed.

The minister urged rural development agencies to act immediately to conserve soil moisture through farm ponds and local water-retention measures. He said where reservoir water is available, its use should be “scientific, balanced and priority-based” to protect as many crops and farmers as possible.

Chouhan instructed authorities to prepare district-specific advice on delayed sowing, alternative cropping and drought-tolerant options, and to set up advance monitoring and treat-

ment guidance for pests and diseases likely to increase with weather fluctuations.

He also urged farmers not panic and worry although weather forecasts are being taken very seriously.

He said the impact of potential challenges can be largely controlled through coordinated efforts by the central and state governments, improved water management, advanced technology, expansion of irrigation facilities, and climate-resilient agricultural practices.

He expressed confidence that through better water management, technological development, advanced agricultural practices, timely seed availability, alternative strategies and strong coordination, the impact of potential challenges will be minimised and the interests of farmers will be fully protected.

TRADE, INFRA TAKE CENTRE STAGE AT DELEGATION-LEVEL MEET

India, South Africa vow to strengthen ties

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: South Africa's Deputy President Shipokosa Paulus Mashatile and External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar on Tuesday held wide-ranging talks focusing on boosting bilateral ties in trade, investments, infrastructure and digital domain.

In the delegation-level meeting, the two sides also agreed that India and South Africa must work closely in international forums.

The South African deputy president also met Vice President C P Radhakrishnan and discussed various aspects of historical, cultural and people-to-people relations between the two nations.

Mashatile, accompanied by his wife Humile Mashatile and a high-powered delegation comprising five ministers and deputy ministers, is on a six-day visit to India from May



EAM S Jaishankar exchanges a handshake with South African Deputy President Shipokosa Paulus Mashatile in New Delhi

29 with an aim to promoting South Africa as a competitive investment destination and to enhance the bilateral trade relations. Following his talks with Jaishankar, Mashatile said both sides agreed that South Africa and India should broaden their ties, especially in the economic sectors.

“Pleased to meet with Deputy President Shipokosa Paulus Mashatile @PMashatile of

the Republic of South Africa along with his delegation in New Delhi today,” the external affairs minister said on ‘X’.

“Appreciate his strong commitment to deepening our longstanding partnership. Discussed opportunities in trade, investments, MSMEs, digital and infrastructure domains. Also agreed that India and South Africa must work closely in international forums,” he

PM SURYA GHAR AWARD

Solar push: Chhattisgarh bags national recognition

RAIPUR: Chhattisgarh has been selected for the PM Surya Ghar Excellence Award for its outstanding performance in the “Month of Solar” campaign conducted under the Centre's PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana, the state government said on Tuesday.

According to an official statement, Chhattisgarh secured the second position in the country in terms of vendor registrations among states with a medium consumer base, earning national recognition under the flagship rooftop solar scheme.

The state government described the achievement as a matter of pride and satisfaction, saying it reflected the collective efforts of vari-

ous agencies involved in promoting solar energy adoption across the state.

Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai congratulated the Energy department, Chhattisgarh State Renewable Energy Development Agency (CREDA), power distribution companies, officers, employees and partner institutions for their contribution to the success. “Under the visionary leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, we remain committed to building an energy self-reliant and green Chhattisgarh.”

The PM Surya Ghar scheme aims to promote rooftop solar installations across the country and reduce household electricity costs while advancing India's clean energy goals.

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann on Tuesday announced an increase in the cooperative loan limit for various crops for Kisan Credit Card holders in the state.

Addressing the media here, Mann said the state government has taken a decision to bring changes in the policy for Kisan Credit Card (KCC) holders to make it more pro-farmer.

He said the credit limit for the wheat crop has been hiked from Rs 24,300 per acre to Rs 30,000 per acre.

For the first time, a sum of Rs 2,000 per acre as a loan will be given for the management of crop residue, he said.

The loan limit of sugarcane crop has been increased from

said. Shortly after his meeting with the vice president, Mashatile said: “Together, our nations must continue to leverage on shared values to promote peace, equality, and fairness in global institutions.” The deputy president met a number of businessmen and key political figures including Rajya Sabha member Vikramjit Singh Sahney in the last few days.

Sahney, a former honorary Consul of South Africa to India, hosted a reception for Mashatile and his delegation last evening. The dinner-cum-interaction was attended by senior officials from the Ministry of External Affairs and the Ministry of Commerce, as well as the secretaries general of FICCI and CII.

During the interaction, Mashatile expressed South Africa's keen desire to conclude the India-SACU (Southern African Customs Union) Free Trade Agreement at earliest.

Punjab CM unveils ‘pro-farmer’ credit reforms, raises loan limits



Rs 44,000 per acre to Rs 1 lakh per acre, Mann said.

He further said new crops have been added under the KCC scheme, whereby loans

will be given to farmers as part of the state government's efforts to boost crop diversification in the state.

He informed that a sum of Rs 2,000 per acre will be given on poplar farming, Rs 13,000

per acre on bamboo, Rs 23,000 per acre on ‘jamun’, Rs 30,000 per acre on lemon grass, Rs 1.57 lakh per acre on garlic, Rs 92,686 per acre on Rabi onion crop and Rs 80,981 per acre on hybrid tomatoes.

On fruits, Mann said for dragon fruit, a Rs 47,000 per acre loan will be given.

He said in fisheries, the loan limit has been hiked from Rs 2.50 lakh to Rs 3 lakh per hectare, and the loan limit of Rs 4.50 lakh per hectare on white shrimps has been increased to Rs 5.50 lakh per hectare.

Mann further said the financial position of cooperative banks will also be improved.

In Punjab, cooperative banks offer loans at a 7 per cent interest rate, which is the lowest, he claimed.

Housing ‘fraud’: ED arrests EIL promoters

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: The Enforcement Directorate (ED) has arrested four promoters and directors of Earth Infrastructures Limited (EIL) in connection with an alleged homebuyer fraud and money laundering case involving more than Rs 2,004 crore collected from investors and homebuyers.

The arrested individuals — Avdhesh Kumar Goel, Rajnish Mittal, Atul Gupta and Vikas Gupta — were taken into custody on Monday under the provisions of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), 2002. They were produced before a Special PMLA Court in Delhi, which granted the ED five days’ custody for further interrogation.

According to the ED, the investigation stems from five FIRs registered by the Economic Offences Wing of Delhi Police against Earth Infrastructures Limited, its promoters, directors and associated entities. The probe is also based on a prosecution complaint filed by the Serious Fraud Investigation Office under Section 447 of the Companies Act, relating to alleged corporate fraud.

The agency alleged that the Earth Group collected around Rs 2,004 crore from more than 19,425 homebuyers and investors by promising timely delivery of residential and commercial units along with assured returns. However, several projects remained incomplete, and buyers neither received possession of the promised properties nor the assured benefits.

The ED said its investigation revealed that approximately Rs 467 crore was allegedly diverted through a network of related companies and entities. The diverted funds were purportedly used to acquire movable and immovable assets in the names of promoters, directors and other associates of the group. In April, the ED conducted searches at multiple premises linked to the Earth Group in Delhi-NCR and seized Rs 6.30 crore cash and jewellery valued at Rs 8.78 crore. The agency attached over 100 immovable properties worth more than Rs 100 crore.

Haryana CM orders overhaul of all cooperative sugar mills in state

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Tuesday directed officials to ensure that all cooperative sugar mills in the state become profitable within the next one year and ordered a comprehensive overhaul of their functioning.

Chairing a review meeting on the Cooperation department's five-year roadmap under Haryana Vision-2047, Saini said the financial health of cooperative sugar mills was closely linked to farmers’ welfare. He asked officials to identify why cooperative mills were incurring losses while private sugar mills in the state were operating profitably. The CM directed Principal Secretary (Cooperation) Pankaj Yadav to undertake a detailed review of the department's functioning and human

He asked officials to ensure that cooperative mills become profitable

resources and initiate reforms. He also ordered strict action against non-performing officers and employees posted in cooperative sugar mills.

Emphasising modernisation, Saini directed officials to regularly upgrade sugar mills, expedite the installation of ethanol plants and establish Compressed Biogas plants in all cooperative sugar mills by the next financial year. He noted that the state government had provided Rs 632 crore in financial assistance to sugar mills during the current year.

The chief minister also

called for a comprehensive plan to increase milk production, expand dairy cooperative societies and support women associated with Self-Help Groups by providing panchayat land on lease for dairy farming and fodder cultivation.

Reviewing cooperative institutions, Saini directed 100 per cent computerisation of Primary Agricultural Credit Societies, sought an increase in the Cooperative Agriculture and Rural Development Bank's loan disbursement target from Rs 130 crore to Rs 300 crore and instructed officials to bring at least 100 PACS into profit during the year. He also ordered a reduction in the interest rate on housing loans for EWS families under the Haryana Cooperative Housing Federation from 7 per cent to 4 per cent.

MPOST

CJI ADMINISTERS THE OATH OF OFFICE TO 5 NEW JUDGES

Apex Court strength touches ‘historic’ high

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant on Tuesday administered the oath of office to five new judges of the Supreme Court, taking the working strength of the apex court to 37 — the highest ever in its history and just one short of the newly enhanced sanctioned strength of 38 judges.

The swearing-in ceremony was held at the Supreme Court premises, where Justices Sheel Nagu, Shree Chandrashekhar, Sanjeev Sachdeva, Arun Palli and V. Mohana took oath as judges of the country's highest court. The appointments were cleared by the Centre on Monday, just four days after the Supreme Court Collegium recommended their names on May 27. The swift approval came amid an expansion of the court's sanctioned strength. Last month, the government promulgated an ordinance amending the law to increase the number of Supreme Court judges from 34 to 38, including the Chief Justice of India.

With the induction of the five judges, the apex court is now functioning with 37



CJI Surya Kant administers the oath of office to Justice Shree Chandrashekhar as a judge of the SC during a swearing-in ceremony, in New Delhi

judges. However, the strength is expected to reduce later this month as Justices Pankaj Mithal and J.K. Maheshwari are scheduled to retire on June 16 and June 28, respectively.

The appointments include four chief justices of high courts (HCs) and one distinguished senior advocate. Justice Sheel Nagu was serving as Chief Justice of the Punjab and Haryana HC, Justice Shree Chandrashekhar as Chief Justice of the Bombay HC, Justice Sanjeev Sachdeva as Chief Justice of the Madhya Pradesh HC, and Justice Arun Palli as Chief Justice of the Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh HC.

Justice V. Mohana's elevation is particularly significant as she becomes only the second woman in India to be directly elevated to the Supreme Court from the Bar, after Justice Indu Malhotra in 2018. With her appointment, the Supreme Court now has two serving women judges, the other being Justice B.V. Nagarathna, who is in line to become India's first woman Chief Justice in September 2027.

Justice Nagu, born on January 1, 1965, enrolled as an advocate in 1987 and was appointed an additional judge of the Madhya Pradesh High Court in 2011 before becoming a per-

KEY POINTS

» Justices Sheel Nagu, Shree Chandrashekhar, Sanjeev Sachdeva, Arun Palli and V. Mohana took oath as judges of the country's highest court

» Justice V Mohana becomes second woman elevated directly from Bar to SC

manent judge in 2013. He later served as acting chief justice of the Madhya Pradesh HC and took over as Chief Justice of the Punjab and Haryana HC in July 2024. He was also part of the SC-appointed in-house committee that investigated allegations relating to the discovery of burnt cash at the residence of former Delhi HC judge Yashwant Varma.

Justice Chandrashekhar, born on May 25, 1965, began his legal career after obtaining his law degree from Delhi University's Campus Law Centre. He joined the Jharkhand HC bench in 2013 and later served as its acting chief justice. After

a stint at the Rajasthan HC, he was elevated as Chief Justice of the Bombay HC in September 2025. He also served on the three-member panel constituted by Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla to examine grounds for the removal of Justice Varma.

Justice Sachdeva, born on December 26, 1964, graduated in law from Delhi University and was designated a senior advocate by the Delhi HC in 2011. Elevated to the Delhi HC bench in 2013, he was later transferred to the Madhya Pradesh HC and became its chief justice in July 2025.

Justice Arun Palli, born on September 18, 1964, completed his law degree from Panjab University and was designated a senior advocate in 2007. He became a judge of the Punjab and Haryana HC in 2013 and was appointed Chief Justice of the Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh HC in April 2025.

Justice V. Mohana, 59, graduated from Coimbatore Law College in 1988 and has practised law for nearly four decades. Designated a senior advocate by the SC in 2015, she enjoys a distinguished reputation at the Bar.

DISAPPEARED IN AMRITSAR

Aussie teacher goes ‘missing’; daughter seeks Pb CM's help

CHANDIGARH: The daughter of a Melbourne-based Indian-origin teacher, who disappeared in Amritsar last month, has turned to Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann for help. Punjab Police has zeroed in on the man's absconding brother, wanted in an NDPS case. The disappearance of 66-year-old Sunil Sharma, a mathematics teacher in Melbourne, has also attracted media attention in Australia, where his family has been desperately seeking answers after losing contact with him during a visit to India.

Sunil arrived in the country last month and travelled to Amritsar in connection with the sale and maintenance of a property he owned there. However, his family has not heard from him since May 22, and his phone has remained switched off. According to the Amritsar Rural Police, Sunny Sharma, Sunil Sharma's brother, is the prime suspect in the case. Sunny and his family have also gone missing.

Sunil also has a house in Mohali. In a video message, Sunil's daughter Surbhi Sharma appealed to the Punjab chief minister and the state government to deploy all available resources to locate her father.

“I seek help to bring back my father. My father has been missing since May 22 from Amritsar. We have no whereabouts about him yet. His phone is switched off,” she said. Describing her father as someone deeply attached to his roots, she said, “My father is a Punjabi and he loves Punjab. He loved Punjab so much that he invested his money to buy property there. I request Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann and the state government to send all available resources to find him. Please bring him home.”

Surbhi said her father had travelled to Amritsar to oversee paint work at the property. She also shared photographs of her uncle, Sunny, claiming he was seen around the property before her father's disappearance.

FIGHTING PRESENTS A MAJOR OBSTACLE TO THE PEACE DEAL

Israeli strikes kill 8 in Lebanon

This comes a day after Trump said Israel and Hezbollah to de-escalate

BEIRUT: Israeli drone strikes on southern Lebanon on Tuesday killed eight people, including a father and his son and daughter, a day after US President Donald Trump said Israel and Hezbollah agreed to dial back fighting.

Israel threatened on Monday to strike Beirut's southern suburbs, causing panic in the Lebanese capital as thousands fled to safer areas and Hezbollah fired rockets at northern Israel. Israeli forces recently made their deepest incursion into Lebanon in 26 years, but Beirut has been mostly spared over the past six weeks, apart from two targeted attacks on the city's southern suburbs in May. Trump later announced after a call with Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu and communicating with the Lebanese militant group through mediators that "there will be no Troops going to Beirut".

Lebanon's State-run National News Agency reported Tuesday that an Israeli drone strike hit a car on the road linking the southern town of Marjayoun with the city of Nabatiyeh, killing James Karam, a dentist from the nearby Christian town of Qlayaa, along with his daughter and son. The Lebanese army said two soldiers were lightly wounded when a separate drone targeted them on a road outside the city. A drone strike on the village of Jibchit



Rescuers work at the site of an Israeli airstrike that hit a building and damaged a hospital in Tyre

AP/PTI

Highlights

- » Israel threatened on Monday to strike Beirut's southern suburbs
- » A drone strike on the village of Jibchit killed two Syrians
- » Hezbollah has rejected direct talks, counting on pressure from Iran
- » Hezbollah's use of hard-to-detect fibre-optic drones has been deadly for the Israeli military

killed two Syrians who worked at a plant nursery, the agency reported, while another on the nearby village of Toul killed two people. A third strike hit a car near the village of Harouf, killing one person.

NNA also reported that an Israeli airstrike on Monday killed six in the southern village of Marwaniyeh. Hezbollah said Tuesday its fighters fired anti-tank missiles on Israeli troops who were pushing into

the southern village of Hada-tha, about 7 km from the Israeli border. Sirens sounded in several areas in northern Israel, the military said in a statement, adding that "a suspicious aerial target" was identified in the area in which Israeli soldiers are operating in southern Lebanon, and that no injuries were reported.

Despite a Washington-brokered ceasefire reached in April, the two sides have continued to exchange strikes after Israel targeted areas in Lebanon, saying it was for self-defence.

The latest exchanges came as a second round of talks between

Israel and Lebanon is scheduled for Tuesday and Wednesday in Washington, where Lebanese negotiators are set to seek a full ceasefire that will prevent future attacks.

The Israel-Lebanon talks that began in April in Washington were the first in more than three decades between the countries, which have no formal diplomatic relations.

The fighting presents a major obstacle to the emerging deal to extend the ceasefire in the Iran war that erupted after the United States and Israel struck the Islamic Kingdom on Feb 28. Tehran wants any agreement to include a complete ceasefire in Lebanon.

Hezbollah has rejected direct talks, counting on pressure from Iran. The latest round of fighting between Israel and Hezbollah has killed 3,433 people in Lebanon and displaced more than 1 million people. According to Netanyahu's office, at least 27 Israeli soldiers and a defense contractor have been killed in or near southern Lebanon.

Two civilians have also been killed in northern Israel. Israel's military said late Monday that a soldier was killed in southern Lebanon. It added that seven more soldiers were wounded in the incident, three of them severely. Hezbollah's use of hard-to-detect fibre-optic drones has been deadly for the Israeli military, which is struggling to respond.

AGENCIES



REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE

“IRAN HAS NOT COMMUNICATED AT ALL ON TUESDAY AFTER SAYING THAT A CEASEFIRE NEEDED TO BE ENFORCED IN LEBANON”

Social on Monday evening

amid reports that the conversation between the two leaders was "heated" and the US president telling Netanyahu that he would have been in prison but for his intervention.

"I had a conversation with Bibi Netanyahu today (Monday), asking him not to go into a major raid of Beirut, Lebanon. He turned his Troops around. Thank you Bibi," he said.

AGENCIES

Bahrain spy agency officer sentenced to life over in-custody death

DUBAI: A court in Bahrain on Tuesday sentenced a member of the Gulf kingdom's domestic spy agency to life in prison over the in-custody death of a man arrested during the Iran war.

Bahrain's state news agency said the ruling came after investigators concluded that the unidentified National Intelligence Service officer was responsible for the man's death. Prosecutors filed

charges in April including "assault resulting in death."

The public prosecutor's special investigative unit did not mention the man him by name, but the date of the death lines up with Mohamed al-Mousawi, a 32-year-old Shiite Muslim whose body was returned to his family bearing bruises, burns and cuts, witnesses who saw him at the morgue and his funeral said.

AGENCIES

Massive Russian attack kills 18 across Ukraine



Firefighters work on the site of a burning building after a Russian missile attack in Kyiv on Tuesday

AP/PTI

KYIV: Russia launched hundreds of drones and dozens of missiles against Kyiv and other Ukrainian cities overnight, killing at least 18 civilians and wounding 131 others, authorities said Tuesday.

Russian President Vladimir Putin has escalated Moscow's aerial campaign in recent weeks in an apparent bid to take advantage of Ukraine's shortage of U.S.-made air defense systems and persuade an increasingly pessimistic audience at home that Moscow is prevailing in the 4-year-old war.

Emergency rescue crews digging through the wreckage of apartment buildings pulled out the bodies of a 3-year-old child as well as those of a woman and her 8-year-old son in the central Ukrainian city of Dnipro, officials said.

The attack stretched past dawn, with explosions reverberating across cities.

The attack stretched past dawn, with explosions reverberating across cities

Officials said 12 people were killed in Dnipro and six in Kyiv.

Residents of the capital have been on edge for days after Russia warned last week that a massive aerial attack was coming and told foreign diplomats to leave. None appeared to heed the call and no embassies immediately reported damage Tuesday.

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy appealed for more U.S. and European support, describing the massive overnight attack as "an explicit statement by Russia: If Ukraine is not protected from ballistic missiles and other missile strikes, those strikes will continue."

AGENCIES

AMID PROTESTS

Kenyan Prez defends US Ebola quarantine centre

NAIROBI: Kenya's president on Monday defended the establishment of an Ebola quarantine facility by the US, a move that led to protests despite a court order blocking the plan.

President William Ruto on Monday night said the US had a long-standing partnership with Kenya on health matters and that the quarantine facility at Laikipia Air Base was one of 24 facilities that had been established in the event of an Ebola outbreak in the country.

Some Kenyans have opposed the Laikipia facility after the US last week said no American Ebola patient would be allowed to return home and that patients would instead be quarantined at the facility in Kenya. The US intends to commit \$13 million to the partnership with Kenya.

The case had been filed by the Law Society of Kenya and a constitutional watchdog, Katiba Institute, who cited Kenya's fragile health system as unable to handle foreign patients. Speaking for the first time on the matter, Ruto said he agreed to the establishment of the facility based on existing bilateral relations.

"When President Trump asked the government of Kenya to support them by having a center at Laikipia Air Base, I gave the OK because it was an agreement and a partnership with friends who have worked with Kenya for 30-40 years," he said. Ruto said the facilities established across the country under the partnership would also benefit Kenyans in the event of an Ebola outbreak.

AGENCIES

Would like to end sanctions waivers on Russian oil: Rubio

Rubio testifies before Cong for first time since Iran war

WASHINGTON: The United States on Tuesday said it would like to end the sanction waivers granted to countries purchasing Russian oil, contending that these measures were time-limited to ease global supplies in the wake of the Iran war.

Testifying before the Senate Foreign Policy Committee, US Secretary of State Marco Rubio said that the ultimate decision regarding the Russian waiver would be made by the Department of Treasury.

"We would like to end it as soon as we possibly can because the underlying policy of this country has been to sanction their oil. These are time-limited waivers for the purpose of opening up more global supply," Rubio told the Committee.



US Secretary of State Marco Rubio

The US granted a waiver from sanctions on the purchase of Russian oil in March and extended it twice. The last extension was granted on May 17 for one month.

Democrat ranking member Jeanne Shaheen sought to know from Rubio

whether he could make a commitment before the panel that the waiver will not be extended further when it expires on June 17. India is among the countries that have benefited from the waiver from US sanctions on the purchase of Russian oil.

AGENCIES

US to dismantle ocean observation system in North Atlantic, North Pacific: report

WASHINGTON: The US will start dismantling its deep ocean observation system in the North Atlantic and North Pacific oceans to monitor coastal environments, marine ecosystems and powerful ocean currents that affect global climate, according to a report.

The National Science Foundation (NSF) said it was sending ships this month to start removing over 900 deep

sea instruments anchored off Oregon, Washington state, Alaska, North Carolina and an area between Greenland and Iceland known as the Irminger Sea, the New York Times reported.

Scientists use the data generated by these instruments, part of the Ocean Observatories Initiative, to understand how oceans absorb greenhouse gases and how changes in sea

temperature such as marine heat waves might affect fisheries or signal bigger climate shifts.

The ocean observation system began operating in 2016 and was expected to continue for 25 years.

The station in the Irminger Sea has been key to understanding changes in the Atlantic Meridional Overturning Current, which some scientists

are concerned may be weakening due to climate warming. A collapse of the current could cause severe weather effects, the NYT reported.

The Irminger Sea moorings are fixed to the seafloor 9,200 feet below the surface and are part of an international collaboration among scientists studying the overturning current.

AGENCIES

Trump names housing finance director Pulte as intel chief

WASHINGTON: President Donald Trump has tapped Bill Pulte, head of the Federal Housing Finance Agency, to be the acting director of national intelligence — putting a real estate scion and fierce Trump loyalist in a key national security post as the U.S. remains at war with Iran.

Trump made the surprise announcement Tuesday on social media that Pulte would be replacing Tulsi Gabbard, the former Hawaii congresswoman who served as the director of national intelligence.

AGENCIES

Will uphold UNGA's work on human rights, says President-elect of 81st UNGA session

Rahman was sworn in as the Foreign Minister of Bangladesh in February

UNITED NATIONS:

Khalilur Rahman, the President-elect of the 81st session of the UN General Assembly, on Tuesday said he will uphold the world body's work on human rights and engage all member states during his tenure.

Rahman, the foreign minister of Bangladesh, emerged victorious in a closely contested election held in the UN General Assembly, garnering 99 votes against Cyprus' Special Envoy for Multilateralism Andreas Kakouris, who

His one-year tenure as head of the chief deliberative, policymaking and representative organ of the UN will commence

got 91 votes.

His one-year tenure as head of the chief deliberative, policymaking and representative organ of the United Nations will commence in September. "As your president, I will dedicate myself to rebuilding trust, nurturing consensus and opening space for good faith negotia-

tions that will lead to outcomes for all that are owned by all," Rahman said in his first remarks to the General Assembly after being elected. "I'll be President of all of you. I will engage all member states in the course of my work. I will not let my personal views interfere with my work as the PGA

(President of the General Assembly). I will seek common ground without ignoring differences," he added. In accordance with the established regional rotation, the President of the 81st session was to be elected from the Asia Pacific Group.

The PGA election was held a day before the 193-member will elect five new non-permanent members of the 15-nation Security Council for the 2027-28 term. Rahman was sworn in as the Foreign

Minister of Bangladesh in February.

He outlined six priorities for his PGA tenure - peace, security and justice; sustainable development and SDG acceleration; climate resilience and environmental sustainability; human rights, humanitarian action, refugees and migrants; digital governance, artificial intelligence, science and technology; and renewed multilateralism, UN80 reforms, and inclusive global governance.

AGENCIES

CHANGE OF NAME

1. Santosh Gupta W/o Late Shri Ram Pratap Gupta R/o Flat No 487, Pocket-2, Sector-19, Green View Apartments, DDA Flats, Amberthal, Dwarka, South West Delhi-110075 have changed my name from Santosh Kumar Gupta & Santosh Kumari to "SANTOSH GUPTA" for all future purposes. As per Affidavit sworn before Notary Public Delhi on 19.01.2026.

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

Replacement of MCI OHE CLA fittings with forged OHE CLA fitting in DDU Division

Open e-tender notice no. TRD/OT/05/MCI/CLA/26-27 E-tenders are invited from reputed contractors having proven experience, electrical license and sound financial standing supported by the valid documents for the work as per details given below.

SI.No. : 1. Name of work with location : Replacement of MCI OHE CLA fitting with forged OHE CLA fittings in DDU Division. 2. Approx. Cost of the work : Rs. 92,29,442.04. 3. Earnest Money/Bid Security to be deposited : Rs. 184600.00. 4. Last date and time for submission of tender : Upto 22/06/2026 at 15:00 hrs. 5. Website particulars from where the details of e-tender can be obtained : www.ireps.gov.in

Trs. Divnl. Elect. Engineer (TRD) East Central Railway/DDU PR/0341/DDU/ELECT/T/26-27/28

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE E-TENDER NOTICE NO.- SG-DSE-OT-12-26

S.N. : 1. Name of work with its location : Provision of MSDAC in parallel to DC track circuit at newly commissioned ANH & NGB station of DDU Division. 2. Approx. Cost of the work : ₹6,52,81,894.61/- (Six Crore Fifty Two Lakh Eighty One Thousand Eight Hundred Ninety Four and Paise Sixty One only). 3. Earnest Money : ₹13,05,600.00/- (Thirteen Lakh Five Thousand Six Hundred only.). 4. Closing date & time for submission of e-tendering : 22/06/2026 up to 12:30 Hrs. 5. Website particulars where complete details of tender can be seen etc. : www.ireps.gov.in

Divnl. Signal & Telecom Engineer East Central Railway, DDU PR/0334/DDU/S&T/T/26-27/24

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform to all concerned that Sh. Krishna Kumar Kaushik S/o Late Sh. Amar Singh Sharma R/o B-502, Sector-19, Noida, Distt. G.B. Nagar (U.P.) who is expired on 15/08/2024 & 50% Share holder of Flat No 29, Sanchar Vihar, Plot No. C-58/4, Sector-62, Noida (U.P.) with me & executed a will in my favour of i.e. Mrs. Manju Sharma W/o Late Sh. Krishna Kumar Kaushik R/o Flat No. 29, Sanchar Vihar, Sector-62, Noida, Distt. G.B. Nagar (U.P.) which is registered in the office of Sub Registrar Noida, Vide Book No. 3, Zild No. 1406, Page 345-354. SC No. 340 on dated 16/05/2023 so it is informed to all concerned that the said Flat No 29, Sanchar Vihar, Plot No. C-58/4, Sector-62, Noida (U.P.) is going to be transferred in my favour if any one has/have any objection he/she may file his/her objection alongwith the sufficient proof in the Residential Plot Department of the Noida Authority within 30 days from the date of publication of this notice.

Name of the transferee Mrs. Manju Sharma W/o Late Sh. Krishna Kumar Kaushik R/o Flat No. 29, Sanchar Vihar, Sector-62, Noida, Distt. G.B. Nagar (U.P.)

New Okhla Industrial Development Authority Administrative Building, Sector-6, Noida-201301 (U.P.) Website : www.noidaauthorityonline.in

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tender are invited from firms/contractors registered with UPLC Lucknow for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on Noida Authority's official website: www.noidaauthorityonline.in & https://etender.up.nic.in Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/ amendments & corrigendum etc.

(A) 1. 39/GM(E&M)/S.M./E/M- III/26-27, Providing Street lighting arrangement on Barat Ghar Road Village Sorkha, Noida. Cost Rs. 29.14 Lacs.

Which can be uploaded by date : - 16.06.2026 Upto 5.00 PM. pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date : - 17.06.2026 at 11.00 AM.

(B) 1. 10/GM(E&M)/S.M./E/M-III/26-27, M/O Authority Building (Annual Maintenance Contract (AMC) of Fire Alarm System at Main Administrative Building sector-6, Noida. Cost Rs. 11.79 Lacs.

2. 15/GM (E&M)/S.M./E/M- III/26-27, Providing Low Height Street light pole in Dr. B R Ambedkar Park Sector-37 Noida Cost Rs. 21.98 Lacs.

Which can be uploaded by date : - 09.06.2026 Upto 5.00 PM. pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date : - 10.06.2026 at 11.00 AM.

Office Sector - 5 General Manager (E&M) Noida

CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA

‘RBI likely to maintain status quo in June, hike rates twice in FY27’

‘RBI has policy space to wait to see 2nd round impact on inflation from the fuel price hike,’ said Gaura Sengupta, economist at IDFC First Bank

MUMBAI: The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) is likely to keep the benchmark repo rate unchanged in the June monetary policy review, according to a survey of economists and treasury heads.

Most of the respondents expect the central bank to resume policy tightening later in FY27 amid mounting inflation risks.

Of the respondents surveyed, 11 expect the Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) to maintain the status quo on rates in the upcoming policy to be announced on Friday, while four foresee a 0.25 per cent hike.

“Pause because headline inflation remains below the 4 per cent target. The RBI has policy space to wait to see the second round impact on inflation from the fuel price hike. Flexible inflation target provides policy space to look through the first round impact of supply side shocks,” said Gaura Sengupta, economist at IDFC First Bank.

The MPC will meet between June 3 and June 5 to decide on the policy rates. The central bank has reduced the repo rate by 1.25 per cent since last year to aid growth.

Economists attributed



The MPC will meet between June 3 and June 5 to decide on the policy rates. The central bank has reduced the repo rate by 1.25 per cent since last year to aid growth

the likelihood of a near-term pause to the RBI's preference to assess the impact of recent fuel price increases and geopolitical developments before taking further policy action.

Despite expectations of a pause in June, the majority of respondents see the policy rate moving higher over the course of FY27. Most participants expect at least two rate hikes during the fiscal year, while

Highlights

» Despite expectations of a pause in June, the majority of respondents see the policy rate moving higher over the course of FY27

» Most participants expect at least two rate hikes during FY27, while some anticipate more than two increases if inflationary pressures intensify. Only a handful expect a single rate hike

» Most respondents expect FY27 consumer price inflation estimates to be raised to around 4.9-5.5 per cent

some anticipate more than two increases if inflationary pressures intensify. Only a handful expect a single rate hike.

“We now think the MPC is likely to begin hiking from the June meeting, as domestic inflation risks are rising, alongside higher global yields; a few Asian central banks have already delivered surprise hikes. Our FY27 rate hike forecasts face upside risk of 0.25-0.50 per

cent if pressures on commodity prices, rupee sustain,” said Anubhuti Sahay, head, India economic research at Standard Chartered Bank, India.

The poll showed a broad consensus that the RBI is likely to revise its inflation projections upward in the upcoming policy review.

Most respondents expect FY27 consumer price inflation estimates to be raised to around 4.9-5.5 per cent, following the rise in global crude oil prices and the recent increase in domestic petrol and diesel prices.

Icra chief economist Aditi Nayar said inflation could rise to around 5 per cent in June as higher fuel prices begin feeding into consumer prices, although the extent of second-round effects remains uncertain.

Several respondents said the central bank may prefer to wait for greater clarity on whether the inflationary impact proves to be temporary or persistent.

Alongside higher inflation projections, many respondents expect the RBI to marginally lower its FY27 GDP growth forecast to reflect the risks posed by elevated energy prices and uncertainty stemming from geopolitical tensions in West Asia.

While the expected revision to growth projections is seen as modest, economists believe higher input costs and weaker global demand conditions could weigh on economic activity if crude oil prices remain elevated for a prolonged period.

On liquidity, most respondents do not expect any major measures in the June policy, though they said the RBI is likely to reiterate its commitment to maintaining adequate liquidity conditions in the banking system and ensuring money market rates remain aligned with the policy corridor.

Some respondents also expect the central bank to review administrative and regulatory measures related to the rupee and foreign exchange market, while maintaining its focus on orderly market conditions. Others believe no significant action may be required, given the expected boost to system liquidity from the RBI dividend transfer.

“We expect measures to support liquidity and to keep money market rates aligned to the corridor and review of admin and regulatory measures for the rupee,” said Sachchidanand Shukla, group chief economist at L&T.

AGENCIES

Markets rebound on strong rally in IT stocks, Sensex rises 382 pts

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: Snapping the four-day losing streak, benchmark BSE Sensex rebounded by 382 points on Tuesday following a strong rally in IT shares.

The 30-share BSE Sensex climbed 382.50 points, or 0.52 per cent, to settle at 74,649.84 with 20 of its constituents ending higher and 10 with losses. The barometer jumped 1,047.07 points to 74,862.19 from its intra-day low of 73,815.12.

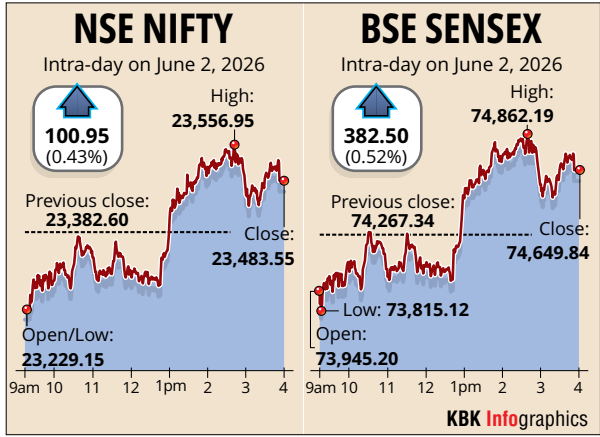
The 50-share NSE Nifty rose by 100.95 points, or 0.43 per cent, to end at 23,483.55.

Among 30 Sensex firms, Tata Consultancy Services jumped the most by 6.53 per cent. Infosys climbed 5.66 per cent, HCL Tech by 4.08 per cent and Tech Mahindra by 1.76 per cent. Adani Ports, Titan, Eternal, HDFC Bank and Mahindra & Mahindra were also among the gainers.

NTPC, Axis Bank, Power Grid and ICICI Bank were among the laggards.

“Markets recovered from initial losses, led by gains in the IT sector, while continued accumulation in large-cap stocks reflected comfort with valuations, as the Nifty-50 trades closer to its long-term averages than the relatively richer valuations in broader markets.

“Despite ongoing delays in a Middle East truce, global sentiment remained stable, highlighting resilience in risk appetite,” Vinod Nair, Head of Research, Geojit Investments



A total of 2,301 stocks advanced, 1,904 declined & 172 remained unchanged on the BSE

Limited, said.

Broader markets also advanced with the BSE Mid-Cap Select index rising by 0.33 per cent and SmallCap Select index by 0.19 per cent.

Among indices, IT surged the most by 4.40 per cent, followed by Focused IT (3.83 per cent), Consumer Durables (1.23 per cent), Services (1.11 per cent), Telecom (0.95 per cent), MidSmall Private Banks Quality Tilt (0.93 per cent), Consumer Discretionary (0.83 per cent), FMCG (0.72 per cent) and Auto (0.68 per cent).

Power, Utilities, Financial Services and Oil & Gas were

the laggards.

A total of 2,301 stocks advanced, while 1,904 declined and 172 remained unchanged on the BSE.

In Asian markets, South Korea's benchmark Kospi, Shanghai's SSE Composite index and Hong Kong's Hang Seng index ended higher, while Japan's Nikkei 225 index settled lower. Markets in Europe were trading higher.

US markets ended in positive territory on Monday.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, declined 1.28 per cent to \$93.76 per barrel.

Meanwhile, Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) offloaded equities worth Rs 3,911.68 crore on Monday, according to exchange data.

On Monday, the Sensex dropped 508.40 points, or 0.68 per cent, to settle at 74,267.34. Falling for the fourth consecutive day, the Nifty edged lower by 165.15 points, or 0.70 per cent, to end at 23,382.60.

TRAI's early assessment suggests new Airtel Priority plans do not violate net neutrality norms

NEW DELHI: Telecom regulator TRAI's early assessment indicates that recently-announced Priority Postpaid plans of Bharti Airtel that leverage 5G network slicing do not violate net neutrality norms, a person aware of the matter said.

The Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI) is, however, closely examining the issue to see whether 'slicing a chunk' to offer better service to certain postpaid customers deteriorates the quality of service offered to the remaining 5G subscribers.

The regulator, which is also seeking more information from Airtel, has asked the operator to furnish data and clarifications related to the quality of service. No specific deadline has been fixed for completing the detailed examination and continuous monitoring will take place.



For now, preliminary assessment has not shown any reason for immediate concern, the person said, adding that Bharti Airtel's Priority Postpaid plans do not violate net neutrality norms.

Airtel has conveyed to TRAI that the offering leverages 5G network slicing to deliver an enhanced service experience to postpaid customers without degrading the service of any other customer. Airtel has said the priority postpaid plan has been implemented in a content-

neutral manner.

Last month, Airtel launched 'Priority Postpaid' plans promising consistent speed even in crowded markets for postpaid customers. The plan sparked off debate on whether such offerings violate the rules of the net neutrality framework.

The telecom services provider promises that 5G Priority Postpaid will provide a "fast lane" to subscribers with the use of network slicing technology, even during peak traffic time, by dynamically separating a portion of the network for them from other categories of telecom services.

On May 26, a parliamentary committee sought answers from the Department of Telecommunications and the TRAI to review the impact of 5G network slicing services in Singapore, the UK and a few other

nations. The Parliamentary Standing Committee on Communications and Information Technology, headed by BJP leader Nishikant Dubey, noted that the priority postpaid plan of certain telecom operators could compromise the net neutrality of crores of prepaid mobile users.

Bharti Airtel has defended its new offering before the Parliamentary panel meeting, asserting that the service, powered by 5G network slicing, neither violates net neutrality norms nor degrades service quality for prepaid users.

On the other hand, Airtel rival Jio, in its submission, favoured the launching of a service only after due examination by the Department of Telecom and competent government authorities against net neutrality principles.

NEW DELHI: India's Unified Payments Interface (UPI) has been launched in Cambodia through the country's national QR code system, KHQR, marking the first phase of a cross-border digital payments partnership between the two nations.

Under the initiative, Indian travellers can use any UPI-enabled app to scan Bakong KHQR codes and make payments at over 4.5 million merchant outlets across Cambodia, including tourist destinations, restaurants and retail stores.

In the next phase, Cambodian visitors to India will be able to make payments at millions of UPI-enabled merchant locations using their domestic banking and payment applications.

The service has been introduced through a partnership between NPCI International



Payments Limited (NIPL) and Cambodia's ACLEDA Bank Plc. Ritesh Shukla, Managing Director and CEO of NIPL, said the collaboration strengthens real-time payment connectivity between the two countries and is expected to boost tourism and commercial engagement. ACLEDA Bank President and Group Managing Director Dr In Channy said the launch enables Indian travellers to make secure digital payments across the bank's extensive KHQR merchant network.

NIPL, a wholly owned subsidiary

of the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI), is responsible for expanding UPI and RuPay internationally. The organisation is also exploring similar payment linkages with countries such as Indonesia, Malaysia and Thailand.

UPI is currently accepted in Bhutan, France, Mauritius, Nepal, Qatar, Singapore, Sri Lanka and the United Arab Emirates. NPCI is also working to expand the platform to Japan, Maldives and Greece.

International UPI transactions crossed the one-million mark for the first time in FY26. Transaction volumes rose to 1.48 million (till December 2025) from 0.75 million in FY25, while transaction value increased to Rs 330.43 crore from Rs 258.53 crore. FY24 had recorded just 37,060 transactions worth Rs 19.7 crore.

AGENCIES

Gold rebounds to ₹1.61 lakh/10g, Silver rises to ₹2,71,000 per kilogram

NEW DELHI: Gold prices rebounded to Rs 1.61 lakh per 10 grams in the national capital on Tuesday after a weak US dollar and easing crude oil revived demand for the precious metals.

The price of 99.9 per cent purity climbed Rs 1,050 to Rs 1,61,450 per 10 grams (inclusive of all taxes), according to the All India Sarafa Association. It had closed at Rs 1,60,400 per 10 grams on Monday.

Silver prices also strengthened by Rs 1,300 to Rs



2,71,000 per kilogram (inclusive of all taxes) from the previous close of Rs 2,69,700 per kg.

In the international markets, spot gold gained 1 per cent to \$4,528.75 per ounce, while silver rose 2 per cent to \$76.29 per ounce on Tuesday.

Chouhan asks officials to issue timely farm advisories after monsoon review

NEW DELHI: Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan on Tuesday reviewed the progress of southwest monsoon and directed officials to provide timely farm advisories and maintain better coordination with states to tackle the potential impact of El Nino on kharif crops.

The government is on "alert mode", Chouhan said, asking officials to maintain constant check on monsoon status.

“Ensure better coordination with states and take prompt action,” Chouhan told officials in the meeting.

He also asked them to provide timely advisories and essential assistance to farmers, an official statement said.



Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan

Measures to safeguard farmers' interests and mitigate the impact on kharif crops were discussed in detail, it said.

Officials from all departments and agencies concerned were present in the meeting.

The southwest monsoon is expected to onset over Kerala

around June 4, the India Meteorological Department (IMD) said on Tuesday. Typically, rains arrive in Kerala around June 1, marking the beginning of the southwest monsoon season (June-September).

In its latest outlook, the IMD has forecast southwest monsoon to be about 90 per cent of normal, flagging a below-normal season and heightened crop-risk pressure, particularly if El Nino conditions strengthen later in the season.

The southwest monsoon, which contributes 70-75 per cent of India's annual rainfall, is critically important for kharif (summer) crops like paddy as 51 per cent of the net sown area is unirrigated and rain-fed.

CLOSER LOOK

» ‘Broader effect will reverberate across economy, pushing up both food & core inflation,’ rating agency Crisil said

» Direct impact of higher fuel prices on CPI inflation is estimated at around 36 bps for a Rs 7.5-per-litre hike

» Sectors such as clothing, consumer electronics, wood products and construction materials, including cement and ceramics could see stronger price pass-through

costs is expected to have the strongest impact on food categories that rely heavily on logistics networks, including dairy products, tea, coffee, fruits, pulses, spices, eggs, meat and

fish. Combined with a favourable base effect fading, this could accelerate food inflation in the coming quarters.

Crisil said core inflation could also face renewed pres-

sure as manufacturers contend with rising costs for crude oil, petroleum products and natural gas, alongside higher transportation expenses.

Sectors such as clothing, consumer electronics, wood products and construction materials, including cement and ceramics, are among the most transport-intensive and could see stronger price pass-through.

Manufacturers of chemicals, coal and metal-related products may also face higher input costs. With demand conditions remaining relatively sta-

ble, companies are increasingly likely to pass on these costs to consumers or resort to shrinkflation strategies to protect margins.

Some of the inflationary impact could be offset by goods and services tax (GST) reductions announced in September 2025, which lowered tax rates on several mass-consumption categories, including electronics, automobiles, clothing, processed foods and fast-moving consumer goods.

The tax cuts are expected to continue exerting downward pressure on prices over the

next year, though analysts say they are unlikely to fully neutralise the impact of elevated energy costs.

Crude oil prices have averaged about \$112 a barrel during the first two months of the current fiscal year, significantly above a base-case forecast of around \$95 a barrel for the full year.

While headline inflation remains below the Reserve Bank of India's 4 per cent target, Crisil expect it to trend higher, though still remain within the central bank's 2-6 per cent tolerance band.

PTI

Adani group cos post record \$16 bn capex, EBITDA of ₹94,834 cr in FY26

The investment programme — the largest annual capex undertaken by an Indian corporate group — lifted group’s gross asset base to \$82.8 bn

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Adani group companies reported a record capital expenditure of Rs 1.53 lakh crore (\$16.1 billion) and an all-time high EBITDA of Rs 94,834 crore (\$10 billion) in the 2025-26 fiscal year, underscoring an accelerating infrastructure expansion cycle while maintaining leverage below its stated target.

The investment programme — the largest annual capex undertaken by an Indian corporate group — lifted the portfolio’s gross asset base to Rs 7.85 lakh crore (\$82.8 billion), with nearly 80 per cent of spending directed towards energy, utilities, transport, and logistics, underscoring the groups continued focus on sectors linked to India’s infrastructure build-out.

Consolidated EBITDA rose 5.6 per cent year-on-year, according to the group’s annual results and credit compendium released on Tuesday.

The investment cycle comes as several large projects entered operations, including 5.1 GW of renewable energy capacity, battery energy storage systems, Navi Mumbai International Airport, the Guwahati terminal, and the Ganga Expressway, and a cop-



Nearly 80% of spending was directed towards energy, utilities, transport, and logistics businesses

per smelter.

The ports-to-energy conglomerate said these assets are expected to contribute more meaningfully to earnings and cash flows FY27 onwards.

Core infrastructure businesses generated Rs 82,083 crore of EBITDA during FY26, accounting for 87 per cent of portfolio earnings. The transport segment, led by Adani Ports, recorded the strongest growth, with EBITDA rising 23.2 per cent to Rs 25,228 crore.

Utility businesses reported EBITDA growth of 4.6 per cent to Rs 45,377 crore.

Despite the sharp increase

Key Points

- » Adani Enterprises raised Rs 24,930 crore through a rights issue during the fiscal year under review
- » Adani Power is targeting a capacity of 42 GW by FY32, with 23.7 GW already locked-in vs current 18.2 GW
- » Adani Ports & SEZ Ltd handled 11 per cent more cargo at 500.8 million tonnes

in capital spending, the group maintained net debt-to-EBITDA at 3.3 times, below its stated ceiling of 3.5 times. Cash and cash equivalents stood at Rs 55,852 crore at the end of March, equivalent to 15 per cent of gross debt.

Sufficient liquidity is maintained across portfolio companies to cover debt servicing requirements for at least the next 17 months.

The group’s average borrowing cost declined to 7.8 per cent in FY26 from 9 per cent two years earlier, supported by rating upgrades across operating companies. Adani said all of its

assets now carry domestic credit ratings of A- or higher.

Among key businesses, Adani Green Energy expanded operational renewable capacity by 5.1 GW to 19.3 GW, while Adani Ports handled a record 500.8 million metric tonnes of cargo, up 11 per cent from a year earlier.

Adani Energy Solutions reported an under-construction transmission pipeline worth Rs 71,779 crore and crossed 10 million smart meter installations.

Adani Enterprises, the group’s incubator business, raised Rs 24,930 crore through a rights issue during the fiscal year under review, while its airports portfolio handled 95.3 million passengers across eight airports.

“The scale of capital deployment during the year is comparable to the asset base we had built over our first 25 years, reflecting both the infrastructure opportunity before India and the group’s confidence in its long-term growth trajectory,” according to the group’s compendium.

Giving operational details, it said renewable energy arm, Adani Green Energy Ltd saw operational capacity expand by 5.1 GW to 19.3 GW. It had

BESS capacity of 1.38 GWh at the end of FY26, now scaled to 3.37 GWh at Khavda in Gujarat -- one of the largest single-location deployments.

Electricity transmission company Adani Energy Solutions Ltd had under-construction transmission pipeline of Rs 71,779 crore and crossed 1 crore smart meters installation. It has an order book at 2.5 crore as against national opportunity of 10.3 crore.

Adani Power is targeting a capacity of 42 GW by FY32, with 23.7 GW already locked-in vs current 18.2 GW.

Adani Ports & SEZ Ltd handled 11 per cent more cargo at 500.8 million tonnes. It completed acquisition of NQXT Australia (50 million tonnes capacity) in December 2025.

Ambuja Cements completed acquisition of Orient Cement, strengthening market position. Cement sales volumes rose 16.1 per cent to 73.7 million tonnes in FY26.

Headquartered in Ahmedabad, the Adani Portfolio is the country’s largest and fastest-growing platform of diversified infrastructure businesses, spanning energy and utilities, transport and logistics, metals and materials, & consumer sectors.

India, US begin 3-day talks to finalise details of trade pact

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The chief negotiators of India and the US on Tuesday began a three-day round of talks here to finalise the details of the proposed interim trade agreement, an official said.

The framework for the pact was finalised in February.

The US team is led by its chief negotiator Brendan Lynch. India’s chief negotiator is Darpan Jain, who is an additional secretary in the Department of Commerce.

The talks are underway at Vanijya Bhavan here, the headquarters of the Commerce and Industry Ministry.

The two sides are looking to finalise the details of the interim trade agreement and take forward the negotiations for the broader bilateral trade agreement (BTA).

On February 7, India and the US issued a joint statement finalising the contours or framework of the first phase of the BTA or an interim trade deal.

According to the framework, the US had agreed to reduce tariffs on India to 18 per cent from 50 per cent.

It had removed the 25 per cent tariffs on Indian goods for buying Russian oil and was to cut the remaining 25 per cent to 18 per cent under the pact.

But, on February 20 this year, the US Supreme Court ruled against President Donald Trump’s sweeping recipro-



cal tariffs, which were imposed under the 1977 International Emergency Economic Powers Act (IEEPA).

After that, the US President announced the imposition of 10 per cent tariffs on all countries for 150 days, starting February 24.

In light of these changes, the two sides met in Washington in April, when the Indian team, headed by Jain, visited America from April 20-23, 2026.

To carry forward those discussions, the US team is here for the talks, the official said.

As the tariff landscape has changed in the US, both sides may wish to revisit the agreement’s framework.

Under the agreed framework, India proposed to eliminate or reduce tariffs on all US industrial goods and a wide range of food and agricultural products, including dried distillers’ grains (DDGs), red sorghum for animal feed, tree nuts, fresh and processed fruit, soybean oil, wine and spirits, and additional products.

New Delhi has also expressed its intentions to pur-

chase \$500 billion of US energy products, aircraft and aircraft parts, precious metals, technology products, and coking coal over the next five years.

When the framework was agreed, India had a comparative advantage over its competitor countries, such as Sri Lanka, Pakistan and Bangladesh.

Now, with all US trading partners facing a uniform 10 per cent tariff, the pact requires recalibration.

Sources have said that it is important that India gets an advantage over its competitor nations on the tariff front in the trade pact.

As the US Supreme Court has ruled against President Donald Trump’s sweeping tariffs, the US administration now has the option of using the Section 301 investigation mechanism to impose new tariffs.

In March, the US Trade Representative (USTR) launched two unilateral Section 301 investigations against a number of countries, including India, over excess capacity and failures to eradicate forced labour in global supply chains.

The US was the second-largest trading partner of India in 2025-26.

India’s outbound shipments to the US grew marginally 0.92 per cent to \$87.3 billion during the last fiscal year, while imports increased 15.95 per cent to \$52.9 billion.

The trade surplus declined to \$34.4 billion in 2025-26 from \$40.89 billion in 2024-25.

RBI to hold ₹50,000 cr 2-day VRR auction on June 3



MUMBAI: The RBI on Tuesday said it will conduct a two-day variable rate repo (VRR) auction of Rs 50,000 crore on June 3. The auction will take place between 9:30 am and 10 am, and the reversal of these funds will take place on June 5.

“On a review of current and evolving liquidity conditions, it has been decided to conduct a VRR auction on Wednesday, June 03, 2026,” the RBI said in a release.

Currently, liquidity in the banking system is estimated to be in surplus of around Rs 85,411.44 crore as of June 1, which has narrowed from a surplus of Rs 1.40 lakh crore on May 31.

VRR auction conducted by the RBI on Tuesday saw weak demand from banks despite lower surplus liquidity in the banking system.

The RBI received Rs 17,445 crore bids at the three-day VRR auction, against the notified amount of Rs 75,000 crore. The apex bank accepted the entire bids and injected Rs 17,445 crore of transient liquidity into the banking system at a cut-off and weighted average rate of 5.26 per cent, according to the RBI’s release.

Coca-Cola explores India bottling unit HCCH IPO in 2027, divest stake

NEW DELHI: Global beverages major the Coca-Cola Company is exploring the listing of Hindustan Coca-Cola Holdings Pvt Ltd (HCCH), the parent entity of its Indian bottling arm HCCH, in 2027 on BSE and NSE, a statement said.

Besides, it is considering selling a part of stake in HCCH. “Initial preparations are underway for a potential listing on the Bombay Stock Exchange and National Stock Exchange of India, subject to market conditions and applicable regulatory and other approvals,” the statement by US-headquartered beverages major said.

The development comes almost a year after Coca-Cola sold its 40 per cent stake in HCCH to Jubilant Bhartia Group. However, Coca-Cola is yet to reveal the financial details of the transaction.

The Coca-Cola Company

in its global statement, said: “It is exploring a potential public listing in India of HCCH, the parent company of the largest Coca-Cola bottler in India, Hindustan Coca-Cola Beverages Pvt Ltd (HCCB), in 2027, and the sale of a portion of its shareholding in HCCH in connection with the listing.”

This potential listing of HCCH will be a significant milestone, completing the refranchising of HCCH and positioning it well to capitalise on the opportunities in the Indian market.

The Coca-Cola Company as its asset-light strategy, is divesting its bottling assets globally.

India is the fifth-largest market for Coca-Cola globally.

In 2024, The Coca-Cola Company had franchised its bottling operations to its existing bottlers in three key markets - Rajasthan, Bihar, Northeast,

and parts of West Bengal. The company had realised \$290 million (around Rs 2,420 crore) by refranchising its bottling operations.

The three bottlers who got the franchisee were Kandhari Global Beverages, SLMG Beverages and Moon Beverages.

Coca-Cola operates in the Indian market with two entities - Coca-Cola India and HCCB. HCCB, which was incorporated on February 14, 1997, operates 14 bottling plants across India.

Headquartered in Bengaluru, HCCB operations are spread in 10 states and 236 districts in South and West India.

It manufactures and sells 37 different products across 8 categories, including Coca-Cola, Thums Up, Sprite, Minute Maid, Maaza, SmartWater, Kinley, Limca, Fanta, among others.

Oyo secures Sebi’s nod to launch ₹6,650 cr IPO

NEW DELHI: Global travel tech unicorn Oyo’s parent firm Prism has secured clearance from markets regulator Sebi to raise Rs 6,650 crore through its initial public offering (IPO), people familiar with the development said on Tuesday.

The proposed public offering is expected to value the company at \$7-8 billion, they added. Oyo’s parent entity Prism filed the preliminary IPO papers with Sebi in December 2025 through the confidential route.

The filing followed shareholders’ approval at an Extraordinary General Meeting (EGM) held on December 20, 2025, where the company received consent to raise up to Rs 6,650 crore through a fresh issue of equity shares.

Prism opted for the con-



fidential pre-filing route, which allows the company to engage with the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi) for initial feedback on its draft document without it being publicly disclosed.

As the next step, the company is expected to file a public Updated Draft Red Herring Prospectus (UDRHP-1) in early July, which will be open for public comments for 21 days, people familiar with the development said. They said that Prism is

currently evaluating market conditions and broader listing timelines while preparing to file its UDRHP-1.

The development comes as Prism continues to strengthen its presence across its key markets -- India, the US, and Europe -- and increases its focus on self-operated hotels and the growth of premium brands such as Sunday Hotels & Palette Hotels. Also, it recently entered the vacation homes segment in India with its European brand DanCenter by opening villas for rent in Goa.

In India, Prism has also increased its presence in religious destinations to capitalize on the growth in spiritual travel. The company has appointed Axis Capital, Citibank, Goldman Sachs, ICICI Securities,

NEW DELHI: India and the UK on Tuesday discussed the “sticking points” that are delaying the implementation of the Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA) between the two countries. The pact was signed in July last year.

The issues came up for discussion during the meeting between Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agarwal and UK Permanent Secretary Amanda Brooks.

“Engaged in extensive discussions with UK Permanent Secretary Ms. Amanda Brooks on #IndiaUKCETA implementation.

“Took stock of progress and worked through the sticking points, while exploring new pathways under #IndiaUKCETA #GlobalTrade #EconomicPartnership aligned with #ViksitBharat. Reaffirmed commitment to regular engagement with @UKGovScotland @TradeGov for effective implementation,” Agarwal said in a social



media post.

Britain’s steel safeguard measure and carbon border adjustment mechanism (CBAM) are delaying the implementation of the pact. According to government sources, India may rebalance some duty concessions on certain British products like Scotch Whiskey under the agreement with the UK if these issues are not addressed.

From July 1, 2026, the UK will limit tariff-free steel imports, reducing overall quota volumes by 60 per cent compared to the steel safeguard measure. Any imports above these levels will then face a 50 per cent tariff.

ED initiates foreign exchange ‘violation’ probe against Vedanta

NEW DELHI: The Enforcement Directorate has initiated a foreign exchange “violation” investigation against billionaire Anil Agarwal’s Vedanta Group and conducted searches at its official premises, officials said on Tuesday.

The raids were launched against the global mining conglomerate on Monday and four premises of Vedanta Ltd, including those located in Delhi, Mumbai and Udaipur in Rajasthan, were surveyed, officials said.

The investigation is being conducted under the civil provisions of the Foreign Exchange Management Act (FEMA).

An instance of Vedanta



Resources, the London-based parent of Indian company Vedanta Ltd., refunding a part of the brand fee to the latter (Vedanta Ltd.) in 2023 is under the scanner of the federal probe agency, the officials said.

The ongoing probe is also looking at some other structures of the group, the officials said.

A Vedanta spokesperson confirmed the ED action, saying the company was “extending

full cooperation to the authorities and are providing all information sought.”

“The company remains committed to compliance with all applicable laws and regulations. As the matter is currently under regulatory process, we are unable to comment further at this stage,” the spokesperson said.

The board of the company recently approved a demerger of Vedanta companies which are planned for listing as four entities: Vedanta Aluminium Metal Limited (VAML), Talwandi Sabo Power Ltd (TSPL), Malco Energy Ltd (MEL), and Vedanta Iron and Steel Limited (VISL).

Govt mandates DGFT nod for silver imports via nominated agencies

NEW DELHI: The government on Tuesday mandated that imports of silver through RBI-nominated agencies, DGFT-approved entities and qualified jewellers through the India International Bullion Exchange will be allowed only against a valid import authorisation.

The move has further tightened import norms for silver.

The import authorisation will be issued by the Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT).

Last month, the government hiked import duty on gold and silver to 15 per cent to curb non-essential imports amid the West Asia crisis, which has put pres-



sure on forex reserves.

Import of silver (including silver plated with gold or platinum), unwrought or in semi manufactured forms, or in powder form, powder, grains, and containing 99.9 per cent or more by weight of silver, “through nominated agencies notified by the RBI, in the case of banks, by the

DGFT, in case of other agencies, any by qualified jewellers as notified by the IFSCA for import through India International Bullion Exchange (IIBX), wherever allowed, shall be permitted only against a valid import authorisation issued by the DGFT,” a notification of the directorate said.

Silver imports in April jumped 157 per cent year on year to \$411 million. It was up about 150 per cent at \$12 billion in 2025-26.

India mainly imports from the UAE, the UK, and China. The precious metal is used in both jewellery manufacturing and industrial applications.

NEW DELHI: The government on Tuesday decided to exercise the green shoe option in the 6 per cent stake sale in the state-owned NHPC through Offer for Sale (OFS), following an overwhelming response from investors on the first day of subscription.

The OFS received an encouraging response from investors and was oversubscribed 3.47 times on the first day.

“Offer for Sale in NHPC Limited received enthusiastic response from investors and was oversubscribed 3.47 times on the first day. Allocation will be on a price priority basis. The government has



decided to exercise the entire green shoe option. Retail investors and employees get to bid on 3rd June 2026,” Department of Investment and Public Asset Management (DIPAM) Secretary Arunish Chawla said in a post on X.

The government on Monday announced to sell up to 6 per

CLOSER LOOK

- » The government on Monday announced to sell up to 6% stake in NHPC via OFS at a floor price of Rs 71 /share
- » The OFS includes a base offer of 3 per cent of the government’s equity in NHPC and an additional 3 per cent green shoe option

cent stake in NHPC via OFS at a floor price of Rs 71 per share.

The OFS includes a base offer of 3 per cent of the government’s equity in NHPC and an additional 3 per cent green shoe option.

The floor price of Rs 71 per share is at an 8 per cent discount over Monday’s closing price of

Rs 77.19 on the BSE. On Monday, the stock ended 2.07 per cent lower than Friday’s close.

The OFS opened for non-retail investors on Tuesday, while for retail investors it will open on Wednesday.

Sale of over 60.27 crore shares representing a 6 per cent stake at a floor price of Rs 71

a share would fetch about Rs 4,200 crore to the exchequer.

This will be the third OFS of a public sector company in the current fiscal year.

Last week, the government sold a 2 per cent stake in Coal India via OFS to mop up Rs 5,542 crore. In May, it sold 8.08 per cent in the Central Bank of India to raise Rs 2,266 crore. Together, the disinvestment proceeds so far in FY27 stand at Rs 7,808 crore. The FY27 Budget has estimated a mop-up of Rs 80,000 crore through disinvestment and asset monetisation, more than double the Rs 33,837 crore as per the Revised Estimates for FY26.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sumit @ Babu @ Chikna S/o Deshraj R/o House No. J-1034, J-Block, Jahangirpuri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 473/2023 U/S 392/411/34 IPC, PS Mahendra Park, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Sumit @ Babu @ Chikna** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Sumit @ Babu @ Chikna** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sumit @ Babu @ Chikna of FIR No. 473/2023 U/S 392/411/34 IPC, PS Mahendra Park, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **29.07.2026**

By Order
Ms. Amar Deep Kaur
LD. Addl. Chief Judicial Magistrate, North Room No. 117
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/7260/NW/2026(Court Matter)

Office of the Executive Engineer, Irrigation Division, Deoghar

(e-Mail Id- ceirdd@gmail.com)

e-Procurement short-Notice

e-Tender Reference no-WRD/Irr.Div.Deoghar/F2-01/2026-27

(2nd Call)

dt 02.06.2026

1.	Name of Work	CONSTRUCTION OF H/R CUM C/R WORK AT CH.857 & SLR BRIDGE AT CH.1261 OF PUNASI MAIN CANAL. Rs. 1,69,39,153.47 (Rs. One Crore Sixty nine Lakh Thirty nine thousand One huded Fifty three and paise Forty seven) only/-
2.	Estimated Cost	270 Days
3.	Time of Completion	
4.	Date of Publication of E-Tender on website	Dt.-04.06.2026
5.	Last date/Time for submission of E-Tender BID'S	Dt.-18.06.2026 at 5:00 PM
6.	Last date for online submission of E-Tender fee and EMD	Dt.-18.06.2026
7.	Date of Opening Tender	Dt.-19.06.2026 at 3:00 PM
8.	Name & Address of Office inviting tender	Executive Engineer, Irrigation Division, Deoghar
a.	Contact no of e-Procurement officer	97710-63448
b.	Helpline number of e-Procurement Cell	06432-232477

Note:- (1) Only e-Tender will be accepted

(2) Published Estimated Cost may be Increase or Decrease

Further Details Can be seen on website http://jhar.khandendres.gov.in

Executive Engineer,
Irrigation Division, Deoghar

PR.NO.381293 Water Resource(26-27):D

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82(2) (ii) Cr. P.C./84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Sachin S/o Chetan Dass R/o B-162/6, Gali No. 09, Bhajanpura, Delhi**, have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 77/2015 U/s 324/34 IPC.**, has been registered at **P.S. Bhajanpura, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Sachin** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Sachin** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Sachin FIR No. 77/2015 U/s 324/34 IPC.**, registered at **P.S. Bhajanpura, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **04.07.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Pankaj Rai
JMFC-01, Room No. 73
Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/7321/NE/2026
(Court Notice)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No.: JHS/Commercial/e-Auction/26/185

Dated: 01.06.2026

NOTICE INVITING E-AUCTION

On Behalf of The President of India, The Divisional Railway Manager (Commercial) Jhansi invites e-auction as per categories given as under:-

Category: Advertisement Catalogue No.: JHS-NFR-ADV-50

Asset Details: E-AUCTION FOR CONTRACT UNDER- (1) Advertisement right through RDN NON DIGITAL media (flex board/glowsign board/ran slight/led flange static advertisement) inside TKMG-MCSC-BNDA Railway Station. (2) Display of commercial publicity outside MAHARAJA CHHATRASAL STATION CHHATARPUR Railway Station under COPI policy over Jhansi Division. (3) Advertisement right on exterior portion (Full Face) of the coaches of following Train No. (02 TRAIN) : 12197/98. (4) Advertisement right on exterior portion (BELOW WINDOW) of the coaches of following Train No. (01 TRAIN): 11125/26. (5) Open E auction to provide refreshment facility for staff and labours at TIKAMGARH & CHHATARPUR Goods Shed.

Auction Start Date & Time: 16.06.2026 at 11:00 Hrs.

Auction End Date & Time: 16.06.2026 at 12:20 Hrs.

Note:- Prospective bidders are requested to visit e-Auction Leasing module on IREPS website (www.ireps.gov.in). The Lot-wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Catalogue Number. 1242/26 (A)

f North central railways | @CPRONCR | www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Tender Notice No. JHS-N-GSU-09-26

Dated: 28.05.2026

E-Tendering Notice

Dy. Chief Signal & Telecom Engineer/GSU/Jhansi, DRM's office, Jhansi, for and on behalf of President of India invite open Tender through online (E-Tendering) for the following works.

E-Tender No.: JHS-N-GSU-09-26

Description of work: EI alteration and other S&T work for Construction of ROB's in lieu of level Crossing No. 315 at Km. 993/30-32, 335 at Km. 1058/30-32 and 357 at Km.1103/34-36 in between Bina-Jhansi section of Jhansi Division.

Approx Cost: ₹ 11998678.97 Earnest Money: ₹ 240000.00

Cost of Tender form: Nil Opening of tender: 19.06.2026 Time 15.00

Completion period from issue of letter of acceptance 12 Months

Tender online can be submitted up to 15:00 hrs on 19.06.2026

For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in. (JHANSI DIVISION-GATI SHAKTI, NORTH CENTRAL RLY) 1238/26 FA

f North central railways | @CPRONCR | www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Krishna, S/o: Ravi, R/o: B-4/133, Sultan Puri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 255/2017, U/s 324/506/34 IPC, P.S.: Subzi Mandi, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Krishna** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Krishna** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Krishna** accused of case **FIR No. 255/2017, U/s 324/506/34 IPC, P.S.: Subzi Mandi, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **08.07.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Preeti Rajoria
Judicial Magistrate First Class - 07 Room No. 32, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/7057/N/2026
(Court Matter)

Fashion statement, court verdict

Sabalenka ends Osaka challenge; Kostyuk books Andreeva date

PARIS: Naomi Osaka may have had the edge in the fashion contest. In the tennis department, though, top-ranked Aryna Sabalenka was the winner.

Sabalenka beat Osaka 7-5, 6-3 on Monday to reach the French Open quarterfinals and move one step closer to finally winning the clay-court Grand Slam, where she lost last year's final to Coco Gauff.

It was the first women's night match at Roland Garros in three years and Osaka entered the court wearing a golden bomber jacket over her gold sequin playing dress, trailing a tiered train with puffs of tulle.

Sabalenka wore more standard tennis attire: A slightly sheer black flared tennis dress with a red underlayer; plus diamond necklaces.

In the matchup of four-time Grand Slam champions, Sabalenka improved to 3-1 in her career against Osaka, who was playing in the fourth round at Roland Garros for the first time.

Sabalenka overpowered Osaka from the baseline, and produced a huge forehand return winner on her first match point that Osaka barely got her racquet on.

Sabalenka's quarterfi-



Marta Kostyuk won her quarterfinal against compatriot Elina Svitolina in three sets, while Aryna Sabalenka downed Naomi Osaka in two sets

nal opponent will be Diana Shnaider, who beat Madison Keys — the last American woman remaining in contention — 6-3, 3-6, 6-0.

Kostyuk vs Andreeva Marta Kostyuk, the best player on clay this season and a vocal supporter of Ukraine amid the war with Russia, will play her first major semifinal at the French Open against a Russian.

Kostyuk won an intense all-Ukraine quarterfinal against Elina Svitolina 6-3, 2-6, 6-2 on Tuesday.

1 Kostyuk is the first Ukrainian woman to reach the semifinals at Roland Garros in the professional era (since 1968)

That set up Kostyuk against Russian teenager Mirra Andre-eva, who thumped Romanian veteran Sorana Cirstea 6-0, 6-3.

Kostyuk leads Andreeva 2-0 on the tour; the second win in the Madrid final a month ago. Kostyuk didn't shake hands at the net, following protocol for



Marta Kostyuk won her quarterfinal against compatriot Elina Svitolina in three sets, while Aryna Sabalenka downed Naomi Osaka in two sets

nian people and to their resilience. Slava Ukraini! (Glory to Ukraine!)"

Andreeva will appear in her second French Open semi-final, two years after the first. She was asked about the challenges of playing a Ukrainian in war-time. "Well, for me it doesn't matter who I play," Andre-eva said. "I really try to play against the ball that is coming at me. Usually it doesn't matter to me who I'm playing against, so I'm trying to really focus on the game and on the game plan that I have to use."

Pragg, Gukesh live to fight another day

OSLO: Indians struck back in style in Round 7 as D Gukesh and R Pragganandhaa delivered crucial victories while Divya Deshmukh bounced back from her previous-round setback to beat compatriot Koneru Humpy, reigniting the country's challenge as the Norway Chess title race entered its decisive phase here.

World champion Gukesh salvaged 1.5 points from his clash against American Grandmaster Wesley So, securing victory in the Armageddon tie-break after letting a winning opportunity slip in the classical game, to move to eight points overall. He, however, remained rooted to the bottom. Pragganandhaa, meanwhile,

handed French Grandmaster Alireza Firouzja a second successive classical defeat to collect the full three points and climb to nine, but the gains did little to alter the standings, with the young Indian GM remaining fifth and Gukesh sixth.

However, both Indians stayed within touching distance of the leaders and could

yet make a late charge with three rounds still to be played.

Wesley So continued to lead the standings with 12.5 points, while Alireza held second place on 10. A tightly packed chasing group of three players -- Pragganandhaa, world No. 1 Magnus Carlsen and Germany's Vincent Keymer -- shared third spot on nine points.

'FAVOURITES TO WIN T20 WC'

Anjum believes India's time has come

AHMEDABAD: The English conditions are no longer "alien" for the Indian women's cricket team, who will start as favourites at the upcoming T20 World Cup, says former captain Anjum Chopra.

The 'Women in Blue' begin their T20 World Cup campaign against arch-rivals Pakistan in Birmingham on June 14.

"England conditions are not alien. Few of them or most of them have already played there, at least the core of this Indian team. For Nandini (Sharma), yes, she is playing there. But in a very small career of Shree Charani, this is her second tour to England in less than 12 months," Chopra said in an exclusive interview.

"For me, India will always remain one of the favourite sides. Obviously, I want them there.



India open campaign against Pakistan on June 14

Not only in the top four. I want them in the top two and then the top team," she added.

One of the biggest positives for India in the lead-up to the World Cup has been the return of wicketkeeper-batter Yastika Bhatia from a lengthy injury layoff. The left-hander made an immediate impact on her comeback, scoring a fluent 54 off 40 balls in the opening T20I against

England, a match in which skipper Harmanpreet Kaur was rested.

With Yastika staking a strong claim to the No. 3 spot and Jemimah Rodrigues moving down the order, Chopra feels the Indian team management may need to embrace greater flexibility in its batting line-up.

"It's very good that she (Yastika) is scoring runs and she scored in the first T20. Though she

“England conditions are not alien. Few of them or most of them have already played there

— Anjum Chopra, former India captain

missed out on a long innings in the second. But what it also does is that it's not about just balancing out Jemmy and Harman and Yastika," she noted. "I am not saying that they will not be because right now, it's just a series against England. But in less than a couple of weeks they will play their first game, I feel there needs to be a little more adaptability to the flexibility."

Liverpool opens talks with Andoni Iraola

LIVERPOOL: Liverpool has begun negotiations with Andoni Iraola to be the new coach, a person with knowledge of the situation told the Associated Press.

The person spoke on the condition of anonymity because nothing

has been formally agreed. Former Bournemouth coach Iraola was quickly identified as the favorite to succeed the fired Arne Slot, with Liverpool wanting its next appointment to play a more attacking style of soccer. Liverpool sporting

director Richard Hughes has led the recruitment process. Spanish coach Iraola led Bournemouth to European qualification this season and then walked away. Under him, Bournemouth was one of the most entertaining teams.

‘Queen’ Serena’s comeback met with rejoice

PARIS: Serena Williams is coming back to professional tennis at the age of 44, returning to the sport she dominated for two decades before famously "evolving" away from the daily grind of competition.

First up for the 23-time Grand Slam singles champion is the doubles tournament at Queen's Club. But Wimbledon and the U.S. Open could be next.

"It seems like she's trying to work her way up maybe to the U.S. Open, and those fans would be so ready to see her back on a singles court there," former No. 1 Lindsay Davenport said at the French Open after the WTA Tour



announced Monday that Williams has accepted a wild-card invitation to play doubles at next week's grass-court tournament in London.

Williams won seven Wimbledon titles and six at the U.S. Open before stepping away from the game in 2022. In doubles,

she won six titles at Wimbledon and two at the U.S. Open — all with her older sister Venus Williams.

"She's a legend. It's inspiring to see," top-ranked Aryna Sabalenka said. "I'm excited to see her play and probably face her. ... It's very good news for tennis."

John McEnroe suggested Williams could compete in singles at Wimbledon, which starts June 28. "She's not getting any younger but she's Serena Williams so I bet you she would tell me about wanting to win the whole damn thing," McEnroe said in Paris.

The Queen's Club tournament starts next Monday and the WTA said Williams will play "with a partner to be announced in due course." "Queen's Club feels like the perfect place to begin this next chapter," Williams said in a statement. "Grass has given me some of the most meaningful moments of my career."

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING
ATTENDANCE OF DEFENDANT

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Prince@Shekhar, S/o: Jitender Kumar, R/o: 3802, B-Block, Sant Nagar Burari, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 635/2022, U/s: 21/25 NDPS Act, Police Station Wazirabad, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Prince@Shekhar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Prince@Shekhar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Prince@Shekhar of Police Station Wazirabad, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **07.07.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Virender Singh
Special Judge (NDPS),
Central, Room No. 222
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/7197/N/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE
OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Veena, W/o: Naresh, R/o: H.No. C-81, Yadav Nagar, Samaypur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 798/2023 U/s 135 Electricity Act, P.S.: Samaypur Badli, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Veena** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Veena** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Veena** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 798/2023 U/s 135 Electricity Act, P.S.: Samaypur Badli, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **03.07.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Prashant Kumar
Additional Sessions Judge (Electricity)
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/7332/ON/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Procurement Tender Notice No. 16/2026 Dated 27.05.2026

E-Procurement Tender Notice

On behalf of President of India, Sr. Divisional Materials Manager, North Central Railway, Prayagraj invites the E-procurement tenders:

Tender No. : 19265376A	Qty. : 301 Nos.	EMD (Rs.) : 1,55,820/-
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Description : Apparatus Case Asm./Location Box

Tender Opening Date : 23.06.2026

Note:- (1) The complete information of above E-Procurement Tender is available on IREPS website i.e. <https://www.ireps.gov.in>. (2) Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above Tender, for this purpose, Vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Class III digital Signature certificates issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. (3) Rates entered into financial rate page and duly signed digitally shall only be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form/letter head if attached by vendor shall be straight away ignored and shall not be considered. (4) Documents being attached should be signed on their body. The above tender notice has been uploaded on <https://www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in>". In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the IREPS website may be approached. 1230/26 (ADM)

North central railways @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONCR

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Tushar Kumar S/o Sh. Vijender Singh R/o H. No. B-97, Ground Floor, Khirki Village, Malviya Nagar, New Delhi & B-97, Ground Floor, DDA Flats, Panchsheel Vihar, New Delhi, Permanent Address: Village Bhopal Garhi, Thana Akrabad, Distt. Aligarh, (U.P.)** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence case FIR No. 691/2023 U/s 363/366/376 IPC & 6 POCSO Act at P.S. Neb Sarai, New Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Tushar Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Tushar Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr. P.C. has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Tushar Kumar** accused of committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence case FIR No. 691/2023 u/s 363/366/376 IPC & 6 POCSO Act at P.S. Neb Sarai, New Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **04.07.2026**.

By Order: Sh. Anuj Kumar Singh,
Addl. Session Magistrate (FTSC) (Pocso),
(South), Room No. 605,
Saket Court Complex, New Delhi

DP/7327/SD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C / 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely: **Shahbaz @ Shahnawaz, S/o. Irfan, R/o.: C-115, Gali No.10, Gamri Extension, Bhajanpura, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in Case **FIR 507/2020 U/S 392/411/34 IPC** registered at **P.S. Bhajanpura, North East District, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Shahbaz @ Shahnawaz** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Shahbaz @ Shahnawaz** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Shahbaz @ Shahnawaz**, accused of Case **FIR 507/2020 U/S 392/411/34 IPC** registered at **P.S. Bhajanpura, North East District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.07.2026**.

By Order, Sh. Pankaj Rai
Judicial Magistrate First Class-01,
DP/7318/NE/2026 Room No.73, Third Floor, North East District,
(Court Matter) Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

JHARKHAND BIJLI VITRAN NIGAM LIMITED
(CIN: U40108JH2013SGC001702)
Regd. Office:- Engineering Building, HEC, Dhurua, Ranchi-834004.
fax # 0651-2400483 e-mail : cesp.jseb@rediffmail.com/gmsp.jbvn@rediffmail.com

North Central Railway
JBNVL invites online short e-tender from reputed, technically experienced and financially sound manufacturers/ supplier only for procurement of following Materials :-

Sr	NIT/Tender notice No. and description of item	Tender fee	Date of publication of tender on website	Document download start date & time	Online Bid Submission start date	Online Bid Submission end date	Technical bid opening date and time
I	129/PR/JBNVL/2026-27 33 KV 3 Pin Type AB Switch 630 Amp.	Rs 10000/- + GST	03/06/2026 from 13:00 Hrs.	03/06/2026 from 13:10 Hrs.	03/06/2026 from 13:20 Hrs.	16/06/2026 upto 18:00 Hrs.	17/06/2026 at 18: 00 Hrs.

NOTE:- (i) Only e-tenders will be accepted. Further details can be seen on website <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> and may be contacted on Mobile No. 9470378503/9430348596, NIC helpline No. 0651-2400178
(ii) Tender fee & EMD must be paid through online mode.
(iii) Tender fee is non-refundable.

स्वीकृत एवं राष्ट्रहित में ऊर्जा बचावों। कृपया अपनी शिकायतों को 18003456570 (कॉल सेंटर) पर दर्ज करावें।
PR 381350 (Jharkhand Bijlee Vitran Nigam Ltd)26-27'D

Sd/-
DGM (Purchase)JBNVL

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender No.: DY-CE-JHSW-93 Dated: 01.06.2026

E-TENDERING TENDER NOTICE

Dy. Chief Engineer/Workshop/Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invite "Open Tender" through On Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

Description of Work: JHS (RCNK/JHS):- Balance work of Rainwater harvesting and related work in RCNK/JHS.

Approx Cost (Rs.): ₹ 11739011.75 (One Crore Seventeen Lakh Thirty Nine Thousand Eleven Rupees and Seventy Five paise Only).

Earnest Money (Rs.): ₹ 234800/- Cost of Tender Form (Rs.): NIL

Date of Closing of Tender: 24.06.2026 At 15:30 hrs.

Date of Completion/period from issue acceptance letter: 09 Months

For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in. 1225/26 (A)

North central railways @ CPRONCR @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
TRANSMISSION LINE MAINTENANCE
DIVISION II
SRINAGAR PAMPORE

Subject: Extension of e-NIT No. TLMD-II/ 02 of 2026-27 dt: 09.04.2026.

No: TLMD II/ 555-57 dt:01.06.2026.

(Extension-III)

Due to the poor response to the tender & in view of requests received from prospective bidders, the fresh dates for e-filling of e-NIT No.TLMD-II/ 02 of 2025-26 dt: 09.04.2026 for the work "Supply, Erection, Testing & Commissioning of 20 MVA, 132/33KV Three Phase Power Transformers (Buffer) at 132/33KV GSS Awantipora of JKPTCL Kashmir" are hereby extended as detailed below:-

Last Date of online filling of e-bids	10.06.2026 up to 02:00 pm
Date of opening of e-bids	11.06.2026 at 02:00 pm

Sd/-
Executive Engineer
TLMD II Pampore

DIPK-NB-633/26

CENTRE FOR DISTANCE & ONLINE EDUCATION
UNIVERSITY OF JAMMU
(NAAC Accredited A++ Grade University)

E-Tender Notice

The Centre for Distance & Online Education invites Short e-Tenders from eligible offset printers across India for Empanelment as Offset Printers for Printing & Supply of Study Material at CDOE, JU. The last date for submission of the said tender is 10-06-2026.

E-Tender can be downloaded/submitted online at www.jktenders.gov.in

Notice inviting tender which includes eligibility criteria, detailed terms & conditions are also available on University Websites: www.jammuuniversity.ac.in, www.distanceeducationju.in.

No: CDOE/Pub/26/226 Sd/-
Dated : 01-06-2026 DIP No:DIP/U-875-P/26 DIRECTOR (CDOE)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tendering Tender Notice

Divisional Railway Manager (Works) N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No.: JHS-ENGG - N- 2026-128

Description of work : Supplying and stacking of Alumino thermic welding portions 52 Kg 90UTS, 60 Kg 90UTS rails/ 60 kg 60EI R-260 rails with complete accessories under Sr.DEN/IN/JHS jurisdiction.

Approx Cost : 26059175.00 Earnest Money : 521200.00

Date of completion /period from issue acceptance letter. 24 Months

Date of closing Tender : 25/06/2026 at 15:00 hrs., Tender on line can be submitted up to 15:00 hrs on 25.06.2026. For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in 1220/26 (D)

North central railways @ CPRONCR @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
TRANSMISSION LINE MAINTENANCE
DIVISION II
SRINAGAR PAMPORE.

Subject: Extension of e-NIT No. TLMD-II/ 01 of 2026-27 dt: 09.04.2026.

No: TLMD II/552-54 dt:01.06.2026.

(Extension-III)

Due to the poor response to the tender & in view of requests received from prospective bidders, the fresh dates for e-filling of e-NIT No.TLMD-II/ 01 of 2026-27; dt: 09.04.2026 for the work "Supply, Erection, Testing & Commissioning of 02 No. 50 MVA, 132/33KV Three Phase Power Transformers (Buffer) at 132/33KV GSS Pampore & Amargarh of JKPTCL Kashmir" are hereby extended as detailed below:-

Last Date of online filling of e-bids	10.06.2026 up to 02:00 pm
Date of opening of e-bids	11.06.2026 at 02:00 pm

Sd/-
Executive Engineer
TLMD II Pampore

DIP No:DIPK-NB-631/26

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Tender Notice No.- EPC-2026-27-01 Date- 27.05.2026

E-Tender Notice

The Dy. Chief Engineer/Const./North Central Railway/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite the following E-Tenders on prescribed form for the following works up to 15.00 hrs. on 27.08.2026. The details of the tenders are as under:-

S.N.1. Tender No.: EPC-2026-27-01

Name of work: Engineering Procurement and Construction (EPC) contract for third line track between Manikpur (excluding) to Bargharh (including) (Ch: 1257.180 to 1297.000) including Electrification & Signaling works along with construction of ROB on LC No. 404/C2, 406/2T & 407/2E in connection with Manikpur-Iradatganj 3rd line project of North Central Railway.

Approx Cost of work: ₹ 620.86 Cr. (approx.) Bid Security: ₹ 12,41,71,800/-

Completion Period: 24 months Type of tendering: Open (Two Packet System)

Tender Closing Date & Time: 27.08.2026 15.00 hrs.

Date of Opening of tender: 27.08.2026 15.30 hrs.

Note: - 1. The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders are available on Website www.ireps.gov.in up to 15.00 hrs on the due date of tender opening i.e. 27.08.2026. 2. Bids other than in the form of E-bids shall not be accepted against above Tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificates issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. 3. The Bid Security shall be deposited either in cash through e-payment gateway or submitted as Bank Guarantee bond from a scheduled commercial bank of India or as mentioned in tender documents. The Bank Guarantee bond shall be as per format in favour of FA & CAO/CINCR/PRYJ as given in Tender Document and shall be valid for a period of 90 days beyond the bid validity period. 4. Rates entered into Financial Rate page and duly signed digitally shall be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form/letter head if attached by vendor shall be straight away ignored and shall not be considered. 5. Joint Venture (JV)/Consortiums/MOUs shall be considered for the tender having cost more than 10 Cr. 6. Documents being attached should be signed by the tenderer on its body. 7. The tenderers shall submit a certificate as given in tender document in standard format for all items without which their tender may not be considered and shall be summarily rejected. 8. Each page of the copy of documents/certificates in support of credentials, submitted by the tenderer, shall be self-attested/digitally signed by the tenderer or authorized representative of the tendering firm. Self-attestation shall include signature, stamp and date (on each page). Only those documents which are declared explicitly by the tenderer as "documents supporting the claim qualifying the laid down eligibility criteria", will be considered for evaluation his/their tender. In case of any wrong information submitted by the tenderer, the contract will be terminated. Bid Security (BS), Performance Guarantee (PG and Security Deposit (SD) of contract will be forfeited and agency will be banned for doing business on entire Indian Railways for two (02) years. 9. GST Act & rules issued from time to time by the Government authorities shall be applicable. 10. In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. 11. Tender online can be submitted up to 15.00 hrs. on 27.08.2026 and will be opened at 15.30 hrs. on same day. 1229/26 FA

North central railways @ CPRONCR @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

millenniumpost
CLASSIFIEDS

CHANGE OF NAME

I, Patrick John Das S/o Sh. Chaitanya Das R/o D-215, G/ F, Back Side, Jhilmil Colony, East Delhi, Delhi-110095 have changed my name from Patrick Xavier to Patrick John Das for all purpose in future.

I, Alvina John Das W/o Sh. Chaitanya Das R/o D-215, G/ F, Back Side, Jhilmil Colony, East Delhi, Delhi-110095 have changed my name from Alivna Xavier to Alvina John Das for all purpose in future.

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF Ms. Meeta Kohli
Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division),
Bhiwani
MAHENDER S/O HARDWARI R/O
GALI NO-2 DADRI GATE, KONT ROAD
BIHANI
VS.
GENERAL PUBLIC
APPLICATION FOR SUCC. US 372
CASE NO SUCC-18-2025
CNR No.HRBH02-001318-2025
Next Date 15-07-2026
PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:
GENERAL PUBLIC
:-
INDIA
In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 15-07-2026 at 10:00 am.
For details login to <https://highcourtchd.gov.in/tmod> = district notice & district = Bhiwani
Sd/- Ms. Meeta Kohli
Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division),
dated 02.06.2026 Bhiwani

CHHATTISGARH STATE POWER TRANSMISSION COMPANY LIMITED
(A Govt. of Chhattisgarh Undertaking GSTN-22AADCC573E1Z3 CIN-440108CT2003SGC015820)
OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR (LINE) Block-4, Near CSPCL Dispensary, Dagaia, Raipur (C.G.)
Website: www.cspcl.co.in E-Mail: ceah@cspcl.co.in Phone no. 9771 - 2574221, 2574028 Fax No.2574222

ED/Line/Works/EE-I/TR-1157/497 Raipur, Date:29.05.2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (Through E-bidding module of SAP-SRM)

Online bids are invited for following EHV work on labour contract basis as detailed here under:

TR No	Name of work	EMD (Rs)	Cost of tender form (Rs) (Incl. GST)	Date of opening
TR-1157 RFX No.- 8100051910	Modification of 132 KV Kharmora (Korba) – Champa line between location No. 62 - 69 (RL- 2.802 KM) on request of M/s Korba Power Limited	100900/-	5,000/-	24.06.2026

For all other details of NIT and terms & conditions, please visit our web site: <https://espc.co.in> > [espcctl_tendernotices](https://espc.co.in) (OR) <https://www.espc.co.in> > ebidding > ebidding web portal (OR) <https://ebidding.espc.co.in:50724/irj/portal>
SAVE ELECTRICITY samvad 47986/1 EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR (LINE) CSPCL, Raipur

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Mohammad Irfan @ Sanjay, S/o: Suleman, R/o: F-185, Gali No-6 Near Bismillah Masjid Subhash Mohalla, North Ghonda, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **CC No 1: 2189/19, 2.: 1229/19, 3. 1931/19, U/s: 138 NIACT, P.S. Gokul Puri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Mohammad Irfan @ Sanjay** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Mohammad Irfan @ Sanjay** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Mohammad Irfan @ Sanjay of P.S. Gokul Puri, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **04.07.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Pankaj Rai
Ld. MM-01, North East Distt.,
5th Floor Room No. 73,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/7216/NE/2026

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tendering Tender Notice

Dy CE(TMC) Line JHS acting for and on behalf of The President of India invites open tender through E-Tenders with closing date mentioned against each:

E-Tender Notice no. : JHS-TMC-05-2026 Estimated value (Rs.): 13875281.38

Name of work : WORK FOR SUPPLY, ASSEMBLING, COMMISSIONING AND MAINTAINING OF NEW TAMPING BANKS FOR UNIMAT SPLIT HEAD 275 MF TRACK MACHINES WITH WARRANTY PERIOD.

Earnest money, (Rs.): 277500.00 Tender closing date & time : 26.06.2026

Period of completion : 06 Months.

* Tender can be submitted online on date mentioned against each up to 15:00 Hrs. • For details description & submission of tender, please see website of Indian Railway www.ireps.gov.in. Detail of Tender notice can also be seen on Notice Board of Dy. CE (TMC) Line office Jhansi. 1231/28 (AS)

North central railways @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONCR

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Vikash Kumar S/o Siro Paswan R/o Jhuggi No. L-142, Vijay Vihar Ph-1, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 159/2023, U/s 380/411/34 IPC, PS Vijay Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Vikash Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Vikash Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Vikash Kumar** of case **FIR No. 159/2023, U/s 380/411/34 IPC, PS Vijay Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **07.07.2026**.

By Order
Shagun
Ld. Judicial Magistrate First Class
Room No. 109, First Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/7128/RD/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTHERN RAILWAY

OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE

Invitation of tender through E-Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)

The Divisional Engineer-IV, Northern Railway, Delhi Division for and on behalf of President of India invites E-Tender on prescribed form for the following work.

1.Name of work with its location	Construction of LHS with Roof Covering Shed at km 264/3-5 in Maur yard on DL-LBTI section. Similar Nature of work: Construction of bridges/ Limited high subway with box pushing/pipe pushing method
2.Approx. cost of work	(1)Rs. 36194725.59
3.Earnest money	(1)Rs. 723900.00
4.Date and Time of submission of tender and opening of tender	Bidding Start date for work no. Up to 15:00 hrs. on 09.06.2026 opening of e-Tender at 15:00 hrs. on 23.06.2026
5.Website particulars, published e-tender, notice location etc. complete details of tender can be seen and website where the tender form can be downloaded	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in

No. 128-W/260/Tender Notice/16/26-27/W4-V Date : 01.06.2026 1857/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bhartiya Nagrik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Yogesh S/o Shankar Lal R/o N-44/A-192, Gali No. 9, Sanjay Colony, Swaroop Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence **FIR No. 290/2021 u/s 279/338 IPC** at P.S. Swaroop Nagar, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Yogesh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Yogesh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr.P.C./84 Bhartiya Nagrik Suraksha Sanhita has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Yogesh** accused of **FIR No. 290/2021 u/s 279/338 IPC** at P.S. Swaroop Nagar, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **03.07.2026**.

By Order: Ms. Jyoti Nain,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07,
Room No. 6, First Floor,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/7263/ON/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Dharambir (Prop. Auth. Signatory, M/s Haryana Khad And Beej Bhandar), S/o: Sh. Suraj Bhan, R/o Railway Road Ganaur Sonipat Haryana Also at: Village Chirsami (112) Ganur Distt. Sonipat Haryana**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in Ct. Case/CC NI Act: 2764/2020, U/s: 138 NI Act, P.S.: Patel Nagar, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Dharambir**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Dharambir**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Dharambir**, of Ct. Case/CC NI Act: 2764/2020, U/s: 138 NI Act, P.S.: Patel Nagar, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **07.07.2026**.

By Order
Poonam Singh
Judicial Magistrate First Class (West) (NI Act)-04
Room No. 04 Annex-I
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/7152/CD/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tendering NoticeNo.2026-May-03 Dated 29.05.26

E-Tender Notice

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering), N. C. Rly Agra for and on behalf of the President of India invites "Open Tender" through on Line only (E-Tendering) for the following works. The details of the tender are as under:

SN.: 1 Tender No.: 2026-May-03-01	Approx Cost: ₹ 1,60,00,000.00
Description of work: Zone 1 : AGC -Repairs & maintenance work of all Service buildings and quarters etc. in North area at Agra Cantt for the year 2026-27 (01.07.26 to 30.06.27)	
SN.: 2 Tender No.: 2026-May-03-02	Approx Cost: ₹ 95,00,000.00
Description of work: Zone 2 (IDH area) : Repairs & maintenance work of all Service buildings and quarters etc. in AGC- (Excl.) to TDL (Excl.), Excl. RKM to JAB for the year 2026-27 (01.07.26 to 30.06.27)	
SN.: 3 Tender No.: 2026-May-03-03	Approx Cost: ₹ 1,60,00,000.00
Description of work: Zone 8 : AGC -Repairs & maintenance work of all Service buildings and quarters etc. in South area at Agra Cantt for the year 2026-27 (01.07.26 to 30.06.27)	
SN.: 4 Tender No.: 2026-May-03-04	Approx Cost: ₹ 70,00,000.00
Description of work: Zone 9 : Repairs & maintenance work of all Service buildings and quarters etc. Excl. AGC- Excl. Baad between section for the year 2026-27 (01.07.26 to 30.06.27)	

For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in Tenders can only be submitted through web portal www.ireps.gov.in up to 15.00 hrs on 19.06.26 1226/26 (MG)

North central railways @ CPRONCR @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No. GSU/EI/PRYJ/EIG/HGJ/2026 Dated: 29.05.2026

Public Notification

Notice is hereby given to all users of Railway lines and premises situated on the completed section of the under- noted section of the North Central Railway that the 25000 Volt, 50 Hz, AC overhead traction wires will be energized on or after the date specified against the section on and from the same date the overhead traction line shall be treated as live at all the times and no unauthorized person shall approach or work in the proximity of the said overhead line.

Division:- Prayagraj, Date of energization:- on or after 19.06.2026

Name of Section :- Harduaganj yard Line no. 15 between KM 153/3025C to L-15/4A in Aligarh-Bareilly section of Prayagraj division of North Central Railway.

Dy.Chief. Electrical Engineer [GSU],
1224/26(DG)
North Central Railway, Prayagraj

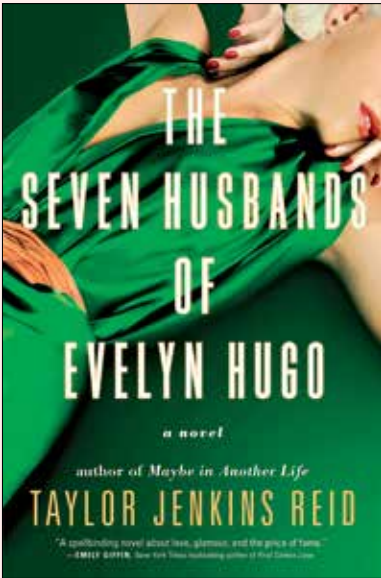
North central railways @ CPRONCR @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in



ANNA TO DIRECT ‘THE SEVEN HUSBANDS OF EVELYN HUGO’

Kendrick made her directorial debut in 2023 with ‘Woman of the Hour’

Hollywood star Anna Kendrick is set to step into the director's shoes again and will direct Netflix's film adaptation of Taylor Jenkins Reid's 'The Seven Husbands of Evelyn Hugo'. Liz Tigelaar will write the film, with current revisions by Francesca Sloane. It is produced by Liza Chasin under '3Dot Productions' and Brad Mendelsohn through 'Circle of Confusion'. Reid and Margaret Chernin will executive produce the film, according to the entertainment news outlet 'The Hollywood Reporter'. 'The Seven Husbands of Evelyn Hugo' revolves around reclusive Hollywood starlet Evelyn Hugo, who enlists unknown reporter Monique Grant to write her tell-all book, which will chronicle her life story and rise to fame during the golden age of Hollywood. Always the subject of tabloids, Evelyn also details, for the first time, her seven marriages, revealing secrets she's held on to, who she is behind the scenes and why she chose Monique for her final confession. Kendrick made her directorial debut in 2023 with 'Woman of the Hour'. The crime thriller had its premiere at the Toronto International Film Festival. Besides directing 'The Seven Husbands of Evelyn Hugo', she will feature in the comedy film 'Babies' and 'Misty Green'. Her last work is 'Another Simple Favor', which was released in 2025.



It revolves around reclusive Hollywood starlet Evelyn Hugo, who enlists unknown reporter Monique Grant to write her tell-all book, which will chronicle her life story and rise to fame during the golden age of Hollywood

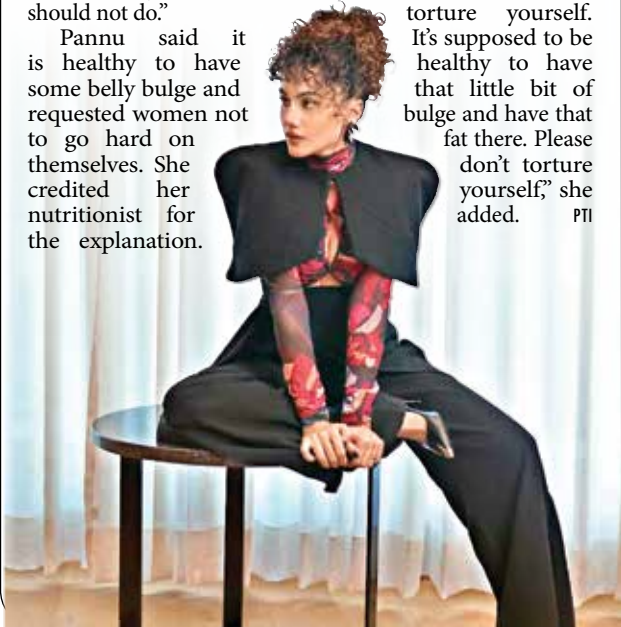
TAAPSEE ‘TORTURED’ HERSELF TO GET FLAT MIDRIFF

Pannu urged women not to torture themselves to meet unrealistic beauty standards

Taapsee Pannu urged women not to torture themselves to meet unrealistic beauty standards as she recalled her struggle to get a flat midriff. The Bollywood actress, who shared a note on her 'Instagram' story on Sunday, said she kept torturing herself to get rid of lower belly fat. "I remember I had this obsession because while growing up. I was extremely fit, but I never understood why the lower belly fat always stayed. I worked out intensely almost to an extent that I over-pushed myself and rightly said, when you over-push yourself, it rings an alarm in your brain that your body needs protection," she wrote. She added, "So instead of actually losing water retention, the body starts retaining it and then that lower belly fat, which might actually not just be fat, it's also water retention, it stays and it increases by overworking out, which I really believe people should not do." Pannu said it is healthy to have some belly bulge and requested women not to go hard on themselves. She credited her nutritionist for the explanation.

She said it's healthy to have some belly bulge and requested women not to go hard on themselves

"It cannot look like any other girl, so you need to accept this. I accepted it very late after really torturing myself and then I realised that there are some days it happens and there are some days it doesn't happen," she said. "My nutritionist Munmun Ganerwal explained to me how it's actually important to have that little bit of fat, a little bit of water retention under the belly because that's where your reproductive organs are and they need protection and by virtue of being a woman, you need that protection... It's healthy for you. So just to get those picture-perfect Instagram pictures, please don't torture yourself. It's supposed to be healthy to have that little bit of bulge and have that fat there. Please don't torture yourself," she added.



Actor Ambrish Verma receives IMDb ‘Breakout Star’ Award

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Actor, director and creator Ambrish Verma, who recently received the IMDb 'Breakout Star' STARmeter Award for his acclaimed series 'Sapne Vs Everyone' S2, opened up about his unconventional journey into the entertainment industry in an exclusive interaction with 'IMDb'. From walking away from a stable corporate career to making his name in the industry, Verma reflected on the risks, doubts and conviction that shaped his path. Speaking about leaving behind a secure corporate job to pursue acting and storytelling, Verma shared, "It was not one specific moment that told me how to do this. It was something which got built up across some three to four years." Recalling his transition from an MBA graduate with a well-paying job to joining TVF and later taking the leap into



The 'Sapne Vs Everyone' actor reflected on quitting his corporate job for acting career

uncertainty, he added, "I made the most impractical decision of quitting my job." He further explained, "When I was going to leave that job, it was not like I had a pipeline. There was nothing in the pipeline. All I knew was that now was the right time. This is something I want to do. This is something I feel I have some talent at."

Verma also reflected on how he landed his role in "The Aam Aadmi Family" and why he initially kept his acting aspirations hidden while working at "TVF". "It was very clear to me that I am not going to tell anyone that I want to act," he shared. "Once you tell them you want to be an actor, but you are doing a sales job, people start doubting your intent."

The actor revealed that things changed after he moved to TVF's Delhi office, where he was encouraged to audition internally. Recalling the advice that pushed him towards acting opportunities within the company, Verma shared, "The guy heading 'TVF' office in Delhi at that time told me, 'If you are good, then you will get a job here as an audition cracker internally. And if you are bad, then you won't get a job in Bombay, which made a lot of sense.'" He further added, "It was not a very meaty role, but I think it suited my personality at that point in time. They wanted someone with a certain kind of look and nature; they wanted a shy boy. It was a very small part, so not a lot was at stake."

‘Boong’ emerges big winner at New York Indian Film Festival

BAFTA-winning Manipuri film 'Boong' took home three awards at the just-concluded New York Indian Film Festival (NYIFF), including the 'Best Child Actor' honour for its young protagonist. The New York Indian Film Festival 2026 concluded its four-day run on Sunday with an awards ceremony, honouring the finest in Indian cinema across ten competitive categories. The festival, held from May 28 to 31, showcased a diverse slate of films across 15 languages, 'underscoring the growing dominance of regional storytelling in contemporary Indian cinema' and brought together filmmakers and artists at North America's longest-running festival dedicated to Indian independent cinema. This year's edition of the film festival, presented by the Indo-American Arts Council (IAAC), included 19 narrative (features), four documentaries (features) and 27 shorts (narratives and documentaries), including several world premieres and a special LGBTQ shorts program.



'Baksho Bondi' ('Shadowbox') won the festival's top honour, winning 'Best Film'. In contrast 'Boong', the Manipuri film that created history by winning the prestigious BAFTA award in the 'Best Children's and Family Film' category in February this year, emerged as the biggest winner of the evening with three awards: the 'Best Debut Film' (selected by the Film Critics Circle of India), the 'Best Director' for Lakshmi Priya Devi and the 'Best Child Actor' for Gugun Kipgen. Nikhil Yadav was named the 'Best Actor' for his performance in 'Vimukt', while Meenakshi Jayan took home the 'Best Actress' award for 'Victoria'. The 'Best Screenplay' honour went to Nikhil Mahajan and Prajakta Deshmukh for 'Tigheh'.

Madhuri Dixit recalls confrontation scene with Aishwarya Rai in ‘Devdas’



One of the most memorable moments in Sanjay Leela Bhansali's 'Devdas' remains the powerful face-off between Madhuri Dixit and Aishwarya Rai Bachchan. Beautifully written, staged and performed, the scene brings together two women from vastly different worlds, meeting at a crossroads defined by love, pride and heartbreak. Dramatic yet deeply emotional, it continues to be regarded as one of the film's finest sequences. Recently, Madhuri herself reflected on the iconic scene and even drew a comparison to Yash Chopra's classic 'Silsila'. Speaking to 'Zoom', the actress recalled filming the much-loved confrontation between her character Chandramukhi and Aishwarya's Paro. "I think that was my only day scene because other than this, we had all-night shoots. So, 40-night shoots and only one day scene."

'It reminded me of Silsila,' says Dixit

She added, "But it was an amazing scene where Aishwarya comes from a place of power and pride and my character comes from humility, you know. She knows that Devdas can never be hers. But she's taunting her, 'Tum kharidne aayi ho Devdas ko humse', that you have to buy him from me. He's not yours. And so that was a beautiful scene where we are contrasting two different people coming into one scene." Madhuri went on to reveal that a particular shot from the sequence reminded her of another iconic Hindi film.

WEST END SHOW

Rosamund calls out an audience member for texting

The actress said she hopes the message was important

Hollywood star Rosamund Pike criticised an audience member for texting during the climax of her West End show 'Inter Alia' but stopped short of singling the person out. The 'Gone Girl' and 'Pride and Prejudice' star performed on Saturday and returned to the stage to address it. The actress said she hopes the message was important, 'The Guardian' reported. "I just wanted to say, for anyone going to the theatre, it's a huge thing that we're trying to give you. I am trying to tell you a story and I'm feeling you and I hope you're feeling me too," she said. She added, "Somebody was texting in this part... You know who you are and I'm



not going to single you out... Maybe it was very important and maybe you're a doctor and you're saving someone's life and I hope you are, but we do see these; we do feel them. I've got you. I feel like I've got to hold you all, so when I feel that and see it, it's hard." 'Inter Alia' is a legal drama written by Australian playwright Suzie Miller. It centres around Jessica Parks, a pioneering London Crown Court Judge who finds her professional convictions and feminist principles put to the ultimate test when her teenage son is accused of rape by a classmate.



'Inter Alia' is a legal drama written by Australian playwright Suzie Miller